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An Exclusive Look Into How DBS Group CEO Tan Su Shan Is Leading Singapore's Banking Giant Into An AI Future

Naazneen Karmali, Forbes Staff

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Success, no matter how stupendous, harbors within it the seed of potential failure if taken for granted and not built upon. As Winston Churchill succinctly summed up: Success is not final. The business leaders profiled in these pages are moving ahead to future-proof their enterprises.

On the cover is one of [Singapore's most-watched CEOs, Tan Su Shan](#), the first woman to head DBS Group, Southeast Asia's largest bank by assets (\$700 billion). Tan, who was born just before the bank was set up in 1968 as the Development Bank of Singapore to support the country's then-emerging businesses, is tasked with leading it in the brave new age of AI, which businesses of all stripes, not just banks, are grappling with. The 16-year DBS veteran has embraced her role with gusto, and, as she disclosed to longtime contributor Jessica Tan in an exclusive sit-down, "It's frontier stuff."

From a banking giant to the 200 small and midsize companies featured on our annual [Best Under A Billion](#) list gives an indication of the broad spectrum we endeavor to cover. This compilation, led by contributing editor [Ardian Wibisono](#) and contributor [Yessar Rosendar](#), shines a light on top-performing companies with sales above \$10 million and below \$1 billion. Unsurprisingly, firms reaping profits from the AI boom steal the show.

One such is [Japan's Santec Holdings](#), a maker of optical testing gear much in demand in AI data centers that use fiber-optic cables to transmit vast quantities of data. The company's shoebox-sized tunable lasers are crucial to ensuring seamless transmission. Speaking with reporter [Zinnia Lee](#), CEO Mototaka Tei, whose father founded the company in 1979, says he aspires to be "very good" in the few products it makes, a goal that has earned Santec global recognition in its niche.

Another second-generation tycoon featured in this issue is [Eusebio Tanco](#) in Manila, a London School of Economics grad who's remade his family group, with roots in cement and metal trading, by diversifying into unrelated areas. Today, Tanco is balancing businesses that couldn't be more different from each other: education, ports and online gaming. We focus on the latter, where Tanco has built listed Digiplus Interactive into the Philippines' largest online gaming operator by gross gaming revenue, a key industry metric.

The entrepreneur's efforts secured him a place on the list of the [Philippines' 50 richest](#) in a challenging year when a weaker peso took a toll on the total **wealth** of the country's tycoons, which shrank 8% to \$79 billion. Despite the odds, ports billionaire [Enrique Razon Jr.](#)'s **wealth** rose meteorically and he took the No. 1 spot in the country's rankings for the first time. Razon, not one to rest on his success, is pressing ahead with the expansion of his port and energy interests at home and beyond. As always, comments welcome at executiveeditor@forbesasia.com.

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Business

OCBC shareholders to receive 47-cent interim dividend as Q2 profit jumps 22% to \$2.22 billion

Sheila Chiang

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SINGAPORE – OCBC Bank's net profit for the second quarter of 2026 grew 22 per cent as strong non-interest income led by **wealth management** cushioned the impact from lower interest rates.

Earnings for the quarter ended June 30 were \$2.22 billion, up from \$1.82 billion a year ago and beating analysts' forecast of \$1.91 billion in a Bloomberg poll.

The bank declared an interim dividend of 47 cents per share for the first half of the year, up from 41 cents a year ago.

The interim dividend payout will amount to an estimated \$2.11 billion, or approximately 50 per cent of the group's net profit after tax of \$4.19 billion for the first half.

Net interest income at OCBC declined 1 per cent to \$2.26 billion amid a lower interest-rate environment. Net interest margin fell to 1.70 per cent, 22 basis points below 1.92 per cent a year ago, but the impact was partly cushioned by a 12 per cent growth in average assets.

Non-interest income rose 51 per cent to \$1.91 billion, driven by strong broad-based growth across fee, trading and insurance income. Fees were up 28 per cent, led by **wealth management**, trading income rose 85 per cent and insurance income jumped 68 per cent.

Total allowances of \$156 million were higher than \$114 million a year ago, mainly from higher allowances for impaired assets.

In a statement, OCBC group chief executive Tan Teck Long said that global conditions remain uncertain amid geopolitical tensions and elevated inflation risks, with much of the near-term outlook depending on the easing of Asia's energy crunch brought about by the war in the Middle East.

Meanwhile, artificial intelligence and related technology sectors continue to register strong growth, he noted.

But the bank is well-positioned to navigate uncertainties and tap the growth sectors to deliver sustainable long-term value, with its strong capital, funding and liquidity position, as well as diversified income streams and disciplined risk management, he said.

OCBC updated its 2026 financial targets, including high-single-digit to low-double-digit loan growth, up from mid-single digits loan growth previously.

It also guided for total income to grow, up from previous expectations for stable-to-growing total income. The bank now expects a slight decline in net interest income, up from a slight-to-moderate decline previously. It still expects credit costs in the range of 20 to 25 basis points.

Singapore banks are expanding aggressively in the **wealth** space. OCBC in July said it will progressively launch what it says is South-east Asia's first AI-native mobile banking app, introducing two virtual avatars that can engage customers around the clock with personalised **wealth management** insights.

To further support its **wealth** push, the bank will hire 600 additional relationship managers for its consumer banking business over the next three years.

UOB and OCBC reported second-quarter earnings on Aug 7, with DBS kicking off the season on Aug 6.

DBS declared 81 cents in dividends per share for the second quarter, as net profit for the period grew 9 per cent on record **wealth management** income.

DBS's net profit came in at \$3.08 billion, up from \$2.82 billion in the year-ago period, surpassing analysts' expectations of \$2.87 billion.

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Banking

HSBC revamps mobile banking app to deliver more personalised digital experience

Team CXP Asia

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HSBC has relaunched its mobile banking app for its International **Wealth** and Premier Banking (IWPB) customers, introducing a more intuitive, personalised and self-service-focused digital experience for more than 14 million customers.

The refreshed app is now available in Singapore, Hong Kong and the UK, with additional market rollouts planned throughout 2026. The redesign was shaped by customer feedback from these markets, resulting in a simplified interface, easier navigation and greater personalisation that allows customers to tailor the app to their individual banking preferences.

Since its launch in the UK and Hong Kong, HSBC has seen increased customer engagement, with higher login frequencies and transaction volumes, particularly among its growing Premier customer segment. The results suggest customers are increasingly relying on the app as their primary banking channel for everyday financial management.

The bank has also introduced market-specific features to address local customer needs. UK users now benefit from open banking capabilities, a personalised rewards hub and a dedicated fraud hub, while customers in Hong Kong can access enhanced fraud protection and a QR code-enabled device switching process. In Singapore, the app now supports Simplified Chinese content and provides a more streamlined way to update contact details, with additional enhancements planned over the coming months.

A key focus of the redesign has been improving self-service capabilities. HSBC reported that fewer customers now need to contact its call centres as chatbot adoption continues to grow. More than half of customer enquiries handled by the chatbot are resolved without human intervention, enabling faster issue resolution while reducing demand on customer service teams.

Personalisation has also become a defining feature of the new experience. Customers are increasingly customising their home screens based on the banking services they use most frequently. In Hong Kong, foreign exchange services are among the most popular shortcuts, while UK customers tend to prioritise access to payees and everyday banking functions. The bank also reported a 120% increase in in-app case activation compared with the previous version of the application.

The new platform was developed through collaboration between HSBC's design, technology and transformation teams across India, the UK, China, Hong Kong and Singapore. Singapore became the first international market to launch the redesigned app, establishing the blueprint for future global deployments.

Beyond improving the customer experience, HSBC said its "design for millions, deliver like a startup" approach has significantly accelerated digital delivery. By bringing together business, technology and market teams, the bank has reduced implementation time to one-third of previous projects while lowering deployment costs to less than a quarter, enabling faster innovation without compromising service quality.

The latest rollout reflects a broader trend in financial services, where banks are investing in hyper-personalisation, AI-enabled self-service and customer-led digital design to strengthen engagement, improve operational efficiency and deliver more seamless omnichannel experiences.

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Business

Investors eye Beijing's next steps as Hong Kong insurance shares react to 20% levy report

Daisy Wu

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Prudential, AIA and HSBC slid following report of the insurance levy, though Goldman Sachs says profit fallout may be limited

Hong Kong's long-standing appeal as a tax-efficient gateway for mainland Chinese buyers of insurance and **wealth** products is facing its biggest test in years, as authorities in mainland China begin levying tax on gains from offshore insurance policies – a shift that threatens to reshape competition for cross-border capital.

An officer at the Jingan district branch of the Shanghai Municipal Tax Service confirmed to the South China Morning Post on Thursday that its office had started levying personal income tax on gains from offshore insurance policies at a flat rate of 20 per cent, aligning with the tax applied to cross-border equity trading and offshore trusts. Enforcement would apply retroactively to 2019, said the official, who declined to be named.

The confirmation follows an earlier report by mainland financial outlet Caixin, which said tax officials in major cities including Beijing and Hangzhou have started levying personal income tax on returns from offshore insurance products – including dividend distributions and interest on prepaid premiums.

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The enforcement signals the latest step in [Beijing's push to tighten control](#) over the insurance and cross-border **wealth-management** sectors, as authorities move to close a long-standing regulatory loophole, curb capital flight and retain domestic savings.

The Hong Kong Government was closely monitoring the tax arrangements in relation to financial products, a spokeswoman for the Insurance Authority said in a statement to the SCMP on Thursday.

"The requirement for [mainland Chinese] residents to declare and pay taxes on offshore investment income in accordance with the law has long been in place. The market does not need to overinterpret or engage in unnecessary speculation," she said.

"Hong Kong's mature insurance market is expected to hold strong appeal for customers from the Chinese mainland."

Selina Lau Pui-ling, CEO of the Hong Kong Federation of Insurers, said the industry body was studying the new rules, adding that she believed the city's insurance markets could remain competitive as they offered a range of products for investment and legacy planning.

AIA declined to comment, citing a blackout period, while HSBC Life, Manulife, AXA, Prudential and FWD did not immediately respond to requests for comment on Thursday.

Legal experts, however, cautioned that the scrutiny is far narrower than initial market reactions suggest, with information-sharing protocols limiting its scope to savings- and investment-linked plans rather than the insurance sector as a whole.

The determining factor was "whether a policy carries a cash value and investment features", said Ye Yongqing, a tax lawyer at Beijing-based Anli Partners, adding that only specific categories, such as universal life insurance and annuity contracts, would fall within the reporting scope.

Pure protection insurance products – such as short-term accident cover and standard high-value medical insurance – deliver only loss compensation without cash value, Ye said, and so would remain excluded from the Common Reporting Standard used for cross-border information sharing.

While no formal nationwide policy has been published, investors and executives are now watching closely to see whether Beijing moves to codify the tax more broadly and how mainland demand holds up once the rules are clarified – a regulatory ambiguity that analysts warn would maintain near-term headwinds for Hong Kong's major financial institutions.

However, investment bank Goldman Sachs suggested in a research note that initial market reactions could exaggerate the ultimate financial fallout, pointing out that insurance and bancassurance activities generated roughly 4 per cent of overall group revenue for HSBC and Standard Chartered.

"While we take no view on any policy or regulatory outcome, we believe the actual earnings impact would be smaller should demand for offshore insurance weaken," Goldman Sachs analysts wrote, noting that direct earnings fallout would likely be limited.

Echoing the view, Wall Street giant Citigroup described the market sell-off as an "overreaction," arguing that cases represent sporadic, discretionary enforcement by local tax bureaus exploiting ambiguities in domestic tax law over insurance policy dividends, rather than a coordinated tightening of central policy from Beijing.

"Without a definitive, nationwide ruling clarifying tax arrangement [regarding] offshore insurance dividends, practically local tax bureaus can still collect tax by interpreting IIT Law in their own ways," Citi analysts noted in a flash report, adding that while the ambiguity would remain a persistent market overhang, "the structural demand for Hong Kong insurance remains fundamentally intact".

Local market observers also emphasised that the tax would not halt mainland buying altogether, as the core drivers for purchasing Hong Kong policies extended beyond simple yield comparisons.

"Mainland visitors have a strong demand to use Hong Kong insurance products to diversify their investments and for **wealth** transfer, which would not be banned by tax payment," said Kenny Tang Sing-hing, chairman of the Hong Kong Institute of Financial Analysts and Professional Commentators.

Kenny Ng Lai-yin, a strategist at Everbright Securities International, added that pure life insurers face relatively higher exposure to the tighter rules than diversified international banks, which can cross-sell alternative **wealth management** products to mainland investors.

At the close of trading in Hong Kong on Thursday, Prudential, whose Hong Kong hub was its biggest profit driver last year, fell 4.3 per cent, while pan-Asian life insurer AIA Group dropped 6 per cent. Banking heavyweights with prominent **wealth management** divisions delivered mixed performance, as HSBC Holdings slipped 1.2 per cent while Standard Chartered notched a modest 0.3 per cent gain.

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HSBC Malta posts resilient first-half results as CEO expects CrediaBank takeover to close in Q2 2027

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HSBC Bank Malta delivered a resilient financial performance during the first half of 2026, maintaining one of the strongest capital positions in the Maltese banking sector while continuing preparations for its transition to new majority shareholder CrediaBank, which HSBC's Chief Executive Officer Geoffrey Fichte expects to be completed during the second quarter of 2027, subject to regulatory approval.

The bank reported a profit before tax of €44.4 million for the six months ended 30 June 2026, down from €58.7 million in the corresponding period last year. Excluding notable one-off items, adjusted profit before tax stood at €51.7 million, reflecting the impact of a lower interest rate environment, market volatility and exceptional expenses.

Despite the decline in prof

itability, HSBC Malta's management emphasised that the underlying business remains strong, supported by growing customer activity, expanding lending volumes, increasing deposits and exceptionally robust capital and liquidity ratios.

Speaking following the presentation of the bank's halfyear results, CEO Geoffrey Fichte told the Malta Business Weekly that preparations for the transition to CrediaBank are progressing smoothly and remain on schedule.

"The transition is going very well," Fichte said. "We are working very closely with HSBC Global and CrediaBank to make sure the transition is a success. We are very enthusiastic and motivated, and we are committed to a seamless transition for our customers."

The acquisition, first announced in September 2025, will see Greek lender CrediaBank acquire HSBC Continental Europe's 70 per cent shareholding in HSBC Malta for €200 million. The agreement was formally signed in December 2025 and remains subject to the necessary corporate and regulatory approvals.

Fichte said the bank expects regulatory approval during the final quarter of 2026, with completion anticipated approximately six months later.

"We expect the transaction to close during the second quarter of next year," he said.

Reassurance for customers

With many customers closely following developments surrounding the ownership change, Fichte sought to reassure clients that the bank remains financially strong and fully committed to serving the Maltese market throughout the transition.

"We think clients have nothing to worry about," he said.

Pointing to the bank's latest financial results, Fichte noted that HSBC Malta continues to maintain the highest capital and liquidity ratios among Malta's listed banks, with capital levels also ranking among the strongest across Europe.

"We have a very strong team that's staying on, and we are committed to a smooth transaction. We are very much open for business, so we think clients have nothing to worry about. In fact, we hope they'll be as excited as we are about the future."

Addressing questions during the results presentation, Fichte also rejected suggestions that the transaction was facing delays, arguing that regulatory approval processes of this nature typically require time.

According to the CEO, the transaction is progressing faster than comparable banking acquisitions elsewhere in Europe.

He added that HSBC Malta remains confident of delivering what management describes as “a seamless transition and upgrade” under CrediaBank, with continued support from the Board of Directors.

Strong underlying performance

While reported profits declined year-on-year, HSBC Malta highlighted solid underlying business momentum across several core activities.

Net interest income fell by €4.3 million to €85.6 million, reflecting the lower interest rate environment compared with the exceptionally favourable conditions experienced in 2025.

Non-funded income also declined slightly, although fee income increased thanks to higher lending activity and stronger **wealth management** sales. Trading income moderated following an exceptionally strong comparative performance in the previous year.

Operating expenses increased to €65.9 million, largely driven by €7.3 million in notable items, including accelerated software amortisation and staff-related payments linked to the industrial dispute with the Malta Union of Bank Employees (MUBE).

The bank also benefited from a €6.5 million release of expected credit losses, supported by the recovery of a long-standing non-performing corporate loan and improved credit quality within its retail portfolio.

Despite continuing geopolitical uncertainty globally, HSBC noted that Malta’s domestic economy remained resilient.

Lending growth continues

The bank continued expanding lending across both retail and corporate segments despite heightened competition.

Retail lending increased by 27 per cent during the first half of the year compared with the same period in 2025, while new corporate lending surged by 75 per cent.

Business financing remained particularly strong across hospitality, real estate, retail and manufacturing, with HSBC indicating that a healthy lending pipeline is expected to support further growth over the coming months.

Although total customer loans declined marginally to €2.7 billion due to repayments and portfolio optimisation, the quality of the loan book continued improving.

Non-performing loans fell by six per cent and now stand at their lowest level in recent years.

Customer deposits remained broadly stable at €6.2 billion, with retail deposits increasing despite seasonal reductions in corporate balances.

Strong capital position

Perhaps the bank’s strongest message was its continued financial resilience.

HSBC Malta reported a Common Equity Tier 1 capital ratio of 24.7 per cent and a total capital ratio of 27.8 per cent as at 30 June 2026, comfortably exceeding regulatory requirements.

Liquidity also remained exceptionally strong, providing the bank with significant capacity to continue supporting customers while navigating the ownership transition.

Reflecting this strength, the Board declared another quarterly interim dividend of €0.043 gross per share, amounting to €15.5 million.

Combined with the firstquarter dividend of €0.036 per share, shareholders will receive total gross dividends of €0.079 per share for the first half of 2026, equivalent to €28.5 million.

The latest payment represents a 60 per cent payout of adjusted profits after accounting for employee benefit expenses related to the industrial dispute.

Wealth and insurance

HSBC Malta also continued strengthening its **wealth management** and insurance businesses.

Wealth investment sales recorded double-digit growth year-on-year as customers increasingly sought long-term savings and investment products.

During April, the bank introduced eight additional Target Dated Funds to its HSBC Life pension platform, expanding retirement planning options for customers.

HSBC Life Assurance (Malta) reported profit before tax of €1.9 million compared with €6.5 million during the same period last year, reflecting more challenging market conditions and movements in financial markets.

Nevertheless, the insurer maintained a strong solvency ratio of 252 per cent while continuing to generate new business across protection and long-term savings products.

Continuing investment

Alongside financial performance, HSBC Malta continued investing in customer service and infrastructure.

The refurbishment of its Rabat branch was completed during the first half of the year, while modernisation works have commenced at the Gżira branch.

The bank also maintained investment in digital services, customer support and credit processing, while continuing marketing initiatives focused on lending, **wealth management** and insurance solutions.

Within corporate banking, HSBC renewed its Gold Sponsorship Agreement with The Malta Chamber of Commerce, Enterprise and Industry, reaffirming its support for Malta's business community.

Earlier this year, HSBC Malta was also recognised with the Environment and Resources Authority's Corporate Award for Environmental Innovation and Sustainability for the €30 million sustainable redevelopment of its Qormi headquarters.

Looking ahead

As HSBC Malta prepares for its next chapter under CrediaBank ownership, management believes the bank is entering the transition from a position of considerable financial strength.

"Our adjusted profit, strong capital and liquidity ratios, growing transaction volumes and continued momentum across customer acquisition and lending leave us well positioned for the future," Fichte said.

With regulatory approval expected later this year and completion targeted for the second quarter of 2027, HSBC Malta says its immediate priorities remain unchanged: supporting its 180,000 customers, maintaining business growth and ensuring a smooth transition for employees, customers and shareholders alike.

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Former DBS Private Bank team head resurfaces at J Safra Sarasin

Priyanka Boghani

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Former DBS Private Bank non-resident Indian (NRI) team head has resurfaced at a new shop, Citywire Asia can reveal.

Shruti Garg has joined J Safra Sarasin as a managing director, client advisory, according to her latest LinkedIn update. She continues to be based in Hong Kong.

Garg worked at DBS for over a decade. Prior to that role, she was at UBS Global **Wealth Management**, Bank of Singapore, ABN Amro Private Banking and Standard Chartered India.

J Safra Sarasin has been quietly [building](#) its presence in the region, having doubled its RM headcount in the region in the past year and with aims to lift its AUM from \$25bn.

The Swiss-Brazilian private bank's Asia RM ranks grew to around 85 in 2025, up from roughly half that a year earlier, according to people familiar with the matter.

The bank's Asia CEO and member of the bank's executive committee Andy Chai alluded to this growth in a June 2025 statement when the bank announced Hsu's hire.

The NRI market in Hong Kong continues to hold a shallow talent pool, with many relocating to Singapore or Dubai to cover the segment. The banks that still operate in the city have capitalised on the next generation opportunity.

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Hires and Fires Asia-Pacific

Kotak's investment banking arm names co-CEOs; DBS Group names India **wealth head**

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Market Intelligence News

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S&P Global Market Intelligence presents a roundup of senior management and board changes at Asia-Pacific financial institutions, excluding insurance, announced between July 30 and Aug. 5.

– Kotak Mahindra Bank Ltd.'s investment banking arm, Kotak Investment Banking, appointed V Jayasankar and Sourav Mallik co-CEOs, The Economic Times reported. Ramesh Srinivasan will become nonexecutive vice chairman, effective Aug. 1.

– DBS Group Holdings Ltd. named Nitin Chengappa head of its **wealth management** business in India, Bloomberg News reported, citing sources. DBS Bank India Ltd. confirmed that Chengappa, a former banker at UK-based Standard Chartered PLC, joined DBS in July as a managing director and head of Treasures business and **wealth management**.

– DBS Group Holdings appointed Jonathan Larsen to the boards of both the group and DBS Bank Ltd., effective Aug. 3. Larsen was most recently chief innovation officer at Ping An Group and chairman and CEO of the Ping An Global Voyager Fund.

– National Australia Bank Ltd. appointed Anna Bligh to its board, effective Sept. 1. Bligh has formerly served as Queensland's premier, treasurer, and finance minister, and spent eight years as the CEO of the Australian Banking Association.

– Bank of Singapore Ltd. appointed Yatish Aron team head of its global South Asia unit, the Global Private Banker reported. Aron is joining the company from HSBC Private Bank in Singapore, where he was managing director and senior relationship manager for the Global India segment. Aron is set to begin his new position on Oct. 12.

– Union Bank of the Philippines said Caesar Antonino Ordoñez Jr., investment head of private banking, resigned for personal reasons, effective Aug. 13. Meanwhile, John Edrian Atendido, planning and capital management division head, and Sandy Estrella, as AML financial intelligence team lead, also stepped down, effective Aug. 1.

– Hong Kong Exchanges and Clearing Ltd. appointed Michael Ho managing director and head of group strategy, effective Sept. 1. The exchange operator also named Kevin Rumjahn managing director, head of the CEO Office and head of strategic relations.

– Asian Development Bank named Qingfeng Zhang country director for Bangladesh, effective July 30.

– The Reserve Bank of India appointed Monisha Chakraborty executive director, effective Aug. 3. Chakraborty will oversee the foreign exchange and financial markets regulation departments, effective Aug. 3.

– The Securities and Exchange Board of India appointed Prasanta Mahapatra as an executive director, responsible for overseeing the corporation finance investigation department as well as the recovery and refund department.

– Pan Asia Banking Corp. PLC Chairman Mahawaduge Yasalal Aravinda Perera retired Aug. 2 after completing his term as a director of the bank for nine years. Wijesundera Mudiyanseelage Ayodhya Iddawela Perera was named deputy chairperson, effective Aug. 3.

– Muthoot Finance Ltd.'s board recommended the appointment of Alexander George as managing director, effective Oct. 1, subject to the approval of the company's shareholders.

- Utkarsh Small Finance Bank Ltd. appointed Anjani Srivastava a nonexecutive nonindependent director for five years, effective May 9.
- Pune E - Stock Broking Ltd. accepted the resignation of Madanlal Shantilal Jain as an independent director. Viral Patel was named an additional nonexecutive independent director for five years. Both appointments took effect Aug. 5.
- The Australian **Wealth** Advisors Group Ltd. announced the resignation of Mark Stephen as a director, effective July 31. Chris Kelaher was appointed to the company's board on May 4.
- Aryaman Capital Markets Ltd. appointed Ronak Jain as additional nonexecutive independent director for a five-year term, effective July 31. Darshit Parikh completed his second consecutive term as a nonexecutive nonindependent director on July 31.
- Community Bank Bangladesh Ltd. has appointed Mohammed Emtiaz Uddin as managing director, effective August 3, The Financial Express reported. He was previously deputy managing director and chief business officer at Padma Bank PLC.
- National Credit and Commerce Bank PLC promoted its deputy managing director, Zakir Anam, to additional managing director, effective Aug. 3, The Business Standard reported.
- Union Bank of Colombo PLC's board appointed Anil Keshary Shah a nonindependent nonexecutive director, effective Aug. 3. The appointment was approved by the Central Bank of Sri Lanka.
- UB Finance PLC appointed Lathika Sampath Weerasinghe a nonexecutive nonindependent director. The appointment will take effect upon receipt of approval from the Central Bank of Sri Lanka.
- PMF Finance PLC said its board appointed Wasala Dugganna Ralalage Sirimevan Bandara Wasala a nonexecutive independent director, effective Aug. 5. The appointment was approved by the Central Bank of Sri Lanka.
- Bajaj Finance Ltd. said the term of Rajiv Bajaj as a nonexecutive director of the company ended July 30. Bajaj did not renew his appointment due to increased professional commitments and responsibilities at Bajaj Auto Ltd.

Document MKTINWS020260806em86000gr

Times Prime partners with HSBC India to Curate Exclusive Dining and Lifestyle Benefits for the New HSBC Live+ VISA Infinite Credit Card

Odisha Diary Bureau

733 words

6 August 2026

Orissa Diary

HTORIS

English

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Bhubaneswar, Aug. 6 -- The experiential IP termed, "Dine with Times Prime" is a platform that brings cardholders chef-curated dining experiences across India, Singapore, Thailand, and Dubai, alongside premium lifestyle privileges

Mumbai, [6 August 2026] - Times Prime, India's leading premium lifestyle membership platform, has partnered with HSBC India to power the dining and lifestyle proposition of the newly launched HSBC Live+ Visa Infinite Credit Card. The collaboration marks another milestone in Times Prime's growing portfolio of premium financial institution partnerships, bringing its signature experiential ecosystem to a discerning audience that values meaningful experiences over transactional rewards. The card was launched with pomp and glamour at Fairmount Mumbai and a special appearance by actress Disha Patani and an extraordinary culinary showcase hosted by acclaimed celebrity chefs and former MasterChef Australia judges George Calombaris and Gary Mehigan. Guests experienced a thoughtfully curated multi-course menu that celebrated innovation, craftsmanship and storytelling through food, perfectly reflecting the partnership's vision of creating memorable, access-led experiences that go beyond the ordinary.

Times Prime is sought out by its members for its unique experiences such as Gourmet Table (fine-dining experience), Purple Carpet (movie premiere experience), Sip & Stir (Cocktail workshops) and many more. Through this partnership, HSBC Live+ Visa Infinite cardholders gain access to Dine with Times Prime, an invitation-led B2B platform curated to give premium audiences access to India's most celebrated restaurants. The offering moves beyond conventional discount-led dining benefits to deliver a curated, editorial approach to fine dining - featuring chef-curated menus, complimentary welcome drinks or desserts, and premium dining experiences.

Cardholders will enjoy privileged access to a portfolio of marquee restaurant partners, including Indian Accent, Lavonne Academy & Cafe, Olive Bar & Kitchen, Comorin, ITC Hotels, and TresInd, among others, spanning India's key metros as well as international dining destinations in Singapore, Thailand, and Dubai.

The dining experiences have been thoughtfully curated across three distinct collections to suit every occasion:

Discovery - Casual premium dining, all-day dining, and neighbourhood favourites

Signature - Chef-led restaurants, destination dining, and award-winning independent brands

Icon - Luxury hotel signatures and nationally acclaimed culinary destinations

In addition to dining privileges, cardholders will enjoy a curated set of lifestyle benefits, including a complimentary Sony LIV subscription and exclusive offers from marquee brands such as Uber, Toni&Guy, and TUMI - reinforcing the card's positioning as a comprehensive premium lifestyle companion.

Commenting on the partnership, Sandeep Batra, Head, International **Wealth** and Premier Banking, HSBC India, said, "The HSBC Live+ Visa Infinite Credit Card demonstrates our commitment to continuously enhance the overall experience of our customers' distinct needs across segments. Designed to cater to the dynamic lifestyle of our customers, the credit card aims to reward every single transaction, ensuring they enjoy more value in every transaction. The card allows customers to enjoy delightful culinary experiences, enhanced benefits on hotels, travel, lifestyle and shopping. We encourage our customers to take advantage of this offer and maximize their benefits with their everyday spends."

Harshita Singh, Business Head, Times Prime, said: "Dining today is as much about the experience as the meal itself. Through Dine with Times Prime, we've partnered with some of India's finest restaurants to offer members curated dining experiences beyond discounts. Our collaboration with HSBC brings this philosophy to a premium banking audience while reinforcing Times Prime's role in creating differentiated card propositions for leading financial institutions."

Suresh Sethi, Group Country Manager, India and South Asia, Visa, said, "Affluence in India is evolving from ownership to experience-led living, with consumers seeking access, recognition and moments that feel personal, seamless and memorable. Dining stands out strongly in this shift - it is where lifestyle, culture and celebration come together. The coming together of HSBC Live+, Visa Infinite and Times Prime is a natural progression in this direction, combining HSBC's customer insight, Visa Infinite's global platform of premium access and trust, and Times Prime's curated dining ecosystem, offering a proposition that brings alive the bespoke life desired by today's discerning consumers."

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MINT, Companies

Standard Chartered gets IFSCA approval to launch **wealth products from GIFT City**

Samriddhi Mahar

486 words

6 August 2026

Mint

HNMINI

English

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Mumbai, Aug. 6 -- Standard Chartered has received in-principle approval from the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) to distribute capital market products from GIFT City, the bank said in a statement on Thursday.

The approval will allow the lender to launch its **wealth management** business from GIFT City, with retail services expected to begin over the next few months.

Standard Chartered was the first foreign bank to start operations in GIFT City in 2020. It currently offers lending, trade finance, transaction banking and financial markets products to corporate and institutional clients from the international financial centre.

P.D. Singh, chief executive for India and South Asia at Standard Chartered, said the bank serves more than 600 clients in GIFT City, including multinational companies, domestic corporates, financial institutions and small businesses. It has financed more than \$25 billion through its GIFT City operations.

"We have the largest client base amongst foreign banks in GIFT City," Singh said, adding that the bank also holds around half of the regional treasury centre market there and is seeing "growing interest in GIFT City as a financial gateway to India" from clients and investors globally.

The approval comes as GIFT City's banking ecosystem continues to expand. The centre now hosts 37 banks, including 20 foreign lenders, while banking assets have grown more than sevenfold since 2020 to exceed \$106 billion. Standard Chartered's **wealth** offering is among the first by a foreign bank to extend beyond wholesale banking into products aimed at individual investors.

The move also coincides with rapid growth in India's **wealth management** industry. Deloitte estimates assets under management will nearly double from about \$1.1 trillion in FY24 to \$2.3 trillion by FY29, driven by rising financial **wealth** and increasing participation in financial assets.

Over the past two years, Standard Chartered has expanded its GIFT City operations by building one of the largest on-ground teams among foreign banks and adding services such as corporate treasury management and foreign currency settlement.

The bank has operated in India for more than 165 years and has a presence across corporate, investment, retail and **wealth** banking.

GIFT IFSC entities are eligible for a 100% tax holiday for 10 consecutive years within their first 15 years of operation, along with exemptions on capital gains and interest income for non-residents, under a regulatory regime run by IFSCA as a single unified regulator rather than the multi-agency oversight of Reserve Bank of India (RBI), Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) and Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai) on the mainland, making it an attractive base for foreign banks.

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Document HNMINI0020260806em86002e8

Singapore
Daily Debrief: What Happened Today (Aug 6)

Navene Elangovan
333 words
6 August 2026
Business Times Singapore

STBT

online

English

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Stories you might have missed

DBS raises 2026 guidance as **wealth** business powers growth despite lower rates

[SINGAPORE] DBS has raised its full-year guidance after record earnings in the first half, betting that strong momentum in **wealth management** and other fee-generating businesses will help offset pressure from lower interest rates.

StarHub to take MyRepublic's 4G customers on its network under expanded agreement

[SINGAPORE] StarHub and MyRepublic have expanded their partnership in the mobile segment by moving all subscribers of MyRepublic Mobile onto StarHub's network.

Singapore's global talent visa holders grew to 8,500 in 2025: MOM

[SINGAPORE] Holders of a visa for top global talent have more than doubled in number since the Overseas Networks and Expertise Pass (One Pass) was unveiled in 2023, numbers from Acting Manpower Minister Jasmin Lau showed on Wednesday (Aug 5).

CGSI Securities Singapore launches first active ETF tracking SGX's small and mid-cap stocks

[SINGAPORE] CGS International (CGSI) Securities Singapore is launching the first active exchange-traded fund that tracks the performance of small and mid-cap counters on the Singapore Exchange (SGX). Called the CGS Fullgoal Singapore Next 50 Active ETF, it is benchmarked to the iEdge Singapore Next 50 Index, which tracks the performance of the next 50 largest SGX mainboard-listed companies beyond the 30 largest stocks.

Venture Q2 net profit up 10.3% at S\$63 million, increases interim dividend

[SINGAPORE] Technology solutions provider Venture Corp posted a 10.3 per cent increase in net profit to S\$63 million for its second quarter ended Jun 30, up from S\$57.1 million in the year-ago period.

DBS names seven 'deep-value' stock picks to ride Singapore's value-unlocking theme

[SINGAPORE] DBS Group Research expects Singapore equities' value-unlocking theme to gain renewed traction, supported by catalysts such as the S\$5 billion Equity Market Development Programme introduced in 2025.

navene@sph.com.sg

Document STBT000020260806em86001jl

DBS second-quarter net profit up 9% to record SGD 3.08 billion as quarterly total income crosses SGD 6 billion for first time

Distributed by Contify.com

1,617 words

6 August 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* Total income crosses SGD 6 billion for first time.

* Assets under management in **Wealth** segment surpass SGD 500 billion.

* ROE at 17.5% despite challenging rate environment.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Hong Kong, Indonesia, India, China, Taiwan, Regional, Aug. 6 -- DBS Bank Ltd issued the following news release:

- First-half total income and net profit reach new highs; ROE at 17.5%

DBS Group achieved record net profit of SGD 3.08 billion for second-quarter 2026, 9% higher than a year ago. Total income rose 6% to a new high of SGD 6.09 billion despite a challenging rate environment, driven by higher non-interest income, reflecting structural growth of the customer franchise. Fee income remained near record levels and treasury customer sales reached a new high as **wealth management** momentum was sustained, with assets under management in the **Wealth** segment surpassing SGD 500 billion for the first time. Markets trading income also strengthened. Group net interest income fell slightly due to lower interest rates, with strong loan and deposit growth as well as proactive hedging mitigating most of the impact. The cost-income ratio was 39%. Compared to the previous quarter, total income rose 2% and net profit increased 5%.

For the first half, total income and net profit rose 3% and 5% respectively to new highs of SGD 12.0 billion and SGD 6.01 billion respectively. Lower interest rates were partially offset by hedging and balance sheet growth. Fee income and treasury customer sales reached new highs, led by **wealth management**, while markets trading income was also higher. The cost-income ratio was 39%. Return on equity was 17.5%, while return on tangible equity was 19.2%.

Asset quality continued to be resilient with the non-performing loan ratio at 1.0% and specific allowances at 16 basis points of loans for the second quarter and 15 basis points of loans for the first half.

Second quarter 2026 vs. second quarter 2025

Group net interest income declined 2% to SGD 3.58 billion due to lower interest rates, with strong loan and deposit growth as well as proactive hedging mitigating most of the impact. Group net interest margin fell 18 basis points to 1.87%.

Loans rose 8% or SGD 35 billion in constant-currency terms to SGD 469 billion led by broad-based growth in lending to large corporates. Deposits increased 11% or SGD 61 billion in constant-currency terms to SGD 638 billion, with Casa balances accounting for about three-quarters of the increase.

Net fee income rose 25% to SGD 1.46 billion, the second-highest quarterly level on record. The increase was largely due to **wealth management** fees, which grew 42% to a record SGD 919 million from higher customer investment activity, while **Wealth** segment assets under management rose 16% in constant-currency terms to SGD 516 billion.

Commercial book other non-interest income increased 30% to a record SGD 681 million driven by treasury customer sales to both **wealth management** and corporate customers.

Markets trading income rose 12% to SGD 469 million, benefiting from volatile markets and lower funding costs.

Expenses increased 3% to SGD 2.35 billion, while the cost-income ratio improved slightly to 39%.

Second quarter 2026 vs. first quarter 2026

Group net interest income rose 2% as balance sheet growth more than offset a two-basis-point decline in net interest margin. Loans grew 3% or SGD 15 billion in constant-currency terms, led by non-trade corporate loans, while deposits rose 1% or SGD 7 billion.

Net fee income eased 1% from the record previous quarter. **Wealth management** momentum remained robust, with **wealth** fees reaching a new high. Investment banking fees were also higher. These increases largely offset lower loan-related fees.

Commercial book other non-interest income rose 13% to a new high driven by treasury customer sales. Markets trading income increased 21% driven by equity derivatives and credit activities.

Expenses rose 2% and the cost-income ratio was stable.

First half 2026 vs. first half 2025

Group net interest income declined 3% to SGD 7.08 billion as the impact of lower interest rates was cushioned by hedging and balance sheet growth. Group net interest margin narrowed 20 basis points to 1.88%.

Over the first six months, loans grew 5% or SGD 24 billion and deposits increased 4% or SGD 26 billion in constant-currency terms.

Net fee income rose 20% to a new high of SGD 2.94 billion. The increase was led by **wealth management** fees, which reached a record SGD 1.83 billion on higher investment product and bancassurance sales. Transaction services fees also reached a new high, while investment banking and card fees increased. These more than offset lower loan-related fees.

Commercial book other non-interest income grew 20% to a record SGD 1.28 billion, driven by treasury customer sales to both **wealth management** and corporate customers. Markets trading income increased 10% to SGD 858 million, benefitting from volatile markets and lower funding costs.

Expenses rose 4% to SGD 4.65 billion, while the cost-income ratio was stable at 39%.

Business unit performance

For the first half, Consumer Banking / **Wealth Management** income rose 5% to SGD 5.52 billion, underpinned by healthy net new money inflows and stronger investment product and bancassurance sales. The gains were partially offset by the impact of lower interest rates on deposit income.

Institutional Banking income rose 1% to SGD 4.54 billion as growth in transaction service fees, investment banking fees and treasury customer sales was moderated by lower net interest income.

Markets Trading delivered its strongest performance in five years, with income of SGD 858 million.

Balance sheet

Asset quality remained resilient. Non-performing assets were little changed from the previous quarter at SGD 4.76 billion as new non-performing asset formation was offset by repayments and write-offs. The non-performing loan ratio was stable at 1.0%.

Specific allowances were SGD 188 million or 16 basis points of loans for the second quarter, bringing the first-half total to SGD 345 million or 15 basis points. Allowance coverage stood at 130% and at 196% after considering collateral.

Liquidity continued to be ample. The liquidity coverage ratio of 142% and the net stable funding ratio of 113% were both well above regulatory requirements of 100%.

The reported Common Equity Tier-1 ratio was 16.6% based on transitional arrangements, while the pro-forma ratio on a fully phased-in basis was 14.6%. The leverage ratio of 5.8% was well above the regulatory minimum of 3%.

The Board declared an ordinary dividend of SGD 66 cents per share and a Capital Return dividend of SGD 15 cents per share for the second quarter, bringing the first-half amounts to SGD 132 cents per share and SGD 30 cents per share respectively.

DBS CEO Tan Su Shan said, "We delivered a strong set of results for the first half, anchored by the strength of our **wealth management** franchise, which drove **Wealth** segment AUM past the half-trillion mark for the first time. Record total income and net profit as well as a return on equity of 17.5% reflect proactive balance sheet management in navigating a challenging interest rate environment, our ability to capture structural growth in **wealth management** and institutional banking, and strong execution in markets trading.

"We also completed our inaugural synthetic securitisation transaction, the first by a Singapore-headquartered bank, expanding our capital management toolkit and enhancing our capacity to support customer financing needs.

"While the macroeconomic environment continues to evolve, our strong balance sheet, sound asset quality, healthy allowance reserves and capital position leave us well placed to capture growth opportunities and continue delivering sustainable shareholder returns."

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named "World's Best AI Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Digital Bank" by Euromoney and the winner of multiple digital assets awards. In addition, DBS has been accorded the "Safest Bank in Asia" award by Global Finance for 17 consecutive years from 2009 to 2025.

DBS provides a full range of services in Consumer, **Wealth**, SME and corporate banking. As a bank born and bred in Asia, DBS understands the intricacies of doing business in the region's most dynamic markets.

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by uplifting lives and livelihoods of those in need. It provides essential needs to the underprivileged, and fosters inclusion by equipping the underserved with financial and digital literacy skills. It also nurtures innovative social enterprises that create positive impact.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

[Category: Asset and **Wealth Management**, Investment Banking, Financial Performance]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd

Document ATINBK0020260806em860005o

Top Stories

UOB to sell asset management arm to Allianz Global Investors for S\$555m

Shikhar Gupta, and Tan Nai Lun

757 words

6 August 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

print

A1

English

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UOB is exiting the fund manufacturing business, selling its asset management arm to Allianz Global Investors (AllianzGI) for S\$555 million as it moves towards an open-architecture **wealth** model focused on advisory and product distribution.

Excluding one-off transaction costs, the sale is set to generate a pre-tax gain of about S\$330 million and raise Common Equity Tier 1 capital ratio by around 14 basis points, the bank said on Wednesday (Aug 5).

This shift comes as UOB lags behind the other two Singapore lenders in growing its **wealth management** business, said analysts.

Rena Kwok, senior credit analyst at Bloomberg Intelligence, noted that the deal enables UOB to monetise a non-core asset.

“(The move will) allow the bank to pivot towards a more capital-light, lower-risk **wealth** distribution model across its Asean footprint, permitting revenue diversification,” she said.

A core component of the deal is a “long-term strategic distribution partnership”, which allows UOB to offer its clients access to AllianzGI’s global product suite alongside an expanded, curated range of investment solutions.

CGS International Securities Singapore analyst Tay Wee Kuang highlighted that UOB’s management previously said they wanted to work with partners to offer more investment solutions.

The move should allow the lender to collaborate with other investment managers to offer a wider range of products, while going lighter on the balance sheet, he said.

The bank has operated UOB Asset Management for four decades. By shedding its in-house product manufacturing, the lender said it intends to focus strictly on **wealth** advisory and distribution.

The acquisition by AllianzGI covers the UOB Asset Management franchise across Singapore, Brunei, Indonesia, Japan, Malaysia, Taiwan, Thailand and Vietnam, with around S\$42 billion of assets under management (AUM) as at Dec 31, 2025.

UOB CEO and deputy chairman Wee Ee Cheong said the partnership sharpens the bank’s focus on **wealth** advisory, as the investment needs of its regional clients become increasingly diverse and sophisticated.

Enhancing long-term shareholder value

Combining UOB’s advisory relationships with AllianzGI’s investment capabilities will let the bank accelerate **wealth management** growth while enhancing long-term shareholder value, he noted.

For the buyer, the acquisition doubles AllianzGI’s AUM in Singapore, and brings the assets it manages for clients in the Asia-Pacific to more than 170 billion euros (US\$196.1 billion).

In a separate statement, AllianzGI said the move would grant it access to “a number of important high-growth markets”, and scale its business in markets where it has an established presence.

The purchase price includes excess cash and the distribution agreement, it added.

Based on unaudited pro forma consolidated figures from end-2025, the net asset value attributable to the sold stake was S\$223 million.

All 500 existing UOB Asset Management employees will transition to AllianzGI, which has formally committed to maintaining their employment.

The transaction is expected to close in 2027.

Jayden Vantarakis, head of Asean equity research at Macquarie Capital, noted that this is the second asset disposal announced by UOB this year, with the earlier transaction offloading interests in two commercial real estate sites.

Assuming these flow through to earnings, the transactions could add around 0.3 per cent to 2026's dividend yield, he said.

Vantarakis, who has an "outperform" rating on UOB, noted that the bank could unlock further gains and capital if it continues to shed its ownership in Wee family affiliated businesses.

These include non-controlling stakes in UOB Kay Hian, UOL and Haw Par, and a controlling stake in UOI.

"We await further details on how UOB will reinvest the proceeds from these corporate actions into hiring more **wealth** relationship managers and build out the franchise," Vantarakis said. "It is likely a multi-year endeavour."

Allianz in July also agreed to buy HSBC's life and health insurance business in Singapore for S\$2.7 billion. This was part of a broader S\$2.9 billion deal that includes an exclusive distribution arrangement.

That deal came about two years after its previous attempt to significantly expand its local footprint ended in controversy.

In late 2024, the German insurance giant's S\$2.2 billion bid for a 51 per cent controlling stake in home-grown Income Insurance fell through.

Shares of UOB finished Wednesday 0.4 per cent or S\$0.19 lower at S\$43.06.

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Document STBT000020260806em860000e

DBS Group Holdings Ltd

MarketLine Company Profiles, 5 August 2026, 11342 words, (English)

DBS Group Holdings LtdDBS Group Holdings Ltd (DBS) is an investment holding company. It primarily serving as a treasury and funding vehicle. The company's main activities include providing a range of commercial banking and financial ...

Allianz Global Investors to Acquire UOB Asset Management; UOB to Establish Strategic Distribution Partnership

731 words

5 August 2026

08:00

MarketLine News and Comment

DTMNTR

English

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UOB Group has agreed that Allianz Global Investors will acquire UOB Asset Management, and the two parties will form a long-term strategic distribution partnership.

UOB Group has entered into an agreement for Allianz Global Investors (AGI) to acquire UOB Asset Management (UOBAM). The acquisition by AGI covers the UOBAM franchise across eight Asian markets – Singapore, Brunei, Indonesia, Japan, Malaysia, Taiwan region, Thailand and Vietnam. As part of the agreement, UOB and AGI will establish a long-term strategic distribution partnership that strengthens UOB's role as an open-architecture **wealth** distributor, expands the investment solutions available to customers, and reinforces the Bank's advisory-led approach to helping customers grow and preserve **wealth** over time.

Through the strategic partnership, UOB will work with AGI to curate a broader suite of investment products and solutions for the Bank's regional customer base of more than 8 million. The partnership builds on UOB's open-architecture strategy, enabling the Bank to draw from a wide universe of investment capabilities while remaining focused on advice, suitability and long-term customer outcomes. It also supports UOB's **wealth** growth ambitions by broadening customers' choice and offering diversified solutions aligned with their investment profiles, life stages and financial goals.

Subject to the requisite regulatory approvals in all applicable markets, the deal is expected to be completed in 2027. UOBAM and AGI are committed to ensuring continuity and a smooth transition for all customers and employees. As part of the agreement, all 500 existing UOBAM employees across the region will transition to AGI, which pledges to maintain and continue their employment, while offering employees opportunities to be part of a larger global investment platform. During this transition period, UOBAM's operations will continue as usual. Customers can continue to access, invest in and redeem their UOBAM funds as usual, with no disruption to service.

Excluding one-off transaction costs, the deal, priced at S\$555 million, is expected to generate a pre-tax gain of approximately S\$330 million and increase the Group's CET1 ratio by an estimated 14 basis points. The transaction forms part of the Group's ongoing efforts to execute on its strategic priorities. By crystallising value from its asset management business and retaining strategic collaboration through a long-term partnership, the Group will be better positioned to strengthen its **wealth management** franchise, drive sustainable earnings growth, and enhance long-term shareholder value.

UOBAM, which has been part of the UOB Group for 40 years, has grown into a leading regional asset management franchise with operations across Asia. As of 31 December 2025, it had approximately S\$42 billion assets under management. Based on the unaudited pro forma consolidated balance sheet of UOBAM and its subsidiaries as at 31 December 2025, the net asset value attributable to the stake sold was S\$223 million.

Mr Wee Ee Cheong, Deputy Chairman and Chief Executive Officer, UOB, said, "UOB serves more than 8 million customers across ASEAN, whose **wealth** and investment needs are becoming increasingly diverse and sophisticated. This partnership sharpens our focus on **wealth** advisory and distribution. By combining UOB's advisory expertise and customer relationships with Allianz Global Investors' investment capabilities, we are well positioned to meet our customers' evolving needs and support their long-term **wealth** goals. This also enables us to accelerate **wealth management** growth while enhancing long-term shareholder value. During the transition period, maintaining continuity for customers and employees is our priority. We thank UOBAM's management team and employees for their dedication and contributions over the past four decades in building a trusted regional asset management franchise."

Mr Tobias Pross, CEO, Allianz Global Investors, said, "This transaction marks a significant milestone in Allianz Global Investors' growth journey in Asia Pacific. By bringing together UOB Asset Management's deep Southeast Asian investment expertise with our global active investment platform, we are creating a stronger business with an enhanced ability to serve clients across the region, providing them with access to an even broader range of innovative **wealth management** and retirement solutions. Importantly, today's announcement also establishes a long-term distribution agreement between Allianz Global Investors and UOB, a trusted financial institution serving millions of clients across Southeast Asia. Together, we will deepen and grow that client engagement further, through complementary capabilities and expanded market reach."

EBC20356-7EA2-4847-B627-1427F6BC085E

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AllianzGI agrees to buy €28bn Singaporean AM

Joseph Eden

246 words

5 August 2026

Citywire

CWIRE

English

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Allianz Global Investors (AllianzGI) has agreed to acquire UOB Asset Management (UOBAM) from Singapore-headquartered UOB group for SGD 555m (€376m), in a bid to expand its presence in southeast Asia.

Once completed, the transaction will push AllianzGI's Asia-Pacific assets under management (AUM) past €170bn and double the German manager's assets in Singapore. The deal is expected to close in 2027, pending regulatory approvals.

The purchase price includes excess cash and a long-term distribution agreement, granting AllianzGI access to UOB's retail network across ASEAN markets, where the bank operates approximately 400 branches serving eight million customers.

UOBAM brings €28bn in AUM and a footprint across eight Asian markets: Singapore, Brunei, Thailand, Malaysia, Indonesia, Taiwan, Japan and Vietnam. The addition introduces Southeast Asian investment capabilities to AllianzGI's global platform, including regional and single-country equity strategies, alongside Sharia-compliant offerings.

'UOBAM is one of Southeast Asia's leading asset managers, with very well-regarded investment capabilities and a strong distribution network,' said Tobias Pross, CEO of AllianzGI.

'Adding their complementary Southeast Asian investment expertise to our global platform will boost our combined offering and significantly accelerate our growth in this dynamic region.'

Wee Ee Cheong, Deputy Chair and CEO of UOB, added: 'UOB serves more than eight million customers across Asean, whose **wealth** and investment needs are becoming increasingly diverse and sophisticated. This partnership sharpens our focus on **wealth** advisory and distribution.'

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coverager

Allianz to acquire UOB Asset Management unit

Coverager

232 words

5 August 2026

Coverager

CVGR

English

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Allianz Global Investors has entered into an agreement to acquire UOB Asset Management, the asset management business of Singapore-headquartered UOB Group for \$433 million.

The transaction will strengthen AllianzGI's business in Asia Pacific and will bring the assets it manages for clients in the region to more than €170 billion.

The transaction is accompanied by a long-term distribution agreement which provides long-term access to the retail client network of UOB.

UOB is the third largest bank in South-East Asia by total assets, with over 8 million clients and around 400 regional branches.

"UOBAM is one of South-East Asia's leading asset managers, with very well-regarded investment capabilities and a strong distribution network. Adding their complementary South-East Asian investment expertise to our global platform will boost our combined offering and significantly accelerate our growth in this dynamic region. Reinforcing our long-term commitment to broadening the reach of our investment offering in South-East Asia, this deal provides us with deeper market connectivity and opens new opportunities to engage with an expanded base of clients. With a strengthened regional presence, we will be able to serve an even broader range of investors, providing them with access to a wider range of innovative **wealth management** and retirement solutions that help them meet their investment objectives." – Tobias Pross, CEO of Allianz Global Investors.

Document CVGR000020260805em850002u

Celebrating Sandeep Batra: From risk desks to the corner office

e4m Staff

Distributed by Contify.com

419 words

5 August 2026

Exchange4Media.com

ATEXME

English

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HSBC India's MD and Head of **Wealth** and Personal Banking, Sandeep Batra, marks his birthday, capping a two-decade journey across Standard Chartered, Citi and HSBC

Some careers move in straight lines. Sandeep Batra's has moved in continents. On his birthday, we take a moment to trace the arc of a banker who has built consumer businesses on three different landscapes before landing at the helm of HSBC's **wealth** ambitions in India.

Batra's grounding came at Standard Chartered Bank, where he spent close to seven years working his way up from Management Associate to product and business development roles. That early runway led him to Citi, where he would stay for more than 15 years, moving through consumer risk leadership before taking charge of risk for Citi Thailand's cards and lending business. There, he built partnerships with major e-commerce and digital wallet players, a skill set that would prove valuable in an increasingly digital-first banking world. His Citi journey culminated in a high-stakes assignment as Head of Consumer Banking at Citi Russia, steering the business through a period of significant geopolitical and organisational transition.

In 2022, HSBC brought Batra on board to lead its **Wealth** and Personal Banking business in India, a market the bank has flagged as a strategic growth priority. The mandate was broad from day one: private banking, retail banking, **wealth management**, cards, mortgages, personal lending, asset management and insurance, all under one remit. In the years since, Batra has been visible at the centre of HSBC India's expansion, from the relaunch of its onshore private banking business to the opening of the bank's largest India branch, in Bengaluru's Whitefield, which he inaugurated alongside HSBC India CEO Hitendra Dave.

Batra has since taken on an even wider canvas as Head of International **Wealth** and Premier Banking at HSBC India, where his focus has turned to serving the country's growing base of globally minded, internationally invested clients. Across his public commentary, including his contribution to the India Private **Wealth Management** Outlook 2026, a throughline is visible: a conviction that Indian **wealth** clients are only getting more sophisticated, and that the banks that win will be the ones offering integrated, personalised, cross-border advice.

Close to twenty-five years into a career spanning risk, retail and **wealth** leadership across Asia, Europe and now India, Batra's story remains one of steady reinvention.

Document ATEXME0020260805em850000p

HSBC, StanChart report first-half double-digit **wealth** income growth

Cheryl Heng

708 words

5 August 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC and Standard Chartered delivered double-digit growth in **wealth** fee income in the first half of the year, as both lenders doubled down on their **wealth** pivots.

StanChart saw its **wealth** solutions income up 38% year on year in the first half of the year to a record \$2.1bn. Growth was broad based, with double digit income growth logged across its 13 markets, as well as across investment funds, capital markets and bancassurance products.

At HSBC, **wealth** fee and other income jumped 18% in the first half to \$5.5bn, propelled by strength across its Asian franchise. The bank gathered \$64bn in net new money during the period, with \$57bn originating from Asia alone.

This brought HSBC's invested assets to \$682bn at the end of first half - a 15% increase compared to the same period last year.

StanChart and HSBC reported their first-half earnings on 29 July and 4 Aug, respectively.

Commenting on the results, HSBC CEO Georges Elhedery said: 'Our unique position in **wealth management** across the client continuum from premier affluent to private banking, combined with an acceleration of our investments, will help us capture an even bigger share of the structural growth opportunity.'

HSBC now manages roughly \$1.1tn in total **wealth** balances across Asia.

In comparison, StanChart pulled in \$33bn of net new money in the first half, representing an annualised AUM growth rate of 15%. Total **wealth** AUM at the bank reached \$258bn, or \$473bn when including customer deposits.

The bank has now achieved \$84bn in affluent net new money over the last six quarters, against its \$200bn 2025 to 2028 target. Group chief executive Bill Winters noted that two-thirds of the net new money comes from international clients.

The **wealth** momentum at both banks is providing a major tailwind for overall first-half group performance, boosting pre-tax profits of \$19.5bn and \$3.4bn respectively.

Margins in focus

Standard Chartered capped the half year following a record second quarter, though analysts questioned whether **wealth** margins can be sustained.

On the bank's earnings call, James Invine, analyst at Rothschild & Co Redburn, pointed to investment product margins hovering between 1.2% and 1.5%.

Manus Costello, StanChart group CFO, said: 'I do think the current level of margin that you've seen or return on assets that you've seen in the first half... is not something that we'd encourage you to move forward.'

Winters noted that if revenue momentum slows, the bank is able to 'flex down commensurately' on associated expense.

'We would be very careful not to disincentivise, what we consider to be a best-in-class cohort on the basis of a quarter or a month's or a half a year's blip,' said Winters. 'Maybe that's the slight caveat to the perfect flexibility in the cost base that you're probing around.'

Navigating regulatory compliance

Addressing regulatory focus and compliance in China, Winters stressed that Standard Chartered remains focused on high standards of due diligence.

'We're completely focused on doing business the right way in terms of helping our Chinese clients, be onshore or offshore, to broaden out their range of investments opportunities,' said Winters.

Acknowledging increased scrutiny around trusts, he said: 'You should probably expect to see an ongoing focus around compliance - around the way trusts are established, and the motivation for those trusts and the way that they're managed.'

'We have a trust business. There's a small, I would call it, close to immaterial proportion of our AUM that is sitting in trust,' Winters added.

'We... satisfy ourselves that the client is discharging her or his appropriate responsibilities vis-a-vis different tax authorities, compliance authorities, et cetera. But it's not ultimately something we can police entirely. But we see no material or practical impact on our business.'

Beijing's recent crackdown on offshore trusts with new tax rules has closed a previously 'grey zone' and could mean a cash crunch for Chinese wealthy families.

Meanwhile, HSBC CEO Elhedery noted that the bank has not seen account openings or onboarding flows impacted during the period of May to July by additional regulatory documentation requirements.

Document CWIRAS0020260805em8500001

Stock Talk: Balfour Beatty, HSBC, SSP, Sainsbury's and Domino's

Michelle McGagh

995 words

5 August 2026

Citywire

CWIRE

English

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Balfour Beatty plc (BBY)

Key stats

Market capitalisation £4.2bn

P/E ratio 16.8

Source: Google Finance

Henderson duo back Balfour growth strategy

Henderson managers Indri van Hien and Cassie Herlihy are backing Balfour Beatty and its 'sharper focus' on growth markets.

The international contractor and infrastructure investor is the top holding in their Henderson Smaller Companies ([HSL](#)) investment trust, where it makes up 3.5% of the £606m portfolio.

It operates construction services in the UK, US and Hong Kong, support services for the maintenance of infrastructure assets such as road, rail and energy in the UK, and owns a portfolio of infrastructure investments, including military housing in the US and hospitals and student accommodation in the UK.

'The shares have performed strongly following continued positive momentum in order book growth driven by UK power generation projects and US buildings,' said the managers.

'New orders have bolstered cash generation and enabled further cash returns to shareholders through both the regular dividend and share buybacks.'

They flagged new chief executive Philip Hoare's new 'evolve, energise, and explore' strategy that suggests 'going forward sharper focus will be given to existing and new growth markets', said the pair.

Shares in Balfour Beatty were trading up 1.2% at 876p at time of writing on Tuesday and year-to-date are up 22%.

HSBC Holdings plc (HSBA)

Key stats

Market capitalisation £268.8bn

P/E ratio 17.4

Source: Google Finance

HSBC on the right course, says AJ Bell

The return of share buybacks shows HSBC is charting the right course, says AJ Bell.

The banking giant kickstarted buybacks after quarterly profits soared to \$10.1bn but the \$1bn of repurchases fell short of lofty analyst expectations, some of which hit \$2bn. HSBC shares were trading down 1.6% at £15.72 after the announcement on Tuesday.

'Buybacks are back on the menu at HSBC but rather than getting their knives and forks out ready to dine out on the shares, investors treated this offering with a shrug,' said analyst Russ Mould.

'The muted share price reaction follows an extremely strong showing so far this year as HSBC benefits from growth in areas like **wealth management** and insurance and from persistently higher interest rates.'

However, Mould said confidence was returning given some 'tweaks' to medium-term guidance and chief executive Georges Elhedery's suggestion that he has spent the first two years of his tenure building a strong group, and the next part is about putting those strengths to work.

'The return for buybacks follows the pause imposed since the bank announced a deal last year to take Hang Seng Bank private, suggesting that having steered this supertanker of a business on to the course he wants, it is now full steam ahead with Elhedery at the helm,' said Mould.

SSP Group PLC (SSPG)

Key stats
Market capitalisation £1.6bn
P/E ratio -

Source: Google Finance

SSP making operational and strategic progress, says Berenberg

SSP is simplifying its model which will 'reveal core value', according to Berenberg.

Analyst Luka Trnovsek reiterated his 'buy' recommendation and increased the target price from 230p to 245p on the food-on-the-go group, which was trading down 0.2% at 205p on Tuesday but is flat over this year.

SSP has delivered peer-leading like-for-like growth this year, which Trnovsek said has been driven by 'the strength of its M&S estate, its commercial initiatives, its 100% food and beverage exposure, and its domestically-skewed footprint'.

These factors will 'underpin a solid fourth quarter' and reiterated free cashflow guidance should open the door to 'incremental shareholder returns'.

More importantly for Trnovsek is the company's 'strategic action on European rail' and the sale of the stake in the India business, which will 'allow the company to unlock the value in its sum-of-the-parts'.

'Together, operational and strategic progress underpins our confidence looking ahead,' he said.

J Sainsbury plc (SBRY)

Key stats
Market capitalisation £7.8bn
P/E ratio 19.8

Source: Google Finance

Deutsche Bank: Sainsbury's will be more predictable without Argos

Sainsbury's sale of its Argos division will make it a more predictable business, says Deutsche Bank.

Analyst Benjamin Yokyong-Zoega retained his 'buy' recommendation and increased the target price from 360p to 390p on the supermarket giant, which was trading down 0.7% at 354p on Tuesday.

It has agreed to sell Argos for £120m to new company Swift Partners, which is significantly less than the £1.4bn it paid for the retailer a decade ago.

Yokyong-Zoega lifted his earnings per share forecasts 2% for full-year 2028/29 and his target price by 8% as it will be 'a less cyclical and more predictable business, which is our view warrants a higher price/earnings multiple'.

'We remain positive on the outlook for the core grocery business, which is underpinned by strong momentum in fresh food, further scaling of Nectar loyalty prices and retail media income, new space and re-allocation driving higher sales density,' he said.

Domino's Pizza Group PLC (DOM)

Key stats

Market capitalisation £804m

P/E ratio 13.9

Source: Google Finance

Peel Hunt predicts Domino's rerating

Momentum is building at Domino's which should rerate the shares, says Peel Hunt.

Analyst Douglas Jack reiterated his 'buy' recommendation and target price of 275p on the takeaway pizza chain, which was trading up 0.8% at 206p on Tuesday following first half results where like-for-like sales were up 5% and pre-tax profit rose 1% to £44.1m.

Jack kept his profit forecasts on hold, but upgraded 2027 profit before tax by 2% and by 3% in 2028 'to reflect the benefits of automation'.

'We believe product innovation is key to driving sales, while automation boosts margins,' he said.

'We believe they can drive a price/earnings rerating from 11 times to 15 times.'

Document CWIRE00020260805em85000e0

HSBC Holdings plc's Lending Sales Forecast To Reach \$45.71 Billion In Five Years

1,532 words

5 August 2026

The Business Research Company Reports

BRCOMR

English

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HSBC Holdings plc's Lending Sales Forecast To Reach \$45.71 Billion In Five Years

HSBC Holdings plc is a multinational banking and financial services company. The company offers retail banking, corporate banking, investment banking, mortgage loans, term loans, private banking, **wealth management**, credit cards, finance and insurance. It has around 223,770 employees and has operations in 66 countries and territories. HSBC was founded in 1865 and is headquartered in London, the UK.

This article is an analysis of HSBC Holdings plc's operations, products and services, strategies and growth prospects in the lending market.

HSBC Holdings plc's Lending Revenues Reached \$34.8 Billion In 2025

HSBC Holdings plc operates in the lending market with 0.29% share in 2025. Its products and services that align to lending market, is estimated to have generated revenues of \$34.8 billion in 2025, about 55.73% of the company's total revenues.

HSBC Holdings plc's Lending Sales Forecast To Reach \$45.71 Bn In Five Years

HSBC Holdings plc's revenues from lending market are expected to grow from \$34.8 billion to \$37.27 billion at a CAGR of 7.11% in the near term till 2026. The change in growth trend is mainly due to the companies stabilizing their output after catering to the demand that grew exponentially during the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020. However, the company is expected to gain \$10.92 billion in revenues in its lending offerings in the next five years, giving it total revenues of \$45.71 billion, according to TBRC estimates.

South America, Middle East, Western Europe, North America, And Asia Pacific Expected To Offer High Growth Opportunities

Countries in the lending market which are expected to grow particularly quickly in the next five years are Argentina, Iran, Nigeria, Italy, Canada, Chile, Mexico and UK, that will create opportunities for HSBC Holdings plc to expand in these countries.

HSBC Holdings plc's Product And Service Operations

The company operates through the following business divisions:

Wealth And Personal Banking division offers various products and services including personal banking, mortgages, credit cards, loans, savings and investments and insurance to its customers.

Commercial Banking division offers various services such as term loans, capital markets, payment services and international trade facilitation, as well as mergers and acquisitions advisory services to its corporate clients.

Global Banking And Markets division offers transaction banking, financing, advisory, capital markets and risk management services to government, corporate and institutional clients worldwide.

HSBC Holdings plc Operates In A Fragmented Market

The global lending market was worth \$12041.2 billion in 2025 accounting for 35.75% of the global financial services market in 2025.

The lending market is fragmented with large number of global players commanding significant market share. Top 5 players of the market constitute 3.54% of the market. Major players in this market include JPMorgan Chase & Co. with 0.85%, China Construction Bank Corporation with 0.75%, Agricultural Bank of China Limited with 0.73%,

Mitsubishi UFJ Financial Group, Inc. with 0.63%, State Bank of India with 0.6%, Bank of China with 0.57%, Koc Holding AS with 0.57%.

Notes

Want more information on this market or to speak to our consultants? visit TBRC.info or contact info@tbrc.info

HSBC Holdings plc's Financial Overview

The table below show the financial performance of HSBC Holdings plc during 2014 – 2025.

Year	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022
Revenue	57.397	56.079	44.566	49.676	52.013	53.342	41.612	50.48	48.135
Operating Profit	16.148	16.311	4.758	14.792	17.354	10.993	7.18	15.86	14.805
Profit For The Year	14.705	15.096	3.446	11.879	15.025	8.708	6.099	14.693	16.67

HSBC Holdings plc had revenue of \$57.40 billion for the financial year 2014, and \$64.42 billion in 2025. It had a market capitalization of \$315.59 billion as of May 2026.

HSBC Holdings plc had operating profit of \$16.15 billion for the financial year 2014, and \$28.00 billion in 2025.

HSBC Holdings plc had profit for the year of \$14.71 billion for the financial year 2014, and \$23.13 billion in 2025.

HSBC Holdings plc generated estimated revenues of \$34.8 billion in the lending market during the financial year 2020. The revenues are TBRC estimates based on the various products/services offered by the company.

Strategic Assessment

HSBC Holdings plc operates in the lending market which is forecasted to grow at 7.06%, faster than the average of the financial services sector at 7.01%, putting it within the small market share and high growth market of financial services markets, according to TBRC analysis. Small market share in a high growth market makes HSBC Holdings plc's lending business highly optimistic with numerous opportunities for growth that need a serious thought.

Notes

Lending is the act of allowing a person or organisation to use a sum of money in exchange for an agreement to repay it later, typically with interest.

Market shares are calculated based on TBRC's Global Market Model and estimates of the company's market share within the given market. Forecasts are made on the basis of market growth, on the assumption that the market share will remain stable during the forecast period.

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Research Methodology

The Business Research Company's reports are based on the methodology below.

Data

Our datasets are created using a wide range of proprietary and public sources including leading government bodies, associations, trade journals, market intelligence reports and trade magazines. Data is modelled based on hard data, extrapolation, regression analysis based on known macro data inputs, interpolation between hard figures, comparisons with other geographies and markets, price estimations, and qualitative inputs. Data is triangulated within our unique market data model covering an exhaustive list of 600+ markets across 48 countries and 7 regions. Comparable data is used for sanity check and trend analysis. For example, our global market value data is compared to unit sales and price data for the relevant market as well as relevant macro-economic datasets in order to establish validity.

Market Value

Market value is defined as the revenues earned by organizations for products and services within the specified market. The break down by geography is revenue generated within the specific industry by organizations in the specified geography, irrespective of where they are produced.

Market value and forecasts used in market share calculation and potential gain of the company is sourced from TBRC's Global Market Model.

Global Market Model (GMM)

The Global Market Model is a comprehensive database of integrated market information which covers historic, current and forecast market information. This database helps in drawing multiple conclusions, exploring market opportunities and taking effective business decisions.

Global Market Model's methodology ensures that the data is of the highest quality. It starts with high standard data sources and correlation based modelling techniques. This is supported by TBRC's market expertise and thousands of expert interviews conducted each year to verify the data.

The datasets on the global market model are created using a wide range of proprietary and public sources including leading government bodies, associations, trade journals, market intelligence reports and trade magazines. Data is modelled based on hard data, extrapolation, regression analysis based on known macro data inputs, interpolation between hard figures, comparisons with other geographies and markets, price estimations, and qualitative inputs. Data is triangulated within our unique market data model covering an exhaustive list of 600+ markets across 48 countries and 7 regions. Comparable data is used for sanity check and trend analysis. For example, our global market value data is compared to unit sales and price data for the relevant market as well as relevant macro-economic datasets in order to establish validity.

Analysis

Analysis is drawn from our Consultants' wide range of industry and research experience as well as public and proprietary sources. Consultants are trained in research techniques and ethics by the Market Research Society.

Verification Through Expert Interviews

Every year The Business Research Company carries out thousands of interviews with senior executives and industry experts across hundreds of markets. Through these interviews we develop our internal understanding of markets and geographies and cross reference our understanding of global markets with expert feedback utilizing 'Delphic' research methodologies.

Referencing

The Business Research Company prides itself on the quality and validity of its data and analysis. Our unique 'end noted' referencing approach allows the user to trace our market numbers and analysis back to the specific data sources they were derived from.

Note on Currency Conversions

All currency conversions are done on the basis of 2018 exchange rates.

Abbreviations

Currencies

\$ stands for US Dollar

Document BRCOMR0020260805em850001k

AllianzGI agrees to buy €28bn Singaporean AM

Joseph Eden

246 words

5 August 2026

Citywire

CWIRE

English

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Allianz Global Investors (AllianzGI) has agreed to acquire UOB Asset Management (UOBAM) from Singapore-headquartered UOB group for SGD 555m (€376m), in a bid to expand its presence in southeast Asia.

Once completed, the transaction will push AllianzGI's Asia-Pacific assets under management (AUM) past €170bn and double the German manager's assets in Singapore. The deal is expected to close in 2027, pending regulatory approvals.

The purchase price includes excess cash and a long-term distribution agreement, granting AllianzGI access to UOB's retail network across ASEAN markets, where the bank operates approximately 400 branches serving eight million customers.

UOBAM brings €28bn in AUM and a footprint across eight Asian markets: Singapore, Brunei, Thailand, Malaysia, Indonesia, Taiwan, Japan and Vietnam. The addition introduces Southeast Asian investment capabilities to AllianzGI's global platform, including regional and single-country equity strategies, alongside Sharia-compliant offerings.

'UOBAM is one of Southeast Asia's leading asset managers, with very well-regarded investment capabilities and a strong distribution network,' said Tobias Pross, CEO of AllianzGI.

'Adding their complementary Southeast Asian investment expertise to our global platform will boost our combined offering and significantly accelerate our growth in this dynamic region.'

Wee Ee Cheong, Deputy Chair and CEO of UOB, added: 'UOB serves more than eight million customers across Asean, whose **wealth** and investment needs are becoming increasingly diverse and sophisticated. This partnership sharpens our focus on **wealth** advisory and distribution.'

Document CWIRE00020260805em85000b6

Time to take profits on HSBC, says Shore Capital

Michele Maatouk / redaccion@vortexmedia.es

248 words

5 August 2026

19:12

Sharecast

SHAREC

English

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Shore Capital said on Wednesday that it was time to take profits on HSBC as it downgraded its stance on the bank to 'sell' from 'under review'.

The broker noted that HSBC delivered a stronger-than-expected Q2 result, with both income and profitability ahead of consensus, driven by continued strength in **Wealth** and Wholesale Transaction Banking fee income.

"Management modestly upgraded Banking NII guidance and announced additional simplification savings, prompting us to increase our FY26F-FY28F earnings forecasts by 4-6% and raise our target price to 1,335p (from 1,250p)," said analyst Gary Greenwood.

"However, while the outlook remains positive, we believe this is more than reflected in the current valuation. With the shares having rallied strongly since our upgrade to 'hold' following the Q1 results in May, our revised target price implies 16% downside, and we therefore downgrade our recommendation...and suggest investors take profits."

Greenwood noted the shares currently trade on around 2.3x end-Q2 TNAV of \$9.36 (or 699p), which appears "excessive" relative to management's medium-term return on tangible equity target of 17%+ and Shore's assessment of sustainable returns.

"While HSBC remains a high-quality franchise, we see better value elsewhere in the sector, particularly among UK small and mid-cap banks trading at or below tangible book value," he added.

At 1110 BST, the shares were down 3.4% at 1,530.20p.

Document SHAREC0020260805em85001e1

Scottish Daily Mail

News

Don't raid our banks, HSBC tells Burnham

Patrick Tooher

514 words

5 August 2026

Scottish Daily Mail

SCODAM

1; Scotland

53

English

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Boss warns windfall tax will hit growth

THE boss of Britain's biggest quoted company has urged Andy Burnham not to impose a windfall tax on banks.

HSBC chief executive Georges Elhedery warned the Prime Minister that the economy would be hit if the banking sector faced the extra levy that some campaigners have demanded.

'Growth requires strong banks,' Elhedery said as he unveiled a 23pc rise in profits to £14.5bn in the first half of the year, helped by 'strong growth' in HSBC's **wealth management** unit in Asia.

The bank also revealed that profits in its UK arm had grown by 7.7pc to £2.9bn.

'For growth to manifest, you need businesses to be confident and invest,' Elhedery said.

'For businesses to invest, you need them to have access to financing. And banks are the preferred financing mechanism for these businesses,' he added.

The comments echo those made by NatWest boss Paul Thwaite last week, who called for 'consistency of policies so businesses can plan'.

Banks pay a 3pc surcharge on top of the standard 25pc corporation tax rate following a cut in 2023. Restoring the levy to 8pc would raise £9bn over four years, according to the Trades Union Congress, which is pushing for higher bank taxes.

Lenders have gained from higher-for-longer interest rates that have boosted their net interest income - the difference between what they pay savers and charge borrowers.

Lebanon-born Elhedery described the economy as 'outstandingly resilient', despite 'all the challenges we've seen lately', notably the Middle East conflict, which has sent energy prices sky-rocketing.

He added: 'The UK remains a very attractive international investment hub and we continue to see foreign direct investment in the UK creating jobs, in all parts.'

Elhedery swerved suggestions that HSBC might review its commitment to its London headquarters if banks faced higher taxes, and highlighted the bank's lending across the country.

'More than 60pc of our loan portfolio is to businesses outside of London and the South East,' he said.

HSBC has substantial operations in Edinburgh, Swansea, Leeds, Sheffield and Chester, while its retail bank headquarters is in Birmingham.

But the bulk of the bank's activities are in Asia, especially in Hong Kong and China, which account for over two-thirds of its profits.

HSBC also announced that it would resume its \$1bn share buyback scheme after pausing it late last year following its takeover of Hong Kong's Hang Seng Bank.

The bank is also considering boosting its bonus pool for bankers after a cap on their bonuses was lifted.

Elhedery said the bank had exited 15 non-strategic businesses since 2025, most recently selling its Singapore insurance arm to Germany's Allianz.

HSBC shares fell yesterday by 0.8pc, or 12.8p, to 1584.6p, having risen more than 70pc in the past 12 months.

Analysts expect HSBC and the four other big UK-based banks - Lloyds, NatWest, Barclays and Standard Chartered - to rack up profits this year of more than £60bn.

Document SCODAM0020260805em85000pb

HSBC Q2 pre-tax profit surges on one-time items, higher income

Tanya Dimitrova Ivanova

327 words

5 August 2026

16:12

SeeNews Banking

SEBNK

English

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August 5 (SeeNews) - British lender HSBC Holdings Plc (LON:HSBA) saw its pre-tax profit jump by 60% on the year to USD 10.1 billion (EUR 8.75bn) in the second quarter of 2026, thanks to one-time items as well as higher interest income and fee and other income.

The bank booked restructuring costs of USD 200 million in the period under review, while the prior-year result was pushed down by impairment losses of USD 2.1 billion and restructuring costs of USD 500 million.

HSBC said its second-quarter net profit surged by 63% to USD 3.1 billion.

Revenue increased by USD 2.6 billion to USD 19.1 billion, including a year-on-year net favourable impact of USD 1.3 billion from notable items. Growth was driven by a rise in net interest income and strong growth in **Wealth** fee and other income in the IWPB and Hong Kong business segments.

At constant currency, revenue excluding notable items rose by USD 1.3 billion to USD 19 billion.

Looking ahead, HSBC expects that its net interest income will be at least USD 46 billion in 2026, while it was previously projecting a figure of around USD 46 billion. The slight revision reflects the continued favourable interest rate outlook.

At the same time, the common equity tier 1 (CET1) capital ratio should be within the medium-term target range of between 14% to 14.5%.

HSBC confirmed its target for a return on average tangible equity (RoTE) of 17% or better for 2026, 2027 and 2028, excluding notable items. The lender also continues to aim at year-on-year growth in revenue from 2026 to 2028, reaching 5% year-on-year growth in 2028.

The bank added it will keep its dividend payout ratio goal of 50% in 2026, 2027 and 2028.

(USD 1 = EUR 0.867)

Document SEBNK00020260805em850002t

Banking & Finance

Sandeep Batra's Borderless Leadership

BW Online Bureau

874 words

5 August 2026

BW Businessworld

ABPBUS

English

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Sandeep Batra's career has been shaped by movement across countries, cultures and complex financial markets. Yet beneath that mobility lies a consistent leadership instinct: to understand customers closely, build businesses for the future and recognise opportunity before it becomes obvious.

As Managing Director and Head of International **Wealth** and Premier Banking at HSBC India, Batra today operates at the centre of one of banking's most consequential opportunities. India is creating **wealth** at remarkable speed. Its affluent customers are younger, more internationally mobile and increasingly sophisticated in how they invest, spend and plan for the future. Connecting this new India with a global financial ecosystem requires more than products. It demands experience across markets and an understanding of how aspirations change as economies evolve.

Batra brings both to the task.

With more than 25 years in banking and financial services, his career has taken him through 12 cities and five countries, including 18 years spent outside India. He has described his current Mumbai apartment as his 25th home, a revealing detail from a professional journey built around repeatedly entering new environments and learning how to lead within them.

Learning Across Markets

An alumnus of the Indian Institute of Management Bangalore, Batra spent more than 15 years with Citi before joining HSBC India in August 2022. His international assignments included leading consumer banking for Citibank Russia during a period of significant change and heading the cards and lending business in Thailand.

In Thailand, he worked at the intersection of traditional banking and a rapidly expanding digital economy. His responsibilities included building partnerships with ecommerce companies and digital wallets, experience that strengthened his understanding of how technology, convenience and lifestyle expectations were beginning to reshape financial services.

His career also exposed him to multiple businesses through operating roles and strategic projects. That breadth has allowed him to see banking through different lenses: as a provider of credit, a custodian of **wealth**, an enabler of consumption and, increasingly, a partner in customers' cross-border lives.

Such international exposure is especially valuable in India today. Affluent Indian customers may earn in one country, invest in another, educate their children overseas and manage family or business interests across several markets. They need financial institutions that can understand the full architecture of their lives rather than address each requirement in isolation.

Building For India's **Wealth** Opportunity

At HSBC India, Batra's responsibilities span a substantial portfolio that includes retail and private banking, **wealth management**, cards, mortgages, personal lending, asset management and insurance.

His tenure has coincided with a renewed push by HSBC to strengthen its position among India's affluent and internationally minded customers. In 2025, the bank received regulatory approval to open branches in 20 additional cities, potentially expanding its network from 26 branches across 14 cities to 46 branches.

The importance of this expansion goes beyond the numbers. New centres of enterprise and personal **wealth** are emerging across India, frequently outside the country's traditional financial capitals. A wider presence allows HSBC to move closer to these customers while connecting them with the capabilities of an international banking network.

Batra has also been closely associated with initiatives intended to make the bank more relevant to changing customer expectations. These include a strengthened HSBC Premier proposition, an upgraded rewards marketplace and partnerships built around the interests and experiences of affluent Indians.

The approach reflects an important shift in **wealth** banking. Customers no longer judge a premium banking relationship solely by its investment products or account privileges. They expect digital convenience, international access, personalised advice and experiences that reflect how they live. The challenge for banks is to deliver all of these without weakening the trust on which financial relationships ultimately depend.

The Human Side Of Banking

For all the emphasis on technology and transformation, Batra's leadership story remains grounded in people. He is recognised as an advocate of collaborative and inclusive teams, as well as the development of future leaders within financial services.

That emphasis matters. Banking may increasingly be conducted through screens and powered by data, but its most important decisions remain deeply human. Customers entrust banks with their savings, family responsibilities, ambitions and anxieties. Leadership in this sector therefore requires judgement and empathy alongside commercial discipline.

Batra's journey also demonstrates the value of adaptability. Working successfully across countries does not come from applying the same formula everywhere. It requires a willingness to listen, question assumptions and understand the cultural and economic forces shaping each market.

This ability to combine global experience with local understanding is what makes his leadership particularly relevant today. India's next phase of **wealth** creation will need institutions capable of seeing the country not as an isolated market but as an increasingly influential part of the global economy.

On his birthday, Sandeep Batra's career offers much to celebrate: more than a quarter-century in banking, leadership experience across several major markets and an important role in shaping HSBC's ambitions in India. More significantly, his journey reflects a distinctly modern kind of leadership, one that crosses borders while remaining close to the customer.

Here's wishing Sandeep Batra a very happy birthday and many more milestones in the years ahead.

Document ABPBUS0020260805em850008h

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

Wealthy Clients Lift HSBC's Earnings

By Kosaku Narioka

502 words

5 August 2026

The Wall Street Journal

J

B11

English

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HSBC Holdings reported a surge in second-quarter net profit on stronger earnings across its businesses and resumed its share buybacks with an up to \$1 billion plan.

The London-based bank said Tuesday that net profit jumped for the three months ended June, exceeding analysts' estimates, as pretax profit increased across its four key segments, rising sharply in the business of supporting affluent clients with their finances.

The bank said it plans to start a share repurchase of up to \$1 billion, which it expects to complete by the time it announces third-quarter results.

HSBC had paused buybacks for three quarters to rebuild a capital buffer against losses following the announcement in October of a plan to take private Hang Seng Bank, a smaller Hong Kong lender it had long controlled. The bank completed a nearly \$14 billion bid in January.

HSBC, which makes much of its profit in Asia, also raised its forecast for banking net interest income this year, projecting at least \$46 billion, compared with around \$46 billion estimated previously.

Under Chief Executive Georges Elhedery, HSBC has been undergoing a broad organizational revamp, cutting costs and streamlining operations. Elhedery has been pushing the bank to focus on its strengths: retail banking in the U.K. and Hong Kong, acting as a bridge for large companies to global markets, and helping wealthy clients with their finances.

In recent weeks, HSBC has agreed to sell its Egypt retail banking business to Emirates NBD, its \$25 billion Australian home and personal loan portfolio to private-equity firm Blackstone, and its Singapore life and health insurance business to Allianz for \$2.1 billion.

"HSBC is becoming the stronger bank we set out to build," Chief Executive Georges Elhedery said.

Its shares listed in Hong Kong have hit record highs in recent sessions, driven by continued hopes for the bank's restructuring efforts and eased fears about U.S.-China trade tensions. The stock has risen about 36% year to date, adding to a 61% increase in 2025.

The bank's net profit jumped 68% from a year earlier to \$7.69 billion for the three months ended June. That beat the \$7.36 billion estimate in a poll of analysts by data provider Visible Alpha. Last year's bottom line was weighed by \$2.1 billion of losses related to associate Bank of Communications.

Pretax profit from its international **wealth** and premier banking gained 53% to \$1.385 billion. That of its corporate and institutional banking business rose 30% to \$3.19 billion. Pretax profit from its Hong Kong and U.K. businesses also climbed.

Net interest income -- the difference between interest earned on loans and that paid on deposits -- rose 9.0% to \$9.29 billion, while net fee income increased 7.2% to \$3.56 billion.

HSBC booked expected credit losses and other impairment charges of \$1.1 billion in the second quarter, largely steady from the year-earlier period.

Document J000000020260805em8500016

Banking & Finance

UOB to sell asset management arm to Allianz Global Investors for S\$555 million

Shikhar Gupta

477 words

5 August 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

online

English

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[SINGAPORE] UOB is selling its asset management arm to Allianz Global Investors (AllianzGI) for S\$555 million, an exit that hands the Singapore lender a significant capital gain while cementing a pivot towards open-architecture **wealth** distribution.

The sale, which includes excess cash, is expected to generate a pre-tax gain of about S\$330 million for South-east Asia's third-largest bank by assets, said UOB on Wednesday (Aug 5).

Excluding one-off transaction costs, the divestment will also lift UOB's Common Equity Tier 1 capital ratio by an estimated 14 basis points, immediately bolstering the bank's balance sheet.

Based on unaudited pro forma consolidated figures from end-2025, the net asset value attributable to the sold stake was S\$223 million.

UOB has operated UOB Asset Management for four decades. By shedding its in-house product manufacturing, the bank said it intends to focus strictly on **wealth** advisory and distribution across its network of more than eight million retail clients in Asean.

The acquisition by AllianzGI covers the UOB Asset Management franchise across Singapore, Brunei, Indonesia, Japan, Malaysia, Taiwan, Thailand and Vietnam.

A core component of the deal is a long-term strategic distribution partnership, allowing UOB to offer its clients access to AllianzGI's global product suite alongside an expanded, curated range of investment solutions.

UOB CEO and deputy chairman Wee Ee Cheong said the partnership sharpens the bank's focus on **wealth** advisory as the investment needs of its regional clients become increasingly diverse and sophisticated.

Combining UOB's advisory relationships with AllianzGI's investment capabilities allows the bank to accelerate **wealth management** growth while simultaneously enhancing long-term shareholder value, he noted.

For the buyer, the acquisition immediately doubles AllianzGI's footprint in Singapore and transfers UOB Asset Management's operations across eight Asian markets, absorbing a regional franchise that oversaw S\$42 billion in assets at the close of 2025.

All 500 existing UOB Asset Management employees will transition to AllianzGI, which has formally committed to maintaining their employment.

The transaction is expected to close in 2027, subject to regulatory approvals, with both firms pledging that operations will continue as usual during the transition period to ensure no disruption to customer services or fund access.

Allianz in July also agreed to buy HSBC's life and health insurance business in Singapore for S\$2.7 billion. This was part of a broader S\$2.9 billion deal that includes an exclusive distribution arrangement.

That deal came about two years after its previous attempt to significantly expand its local footprint ended in controversy.

In late 2024, the German insurance giant's S\$2.2 billion bid for a 51 per cent controlling stake in home-grown Income Insurance fell through.

sgupta@sph.com.sg

Document STBT000020260805em850012x

News

HSBC banks big increase in profits

178 words

5 August 2026

The Western Mail

WESMAI

1; National

25

English

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BUSINESS IN BRIEF

HSBC saw pre-tax profits for the first half of the year increased by 23%, the bank has revealed.

Interim results reported a \$3.7bn (£2.75bn) rise in profit before tax to \$19.5bn (£14.5bn) compared with the same period last year.

The bank said the growth was driven by higher net interest income and increased fee income, particularly from its **wealth management** and banking services.

The rise was partly offset by higher expected credit losses and increased operating expenses.

HSBC also announced it would resume share buybacks with a planned buyback of up to \$1bn (£744.8m), the first since the Hang Seng Bank privatisation announced in October.

Group chief executive Georges Elhedery said: "HSBC is becoming the stronger bank we set out to build. We are executing our strategic priorities with pace, precision and discipline. This is allowing our four businesses to focus on their core strengths, grow, work together more effectively and deepen customer relationships. The result is a bank capable of achieving more."

Document WESMAI0020260805em850002v

Earnings News

HSBC India profit rises 4% to \$965 million in H1 2026, corporate and institutional banking drives growth

Joel Rebello

399 words

5 August 2026

The Economic Times

ECTIM

English

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Mumbai: Hong Kong and Shanghai Banking Corp Ltd's (HSBC) India profit before tax increased 4% year on year in the first half of calendar 2026 led by higher revenue from corporate and institutional banking (CIB) its largest vertical in India. Profit before tax increased to \$965 million in six months ended June 2026 from \$931 million a year ago.

India is the fourth most profitable market behind Hong Kong (\$7.78 bln), UK (\$3.62 bln) and China (\$1.83 bln), dropping a place from a year ago. The Chinese business of the bank had made a loss in the first half of 2025. The Chinese business of HSBC had made a \$438 million loss in the first half of last year because of the dilution of the bank's shareholding in its associate Bank of Communications (BoCom) and an impairment loss on the carrying value of the Group's investment in BoCom.

Profit before tax from the CIB business increased 3% to \$792 million in the six months ended June 2026 from \$767 million a year ago. This division is the bank's main business centre in India and services large corporations and includes treasury operations. HSBC is the largest mobiliser of foreign currency deposits under the special scheme announced by RBI garnering \$6.1 billion until July 31, more than the \$4.1 billion received by State Bank of India, government data released on Monday showed.

Profit from the bank's corporate centre division, which provides support services to the bank globally, increased 15% to \$124 million from \$108 million a year ago. The bank's **wealth** and premier banking division reported a sharp 32% drop in profits to \$39 million from \$57 million a year ago. A bank spokesperson declined to comment on the results.

The bank's total wholesale loans to customers increased 5% year on year to \$21.42 billion from \$20.47 billion a year ago. Expected credit loss provisions dropped slightly to \$58 million from \$60 million a year ago.

Globally the bank reported a 23% year-on-year rise in pre-tax profit to \$19.5 billion in the first six months of 2026 helped by higher net interest income, fee and other income.

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Document ECTIM00020260805em8500005

Expert View: Balfour Beatty, HSBC, SSP, Sainsbury's, and Domino's

Michelle McGagh

994 words

5 August 2026

Citywire

CWIRE

English

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Balfour Beatty plc (BBY)

Key stats

Market capitalisation £4.2bn

P/E ratio 16.8

Source: Google Finance

Henderson duo back Balfour growth strategy

Henderson managers Indri van Hien and Cassie Herlihy are backing Balfour Beatty and its 'sharper focus' on growth markets.

The international contractor and infrastructure investor is the top holding in their Henderson Smaller Companies ([HSL](#)) closed-ended investment trust, where it makes up 3.5% of the £606m portfolio.

It operates construction services in the UK, US and Hong Kong, support services for the maintenance of infrastructure assets such as road, rail and energy in the UK, and owns a portfolio of infrastructure investments, including military housing in the US and hospitals and student accommodation in the UK.

'The shares have performed strongly following continued positive momentum in order book growth driven by UK power generation projects and US buildings,' said the managers.

'New orders have bolstered cash generation and enabled further cash returns to shareholders through both the regular dividend and share buybacks.'

They flagged new chief executive Philip Hoare's new 'evolve, energise, and explore' strategy that suggests 'going forward sharper focus will be given to existing and new growth markets', said the pair.

Shares in Balfour Beatty were trading up 1.2% at 876p on Tuesday and year-to-date are up 22%.

HSBC Holdings plc (HSBA)

Key stats

Market capitalisation £268.8bn

P/E ratio 17.4

Source: Google Finance

HSBC on the right course, says AJ Bell

The return of share buybacks shows HSBC is charting the right course, says AJ Bell.

The banking giant kickstarted buybacks after quarterly profits soared to \$10.1bn but the \$1bn of repurchases fell short of lofty analyst expectations, some of which hit \$2bn. However, HSBC shares were trading down 1.6% at £15.72 after the announcement on Tuesday.

'Buybacks are back on the menu at HSBC but rather than getting their knives and forks out ready to dine out on the shares, investors treated this offering with a shrug,' said analyst Russ Mould.

'The muted share price reaction follows an extremely strong showing so far this year as HSBC benefits from growth in areas like **wealth management** and insurance and from persistently higher interest rates.'

However, Mould said confidence was returning given some 'tweaks' to medium-term guidance and chief executive Georges Elhedery's suggestion that he has spent the first two years of his tenure building a strong group, and the next part is about putting those strengths to work.

'The return for buybacks follows the pause imposed since the bank announced a deal last year to take Hang Seng Bank private, suggesting that having steered this supertanker of a business on to the course he wants, it is now full steam ahead with Elhedery at the helm,' said Mould.

SSP Group PLC (SSPG)

Key stats
Market capitalisation £1.6bn
P/E ratio -

Source: Google Finance

SSP making operational and strategic progress, says Berenberg

SSP is simplifying its model which will 'reveal core value', according to Berenberg.

Analyst Luka Trnovsek reiterated his 'buy' recommendation and increased the target price from 230p to 245p on the food-on-the-go group, which was trading down 0.2% at 205p on Tuesday but is flat over this year.

SSP has delivered peer-leading like-for-like growth this year, which Trnovsek said has been driven by 'the strength of its M&S estate, its commercial initiatives, its 100% food and beverage exposure, and its domestically-skewed footprint'.

These factors will 'underpin a solid fourth quarter' and reiterated free cashflow guidance should open the door to 'incremental shareholder returns'.

More importantly for Trnovsek is the company's 'strategic action on European rail' and the sale of the stake in the India business, which will 'allow the company to unlock the value in its sum-of-the-parts'.

'Together, operational and strategic progress underpins our confidence looking ahead,' he said.

J Sainsbury plc (SBRY)

Key stats
Market capitalisation £7.8bn
P/E ratio 19.8

Source: Google Finance

Deutsche Bank: Sainsbury's will be more predictable without Argos

Sainsbury's sale of its Argos division will make it a more predictable business, says Deutsche Bank.

Analyst Benjamin Yokyong-Zoega retained his 'buy' recommendation and increased the target price from 360p to 390p on the supermarket giant, which was trading down 0.7% at 354p on Tuesday.

It has agreed to sell Argos for £120m to new company Swift Partners, which is significantly less than the £1.4bn it paid for the retailer a decade ago.

Yokyong-Zoega lifted his earnings per share forecasts 2% for full-year 2028/29 and his target price by 8% as it will be 'a less cyclical and more predictable business, which is our view warrants a higher price/earnings multiple'.

'We remain positive on the outlook for the core grocery business, which is underpinned by strong momentum in fresh food, further scaling of Nectar loyalty prices and retail media income, new space and re-allocation driving higher sales density,' he said.

Domino's Pizza Group PLC (DOM)

Key stats
Market capitalisation £804m
P/E ratio 13.9

Source: Google Finance

Peel Hunt predicts Domino's rerating

Momentum is building at Domino's which should rerate the shares, says Peel Hunt.

Analyst Douglas Jack reiterated his 'buy' recommendation and target price of 275p on the takeaway pizza chain, which was trading up 0.8% at 206p on Tuesday following first half results where like-for-like sales were up 5% and pre-tax profit rose 1% to £44.1m.

Jack kept his profit forecasts on hold, but upgraded 2027 profit before tax by 2% and by 3% in 2028 'to reflect the benefits of automation'.

'We believe product innovation is key to driving sales, while automation boosts margins,' he said.

'We believe they can drive a price/earnings rerating from 11 times to 15 times.'

Document CWIRE00020260805em8500002

News

HSBC restarts buybacks as profits soar 60% to \$10.1bn

ARJUN NEIL ALIM ; ORTENCA ALIAJ

548 words

5 August 2026

Financial Times

FTFTA

1; Usa

7

English

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Banks

HSBC's pre-tax profits jumped 60 per cent to \$10.1bn in the second quarter as the bank raised its target for cost savings and announced a new share buyback.

Revenues at Europe's largest lender came in at \$19.1bn in the three months to June 30, against a company-compiled analyst consensus of \$18.6bn up 16 per cent on the same period last year.

Profits were boosted by its **wealth management** and insurance business, including in its "second-home market" of Hong Kong, where it said it onboarded 640,000 clients across HSBC and its subsidiary Hang Seng this year.

Pre-tax profits in the second quarter last year were damped by impairment losses relating to the bank's stake in a Chinese lender, as well as by restructuring costs of \$500mn. "HSBC is becoming the stronger bank we set out to build," said chief executive Georges Elhedery. "We're executing our strategic priorities with pace, precision and discipline."

Shares dipped 0.8 per cent yesterday in London, bringing the increase this year to a third and valuing the company at £273bn.

HSBC retained its targets of a return on tangible equity of 17 per cent or higher for the next three years, and updated its banking net interest income outlook for 2026 from "around" to "at least" \$46bn.

Profits were up across HSBC's four businesses, with Hong Kong and international **wealth** and premier banking both delivering double-digit growth.

Wealth revenues rose 22 per cent in the second quarter from a year earlier to \$2.8bn, while wholesale transaction revenues rose 7 per cent at \$3bn. The share buyback worth up to \$1bn is the first since the bank last year announced a deal to take Hang Seng Bank private. It also planned to pay a second interim dividend of \$0.10 per share.

The bank raised its target for savings from its restructuring from \$1.5bn to \$2bn annualised by the end of this year, and recognised an additional \$200mn of costs in the quarter relating to Elhedery's plans to simplify operations.

HSBC also warned that its costs may increase if it allowed "additional performance-related pay" on the back of strong business performance. Analysts at Citi responded by warning that higher costs were not factored into existing consensus estimates.

Expected credit losses for the quarter stood at \$1.1bn, in line with the previous year and analyst expectations, with an additional \$400mn set aside for risky loans related to the Hong Kong commercial real estate sector.

Provisions for wholesale banking were \$1.6bn, which HSBC attributed to "fraud-related, secondary, securitisation exposure with a financial sponsor in the UK". In May the FT reported that HSBC had exposure to collapsed mortgage lender Market Financial Solutions through Apollo's asset-backed lending unit, Atlas SP. The higher

provisions also reflected an uptick for "mid-market clients across the globe", said Pam Kaur, HSBC's chief financial officer.

HSBC has continued its drive to simplify operations and reduced the number of managing director positions by 15 per cent between October 2024 and June 2026.

'We're executing our strategic priorities with pace, precision and discipline'

Document FTFTA00020260805em850015u

The Official Board

HSBC Private Bank APAC - The organizational chart displays its 18 executives, including Lok Yim and Jyrki Rauhio

421 words

4 August 2026

The Official Board

OFBOAR

English

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In the Banking industry, there are 5,570 large companies in 188 countries, with a total of 104,122 top executives. Within those companies, 43,366 executive movements have been recorded in the last 12 months.

Company: HSBC Private Bank APAC

URL: www.hsbcprivatebank.com/en/about-us/office-locations?r=asia-pacific&c=philippines

Industry: Banking

HSBC Private Bank APAC is a subsidiary of HSBC Private Bank Switzerland.

Name: Lok Yim

Title: Managing Director

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/lok-yim-579d6>

Name: Ken Ng

Title: General Counsel

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/ken-ng-7e76g>

Name: Jyrki Rauhio

Title: Regional Head of Credit Advisory

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/jyrki-rauhio-7gd2g>

Name: Gautam Anand

Title: Head of Global India

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/gautam-anand-43dg8>

Name: Kerri Lim

Title: Head of Ultra High Net Worth Segment

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/kerri-lim-g6182>

Name: Kanas Chan

Title: Head of Global Private Banking, North Asia and Hong Kong

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/kanas-chan-9769d>

Name: Tommy Leung

Title: Head of Global Private Banking, South Asia

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/tommy-leung-81gd4>

Name: Benoit Douchin

Title: Chief Operating Officer

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/benoit-douchin-481d0>

Name: Edith Wong

Title: Managing Director, Head of Southern Region

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/edith-wong-754g0>

Name: Gloria Sun

Title: Market Head of Offshore Taiwan

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/gloria-sun-e9d53>

Name: Sam Wong

Title: Ultra-High-Net-Worth Segment Development Manager

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/sam-wong-de39e>

Name: Abhishek Mehrotra

Title: Market Head of South East Asia International

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/abhishek-mehrotra-24e74>

Name: Sharnika Silva

Title: Head of Trust and Fiduciary Services, Southeast Asia

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/sharnika-silva-d1d94>

Name: Ann Ling

Title: Regional Head of **Wealth** Planning and Advisory

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/ann-ling-e0e10>

Name: Adam Lau

Title: Regional Head of Markets Solutions

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/adam-lau-d5230>

Name: Gary Goh

Title: Market Head of Malaysia

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/gary-goh-23d83>

Name: Hammad Hashmi

Title: Market Head of Singapore, Malaysia and Indonesia

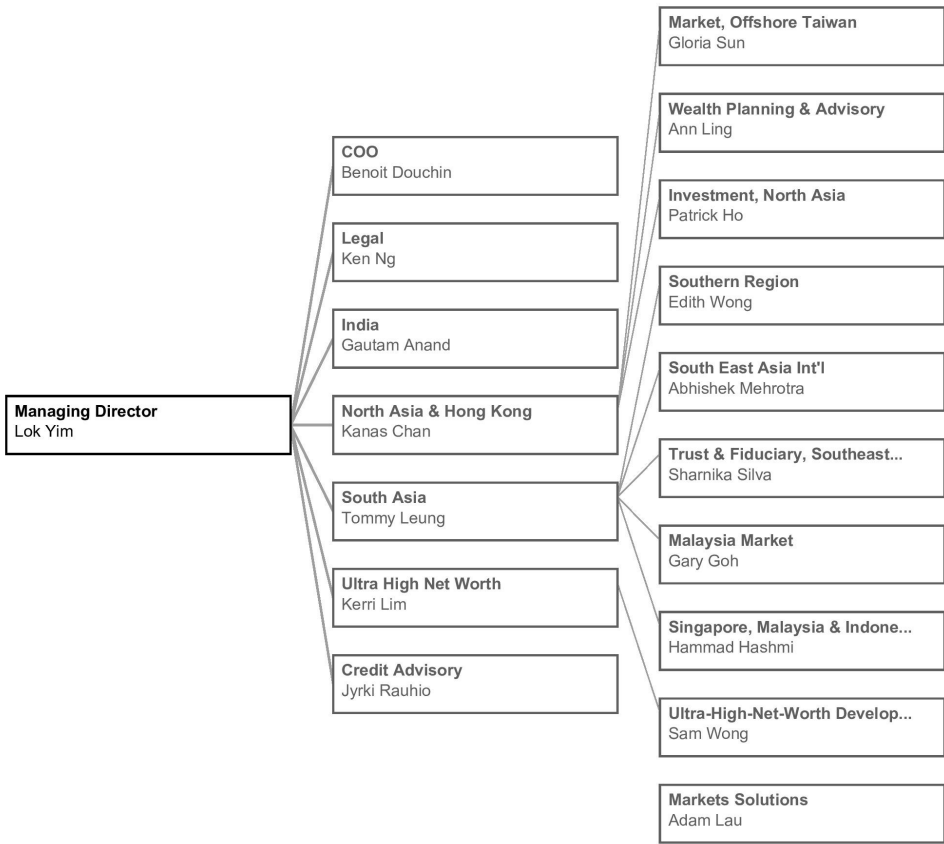
Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/hammad-hashmi-e54e7>

Name: Patrick Ho

Title: Chief Investment Officer, North Asia

Biography: <http://www.theofficialboard.com/biography/patrick-ho-26d14>

Organizational Chart HSBC Private Bank APAC



The Official Board as of Aug 10, 2026 10:00:30 AM - Know more at contact@theofficialboard.com

Investment Banking

HSBC signals bonus hike as revenue jumps; The UK lender is considering a bonus increase after improved performance

By Paul Clarke

426 words

4 August 2026

15:14

fnlondon.com

LONFIN

English

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HSBC could hike bonuses for 2026 following a big increase in revenue during the first half of the year PHOTO: Paul Yeung/Bloomberg via Getty Images

HSBC has said that its bonus pool could increase this year after its first-half revenue surged, becoming the latest big bank to signal a jump in variable pay.

The UK lender posted revenue of \$37.7bn for the first half of 2026, an increase of 11% on the prior year. Strong performance in its **wealth** unit, as well as a jump in trading and transaction banking income, have pushed profit up [beyond market expectations for the period](#).

HSBC chief executive Georges Elhedery said that the performance could justify a bigger bonus pool for 2026. The bank shelled out \$3.9bn for its overall 2025 bonus pool, which was up 10% compared with a year earlier, while average payouts for senior staff known as [material risk takers increased to \\$819,000](#).

"Should we continue to see this momentum carry forward in the second half, then we would certainly consider rewarding our colleagues for their increased performance and adjusting our variable pay pool upwards," he told journalists.

Elhedery said that the bonus pool amounted to 10% of overall costs and any rise would "have a modest impact on our overall costs as a bank".

Investment banks face a battle for talent as revenue has surged across both trading and dealmaking so far in 2026. Volatile markets have led to record equity trading revenue for some US banks in the second quarter, while M&A and IPO activity has surged.

HSBC's move to potentially hike pay comes after UK rival [Barclays also increased bonus costs](#).

Barclays put £1.3bn aside for its bonus pool for the first half of the year, which was up from £1bn at the same point in 2025. It also incurred a cost of around £200m as it shifted its pay model for MRTs more towards variable pay and away from fixed salaries.

MRTs have been paid so-called fixed allowances in addition to their base salary for years. These were put in place to circumvent the long-standing cap on bonuses, implemented in 2014, which limited bonuses to two-times salary. This was scrapped in 2024 and both Wall Street and UK banks have been unwinding fixed allowances this year, [Financial News has reported](#).

Write to Paul Clarke at paul.clarke@dowjones.com

Document LONFIN0020260804em840002t

DBS hires ex-Standard Chartered banker to lead India **wealth** business

273 words

4 August 2026

19:58

MarketLine News and Comment

DTMNTR

English

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DBS has named Nitin Chengappa, previously with Standard Chartered, to run its **wealth** operations in India.

Bloomberg sources said Chengappa joined in July and reports to Ambuj Chandna, who oversees consumer banking for DBS in India.

DBS Bank India told the news publication that Chengappa joined as managing director and head of its Treasures business and **wealth management**.

According to his LinkedIn profile, Chengappa worked for almost 10 years at Standard Chartered in India, most recently as head of affluent distribution and branch network. Before that, he spent more than 10 years at HSBC.

DBS expanded its presence in India in 2020 through the takeover of Lakshmi Vilas Bank, marking the first occasion on which Indian authorities relied on an overseas bank to rescue a troubled domestic lender.

Last year, DBS Bank India named Rajat Verma as chief executive officer, with effect from 1 March 2025. He succeeded Surojit Shome, who retired on 28 February 2025.

Verma has close to 30 years of banking experience across consumer and corporate banking, sustainable finance and SME banking. Since arriving at DBS in mid-2023, he has led the IBG division, broadening client ties and moving into additional business segments.

Earlier in his career, Verma was managing director and country head of commercial banking at HSBC India.

Last month, DBS disclosed plans to open 18 **wealth** centres across Asia by the end of 2027, while also refurbishing 36 existing locations over the next 18 months.

Those additions and upgrades are planned for Singapore, Hong Kong, mainland China, India, Indonesia and Taiwan.

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Document DTMNTR0020260806em840002a

HSBC Holdings plc Interim Results 2026

Distributed by Contify.com

1,775 words

4 August 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Executing strategic priorities with pace and precision.
- * Four businesses focusing on core strengths, growing and collaborating.
- * Bank capable of achieving more, deepening customer relationships.

Original Press Release:

Aug. 4 -- HSBC Group issued the following news release:

- Georges Elhedery, Group CEO, said:

"HSBC is becoming the stronger bank we set out to build. We are executing our strategic priorities with pace, precision and discipline. This is allowing our four businesses to focus on their core strengths, grow, work together more effectively and deepen customer relationships. The result is a bank capable of achieving more."

Financial performance in 1H26

* Profit before tax increased by \$3.7bn or 23% to \$19.5bn compared with 1H25. The increase primarily reflected a year-on-year net favourable impact of \$2.2bn from notable items. The increase also reflected growth in banking net interest income ('banking NII') and higher fee and other income, primarily in **Wealth** and Wholesale Transaction Banking ('WTB'). This was partly offset by higher expected credit losses and other credit impairment charges ('ECL'), and a planned increase in operating expenses. Profit after tax of \$15.3bn was \$2.9bn or 23% higher compared with 1H25.

* In 1H26, notable items included disposal losses of \$0.3bn recognised on classification to held for sale associated with the planned sale of our business in Malta, restructuring costs associated with our organisational simplification of \$0.3bn, and losses of \$0.2bn from the recycling of foreign currency translation reserves following the completion of the sale of our UK life insurance business. In 1H25, notable items included dilution and impairment losses of \$2.1bn related to our associate Bank of Communications Co., Limited ('BoCom'), and restructuring costs associated with our organisational simplification of \$0.6bn.

* Constant currency profit before tax excluding notable items increased by \$1.1bn to \$20.4bn compared with 1H25.

* Revenue increased by \$3.6bn or 11% to \$37.7bn compared with 1H25, including a year-on-year net favourable impact of notable items of \$0.8bn and the favourable impact of foreign currency translation differences of \$0.7bn. The remaining increase reflected higher banking NII, and strong growth in **Wealth** fee and other income in our International **Wealth** and Premier Banking ('IWPB') and Hong Kong business segments, supported by higher customer activity. The increase also included a one-off property asset disposal gain of \$0.2bn. Constant currency revenue excluding notable items rose by \$2.0bn to \$38.2bn compared with 1H25.

* Net interest income ('NII') increased by \$1.4bn compared with 1H25, primarily driven by deposit balance growth and the benefit of reinvestment of our structural hedge at higher yields. There was also a favourable impact from foreign currency translation differences of \$0.4bn, partly offset by the impact of an adverse \$0.1bn one-off item. The impact of lower market interest rates on the funding deployed to the trading book was broadly offset by

higher trading balances. Banking NII, which excludes the funding costs associated with the trading book and insurance NII, increased by \$1.6bn to \$22.9bn.

* Net interest margin ('NIM') of 1.61% was 4 basis points ('bps') higher compared with 1H25, mainly due to the impact from foreign currency translation differences and the benefit of our structural hedge, partly offset by lower market interest rates.

* ECL of \$2.4bn were \$0.4bn higher than in 1H25. The 1H26 charge primarily reflected stage 3 charges on wholesale exposures, including a \$0.4bn fraud-related, secondary, securitisation exposure with a financial sponsor in the UK in our Corporate and Institutional Banking ('CIB') business, and \$0.2bn related to the Hong Kong commercial real estate ('CRE') sector. 1H26 also included allowances to reflect uncertainty due to the ongoing conflict in the Middle East. ECL in 1H25 included charges related to the Hong Kong CRE sector of \$0.5bn, as well as allowance increases relating to geopolitical tensions and higher trade tariffs.

* Operating expenses of \$17.4bn were \$0.4bn or 2% higher than in 1H25, including an adverse impact from foreign currency translation differences of \$0.4bn. The increase was driven by higher planned spend and investment in technology, and the impact of inflation. These increases were partly mitigated by cost reductions from our organisational simplification and a year-on-year favourable impact from notable items.

* Target basis operating expenses were \$0.4bn or 2% higher than in 1H25, including the impact of inflation and higher planned spend and investment in technology, partly offset by cost reductions from our organisational simplification.

* Customer lending balances increased by \$34bn compared with 31 December 2025, including adverse foreign currency translation differences of \$6bn. On a constant currency basis, lending balances increased by \$40bn, reflecting growth across all our business segments, particularly in our main entity in Hong Kong. This was partly offset by the classification to held for sale of loans from the planned sale of our business in Malta.

* Customer accounts increased by \$41bn compared with 31 December 2025, including adverse foreign currency translation differences of \$15bn. On a constant currency basis, customer accounts increased by \$56bn, primarily reflecting growth in our CIB business, partly offset by the classification to held for sale of deposits from the planned sale of our business in Malta and our retail banking business in Indonesia.

* Common equity tier 1 ('CET1') capital ratio of 14.1% decreased by 0.8 percentage points compared with 31 December 2025, reflecting the impact of the privatisation of Hang Seng Bank Limited ('Hang Seng Bank'), dividends and an increase in risk-weighted assets ('RWAs'), partly offset by regulatory profit.

* The Board has approved a second interim dividend of \$0.10 per share. We also intend to initiate a share buy-back of up to \$1bn, which we expect to complete by our third quarter 2026 results announcement.

Financial performance in 2Q26

* Profit before tax increased by \$3.8bn or 60% to \$10.1bn compared with 2Q25, primarily reflecting a net favourable impact from notable items of \$2.6bn. The increase also reflected growth in banking NII, and higher fee and other income primarily in **Wealth** and WTB. Profit after tax increased by \$3.1bn or 63% to \$7.9bn compared with 2Q25.

* In 2Q26, notable items included restructuring costs associated with our organisational simplification of \$0.2bn. In 2Q25, notable items included dilution and impairment losses of \$2.1bn related to our associate BoCom, and restructuring costs associated with our organisational simplification of \$0.5bn.

* Revenue increased by \$2.6bn to \$19.1bn compared with 2Q25, including a year-on-year net favourable impact of \$1.3bn from notable items. The increase also reflected a rise in banking NII, and strong growth in **Wealth** fee and other income in our IWPB and Hong Kong business segments, supported by higher customer activity. Revenue grew in Debt and Equity Markets and WTB in our CIB business. Constant currency revenue excluding notable items rose by \$1.3bn to \$19.0bn.

* ECL of \$1.1bn were stable compared with 2Q25. The charge in 2Q26 primarily comprised stage 3 charges, including \$0.2bn related to the Hong Kong CRE sector. The ECL charge in 2Q25 included charges of \$0.4bn related to the Hong Kong CRE sector.

* Operating expenses of \$8.7bn were \$0.2bn or 2% lower compared with 2Q25, reflecting lower restructuring costs together with the resultant cost reduction benefits from our organisational simplification, and the phasing of performance-related pay accrual relative to 2Q25. These reductions were partly offset by higher planned spend

and investment in technology, the impact of inflation and an adverse impact from foreign currency translation differences of \$0.1bn.

* Customer lending increased by \$20bn compared with 1Q26 on a reported basis, reflecting growth across all segments.

* Customer accounts increased by \$46bn compared with 1Q26 on a reported basis, primarily reflecting growth in our CIB business, notably in Hong Kong, partly offset by the classification of deposits from the planned sale of our retail banking business in Indonesia to held for sale.

Outlook

Group financial targets

* We remain confident in achieving the targets we set out in February 2026, including a return on average tangible equity ('RoTE') of 17% or better for 2026, 2027 and 2028, excluding notable items.

* We continue to target year-on-year growth in revenue from 2026 to 2028, rising to 5% growth in 2028 compared with 2027, excluding notable items and on a constant currency basis.

* We maintain our dividend payout ratio target basis of 50% in 2026, 2027 and 2028. Our target basis payout ratio is calculated as a percentage of earnings per share ('EPS') excluding material notable items and related impacts.

In respect of 2026

* We now expect banking NII of at least \$46bn in 2026, reflecting a continued favourable interest rate outlook, while recognising the outlook remains volatile and uncertain. We had previously provided banking NII guidance of around \$46bn for 2026.

* We continue to expect an ECL charge as a percentage of average gross customer loans to be around 45bps (including held for sale loan balances) for 2026, reflecting ongoing uncertainty in the outlook. Over the medium term, we retain our planning range of 30-40bps.

* The Group remains on track to deliver year-on-year growth in operating expenses of approximately 1% in 2026 on a target basis. Should strong business performance continue, we may consider additional performance-related pay which would increase 2026 target basis cost growth modestly. Our target basis operating expenses measure excludes notable items and includes the impact of simplification-related saves associated with our announced strategic reorganisation.

* We intend to continue to manage the CET1 capital ratio within our medium-term target range of 14% to 14.5%.

Our targets and expectations reflect our current outlook for the global macroeconomic environment and market-dependent factors, such as market-implied interest rates (as of mid-July 2026) and rates of foreign exchange, as well as customer behaviour and activity levels.

We do not reconcile our forward guidance on RoTE excluding notable items, target basis operating expenses, dividend payout ratio target basis or banking NII to their equivalent reported measures.

For further details, please refer to the following pages of our Interim Report 2026: pages 41 to 44 for a further explanation of RoTE excluding notable items, banking NII, target basis operating expenses and dividend payout ratio target basis. For further information on our CET1 ratio, see page 70.

Disclaimer: The full PDF release can be found

at: <https://www.hsbc.com/news-and-views/news/media-releases/2026/hsbc-holdings-plc-interim-results-2026>

[Category: Investment Banking, Financial Performance]

Source: HSBC Group

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The Daily Dose Asia-Pacific
Daiwa Next Bank acquires Orix Bank; P&N, Bank Australia advance merger talks

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TOP NEWS IN BANKING & FINANCIAL SERVICES

– Japan-based Daiwa Next Bank Ltd., a wholly owned subsidiary of Daiwa Securities Group Inc., completed the acquisition of all outstanding shares of Orix Bank Corp. from Orix Corp. Orix Bank is now a wholly owned subsidiary of Daiwa Next Bank.

– Police & Nurses Ltd. (P&N) and Bank Australia Ltd. will advance to the regulatory application stage of their proposed merger after completing initial due diligence. The Australian banks said in May they were exploring the deal. The companies' boards agreed to proceed after due diligence showed strong alignment in values and purpose, according to a news release.

➤ Australia's stability creates fertile ground for M&A activity in Asia-Pacific

Australia stood out as the leading market, supported by its relative isolation from global geopolitical turmoil.

➤ Singapore banks' Q2 profits seen steady as non-interest income offsets NIM drop

DBS Group Holdings, Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp. and United Overseas Bank are expected to post flat second-quarter net profits as net interest margins continue to decline, S&P Global Market Intelligence data shows.

EARNINGS SPOTLIGHT

– Japan-based Resona Holdings Inc. reported a consolidated attributable net profit of ¥80.53 billion for the quarter ended June 30, up 14.2% year over year from ¥70.53 billion. Net interest income for the quarter increased to ¥163.10 billion, growing 32.1% year over year. The bank increased its full-year profit forecast to ¥330 billion from ¥310 billion, expecting a 27.6% increase.

– Habib Bank Ltd. booked consolidated net profit of 18.39 billion Pakistani rupees for the quarter ended June, up 3.17% year over year from 17.82 billion rupees. Strong net interest income at 68.92 billion rupees drove the result, with the consolidated figure reaching 140.29 billion rupees for the first half, up 1.93% from the prior-year half. The bank declared an interim cash dividend of 6 rupees per share for the second quarter, bringing total payouts for the first half to 12 rupees per share.

BANKING

– HSBC Holdings PLC said the privatization of its Hong Kong unit, Hang Seng Bank Ltd., will not result in layoffs, and there is no plan to merge the banks' customer-facing frontline operations, The Standard reported, citing CEO Georges Elhedery. HSBC Hong Kong and Hang Seng Bank will integrate back-office functions, technology and product manufacturing, while maintaining separate brands and independent operations, Elhedery said.

HSBC's Hong Kong business, which comprises the retail banking and **wealth** and commercial banking of HSBC Hong Kong and Hang Seng Bank, contributed US\$5.1 billion to the group profit before tax in the first half of fiscal year 2026, the UK-based lender said in its earnings report.

– Agricultural Bank of China Ltd. raised 20 billion Chinese yuan through a three-year green bond, which carries a coupon rate of 1.51%, the Shanghai Securities News reported. The proceeds will reportedly be used to finance eligible green projects.

– Rural commercial banks throughout China have initiated midyear efforts to collect nonperforming loans (NPL), including campaigns that cover entire provinces and door-to-door clearances in counties, 21jingli.com reported. Since July, several NPL transfer projects have been listed on the exchange center, each valued at between tens

of millions and more than 100 million yuan, and covering personal consumption loans, business loans, and corporate loans.

- Axis Bank Ltd. said it priced US dollar-denominated senior notes issued by its Gift City branch under the Indian bank's global medium-term note program. The \$300 million tranche, to be issued Aug. 11, will carry a coupon of 5.348% per annum, payable semiannually.

- National Bank for Agriculture & Rural Development withdrew its bond issue after investors demanded a higher cutoff than the issuer was willing to accept, the Business Standard wrote. The bank had planned to raise 8 billion Indian rupees through five-year bonds but received bids of only 7.17 billion rupees, at coupon levels ranging from 7.20% to 7.60%, according to the report.

- India-based Tamilnad Mercantile Bank Ltd. plans to open liaison offices in Singapore, Malaysia and the Middle East to expand its outreach to Indians living abroad, Managing Director Salee Nair told Moneycontrol. A liaison office lets banks establish a representative branch in a foreign country before launching full operations.

FINANCIAL SERVICES

- Pacific Asset Management LLP, part of Australia-based Pinnacle Investment Management Group Ltd., said it agreed to acquire UK-based asset manager Asset Value Investors Ltd. for about A\$76.7 million. The deal includes about A\$25.3 million in cash and A\$31.9 million in new Pinnacle shares at completion, plus A\$19.5 million in cash payable 12 months later. AVI will continue operating independently under its existing brand, with no changes to its investment team or London office.

- Apple Pay, the payment service of Apple Inc., launched in the Philippines, allowing customers to make contactless payments, the Philippine Daily Inquirer reported. The service supports cards issued by Philippines-based China Banking Corp., GoTyme Bank Corp., Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co. and Union Bank of the Philippines, with more banks expected to join in the coming months.

POLICY AND REGULATION

- South Korea's Financial Services Commission updated its regulations to facilitate the easier sharing of voice-phishing-related information among financial firms, telecom service providers, and investigators. The new rules took effect Aug. 4, the regulator said in a news release. The AI-based Anti-Phishing Sharing and Analysis Platform was launched in October 2025.

- Philippine lawmakers filed a proposed law that would let Filipinos use digital transaction histories to prove creditworthiness when applying for loans and other financial products, the Philippine Daily Inquirer reported. The bill would allow lenders to use alternative data alongside traditional credit information, with consumers able to grant access to up to 24 months of data.

- State Bank of Vietnam plans to close millions of dormant accounts to clean up the banking database and curb financial fraud, Viet Nam News reported. The Vietnamese central bank currently allows banks to close accounts that have been inactive for at least three years since their last transaction, unless the bank and customer agree otherwise.

INDUSTRY NEWS

- Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi urged Bank of Japan Governor Kazuo Ueda to purchase Japanese government bonds if needed to control the increase in long-term interest rates, the Japan Times reported, citing sources. The request was made during a meeting in May, at a time when the central bank is scaling back its government bond acquisitions. Takaichi reportedly wants the BOJ to align its monetary policy with the Cabinet's agenda.

[Click here](#) for a summary of indexes on the S&P Capital IQ Pro platform.

As of Aug. 3, US\$1 was equivalent to 6.75 Chinese yuan, ¥157.56, 277.77 Pakistani rupees and 95.12 Indian rupees.

Eden Estopace, R Sio, Kanas Chan and Jonathan Cheah contributed to this report.

The Daily Dose has an editorial deadline of 6:30 a.m. Hong Kong time. Some external links may require a subscription. Links are current as of publication time, and we are not responsible if those links are unavailable later.

Business

Calls for UK bank tax to fund cost of living help as HSBC profits hit £7.5bn

Kalyeena Makortoff Banking correspondent

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Levy could raise £19bn to help pay for Andy Burnham's support for those struggling with bills, say campaigners

Campaigners have renewed calls for a windfall tax on UK banks that could raise £19bn towards Andy Burnham's cost of living agenda, after HSBC raked in \$10.1bn (£7.5bn) worth of profits in the second quarter of the year.

Bosses at HSBC reported on Tuesday that profits rose 60% year on year in the three months to the end of June, helped by fees from **wealth management** and insurance business, as well as higher interest rates, which allow the bank to charge more for loans and mortgages.

The HSBC chief executive, Georges Elhedery, said he would consider increasing banker bonuses on the back of the strong results and planned to restart a share buy-back programme that had been on pause since last year.

It brings collective profits for the four largest banks – HSBC, NatWest, Barclays and Lloyds – to £29.2bn over the first six months of the year, putting lenders [back in the crosshairs of campaigners](#), including Positive Money and the Trades Union Congress, who are calling for a fresh tax on the lucrative industry.

The campaign group Positive Money said bank bosses had pledged nearly half of their profits – a total of £13.7bn – to shareholders through dividends and share buy-backs, proving they could easily shoulder a tax that they calculated could ultimately raise £19bn towards the government's [spending plans at the October budget](#).

Positive Money said the government could replicate Spain's levy, targeting any UK revenues above £800m with a 38% tax, in line with the energy profits levy introduced for oil and gas companies [announced by the Tory government in 2022](#).

They said the resulting £19bn would be enough to cover the cost of Andy Burnham's VAT cut from electricity bills (worth £850m), the £2 cap on bus fares (worth £500m) and the business rates cut for pubs, clubs and music venues (worth £100m) more than 13 times over.

"Previous governments have allowed the powerful banking lobby to persuade them against taxing these record-breaking profits in recent years, despite overwhelming public support for the policy," said the co-director of Positive Money, Sara Hall.

"We're calling on Andy Burnham to break with his predecessors by resisting the demands of City lobbyists and reclaiming these lost billions with a windfall tax on bank profits, the proceeds of which could be used to fund truly life-changing support for the households and businesses struggling to pay their bills right now."

Banking bosses have been cautious when asked about their views on a fresh tax rise. They told journalists over the past week that they were encouraged by Burnham's economic vision, but stressed that their ability to lend money to businesses was crucial for the new prime minister's growth ambitions. "UK growth requires strong banks," Elhedery said.

But advocates of a tax remain undeterred, and the TUC general secretary, Paul Nowak, said: "There is now a mountain of evidence to suggest that banks can easily afford to pay more tax. While higher interest rates have meant mortgage misery and bigger bills for the rest of us, the big banks have been rolling in it."

Joanne O'Neill, the co-director of advocacy and influencing at ActionAid UK, said the government should also take "meaningful action" to hold UK banks to account for their impact on the climate and human rights.

[“ActionAid research has shown](#) how HSBC funnelled billions into fossil fuels and industrial agriculture companies between 2021 and 2023, helping to fuel environmental destruction. And since then it has watered down its climate commitments, further shirking its responsibility to help bring about the just transition we need,” O’Neill said, adding that banks should face a “polluters pay tax” that fairly reflected their responsibility for financing and causing climate harm.

Metro Bank followed its big four competitors in reporting bumper profits for the first half of the year. The challenger bank reported a 38% jump in pre-tax profits on Tuesday morning to £60.7m over the first six months of 2026, after a jump in corporate, SME and specialist mortgage lending, as Metro tried to corner “underserved markets” to boost profits.

While the strong rise in profits will add weight to calls for a UK windfall tax, Metro would probably escape Positive Money’s proposals. The bank reported about £241.5m in underlying net interest income for the first six months of the year, and if repeated, would keep its full-year figure below the campaigner’s £800m threshold.

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DFCC completes acquisition of Standard Chartered Sri Lanka's **wealth** and retail banking business

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DFCC Bank PLC yesterday said that it has completed its acquisition of Standard Chartered Bank Sri Lanka's **wealth** and retail banking business.

Approximately 50,000 customers, together with colleagues from the business, have now joined DFCC Bank, it said.

The transaction includes customer relationships across Priority Banking, credit cards, retail lending, deposits, **wealth management**, and small and medium enterprise (SME) portfolios, together with selected operating assets. It strengthens DFCC Bank's retail, **wealth management**, and SME capabilities, while expanding the scale and reach of these businesses.

For customers, the transition has been planned around continuity. Months of detailed preparation and close collaboration across both organisations have enabled customers to retain many of the banking arrangements, relationships, and services they use every day. Their existing Standard Chartered account numbers remain usable alongside their new DFCC Bank account numbers, while their existing credit and debit cards, card PINs, standing instructions, direct debits, and recurring payment arrangements continue as before.

Saved payees and beneficiaries have also been migrated to the bank's digital banking platforms, DFCC ONE and DFCC iConnect, removing one of the most common inconveniences associated with changing banks. Customers with existing branch and Relationship Manager arrangements can continue banking through the same branches and same Relationship Managers.

Customers who have joined DFCC Bank now have access to the bank's wider range of personal banking, **wealth management**, SME, card, and lending solutions. They are supported by DFCC Bank's islandwide network of over 130 branches, access to more than 5,000 ATMs through the LankaPay network, DFCC ONE, DFCC iConnect, and dedicated customer service channels.

Eligible customers will also have access to DFCC Pinnacle, the bank's premium banking proposition.

The acquisition is an important step in DFCC Bank's long-term strategy to expand its retail and **wealth management** franchise, strengthen its SME business, and broaden its ability to serve customers across Sri Lanka.

DFCC Bank CEO Thimal Perera said: 'From the very beginning, our focus has been on making this transition as seamless and familiar as possible for customers. Behind that experience has been an exceptionally complex technology program, supported by months of detailed planning, close collaboration, and an extraordinary effort by teams across both organisations. Success meant ensuring that customers experienced as little of that complexity as possible. Their existing Standard Chartered account numbers remain usable alongside their new DFCC Bank account numbers. They can continue using the same credit and debit cards and the same card PINs, while their standing instructions, direct debits, recurring payments, instalment arrangements, and other everyday banking arrangements continue as before.'

He added: 'We have also transferred their saved payees and beneficiaries to our digital banking platforms, removing one of the most common inconveniences customers face when changing banks. Customers with existing branch and Relationship Manager arrangements can continue banking through the same branches and with the Relationship Managers they already know and trust. I extend my sincere appreciation to my colleagues at DFCC Bank and our colleagues at Standard Chartered Bank, the Central Bank of Sri Lanka, our technology and implementation partners, and everyone whose expertise and commitment made this possible. It is an honour to

welcome our new customers and colleagues to DFCC Bank. We look forward to earning their trust and supporting them through every stage of their financial lives.'

Standard Chartered Sri Lanka CEO Bingumal Thewarathanthri said: 'This transition reflects a strategic decision in line with Standard Chartered Group's global strategy, to focus our resources in areas where we have the necessary scale and most distinctive proposition. We are grateful to our clients for the trust they have placed in us over the years, and to our colleagues for their professionalism and commitment throughout this transition. We extend our best wishes to our clients and staff who have moved to DFCC Bank, and wish them every success for the future.'

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News18

HSBC India H1 2026 profit rises 3.65 pc; adds nearly 2k employees

News18

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Mumbai, Aug 4 (PTI) Foreign lender HSBC on Tuesday reported a 3.65 per cent increase in its pre-tax profit from India operations to USD 965 million.

The lender, which recently increased branches in India by 20 to 46, had earned a pre-tax profit of USD 931 million for the January-June 2025 period.

The country slipped to the fourth largest profit centre for the UK-headquartered group. Mainland China, which reported a loss of USD 438 million in H12025, accelerated ahead with a profit of USD 1.837 billion.

HSBC, which depends on the country for a sizeable part of its back-office operations, added nearly 2,000 employees over the last year to take the overall base to 48,114. The employee base was higher than in the UK and Hong Kong, where it witnessed a decline in workforce.

Among business segments, corporate and institutional banking continued to be the largest contributor for the lender in India, delivering a profit of USD 792 million against USD 767 million in the year-ago period.

Corporate Centre, which includes balance sheet and treasury management, witnessed profit rising to USD 124 million from USD 108 million in the year-ago period.

Profit from the International **Wealth** and Premier Banking (IWPB) slipped to USD 39 million from USD 57 million a year ago.

The HSBC Group's global pre-tax profit grew by over 13 per cent to USD 5.138 billion.

The period saw marginal declines in exposure to the non-banks and real estate segments, even though overall corporate and commercial exposure grew to USD 14.987 billion as of June 30, 2026, against 13.789 billion in the year-ago period.

The bank, which is concentrating on the retail segment lately, saw a marginal increase in the overall personal lending category at USD 3.484 billion from USD 3.334 billion last year. PTI AA BAL BAL

Document NEWSET0020260804em84001mh

HSBC Malta delivers strong half-year results with robust capital and liquidity

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HSBC Bank Malta p.l.c. delivered a reported profit before tax for the six months ended 30 June 2026 amounting to €44.4million (June 2025: €58.7million). Adjusted profit before tax, after considering notable items amounts to €51.7million (June 2025: €58.7million). The Board of Directors declared an interim quarterly cash ordinary dividend of €0.043 gross per share amounting to €15.5 million to be paid to shareholders appearing on the bank's Register of Members, as maintained at the Central Securities Depository at the Malta Stock Exchange, as at the close of business of 18 August 2026. Interim dividends will be paid on 23 September 2026. Considering the gross dividend per share paid in Q1 2026 of €0.036, total gross dividend per share in H1 2026 amounted to €0.079, equivalent to €28.5million.

Commenting on the results, Geoffrey Fichte, Chief Executive Officer, said. "We delivered a strong and resilient first half performance, with adjusted profit before tax of €51.7million, supported by rising transaction volumes and broad-based momentum across new-to-bank customers, personal lending, **wealth** and insurance, including product enhancements. New corporate lending increased to support businesses and the wider economy, while deposits grew year-on-year, reinforcing our funding strength and the trust customers place in us. Backed by our strong capital and liquidity ratios, and solid first half profitability, we are well positioned for the future and continue to reward shareholders with quarterly dividends. The proposed transition to a new majority shareholder, CrediaBank, subject to regulatory approvals, is progressing and the bank's employees remain focused on serving customers."

Financial Performance

The reported profit before tax for the six months ended 30 June 2026 was €44.4million, a decrease of €14.3million compared with H1 2025. The period-on-period movement reflects the lower interest rate environment, market volatility and the impact of notable expenses. The adjusted profit before tax amounted to €51.7million, a decrease of €7.0million compared with the same period last year.

Net interest income decreased by €4.3million to €85.6million compared with €89.8million in H1 2025, reflecting lower average market interest rates during the period.

Non-funds income (fees and commissions and trading income) decreased by €0.6million compared to the same period last year. Net fee income increased by €0.3million supported by growth in new lending across both business lines and higher **wealth** sales. Trading income decreased by €0.9million, following an exceptionally strong comparative performance in H1 2025.

Operating expenses increased by €7.8million to €65.9million, compared with €58.1million in H1 2025. This reflects notable expenses of €7.3million, being accelerated software amortisation following a revision of the estimated useful life, and an expense for staff-related payments in connection with the industrial dispute with the Malta Union of Bank Employees ('MUBE') as announced in Company Announcement HSBC469.

The bank reported a net release of Expected Credit Losses ('ECL') of €6.5million, compared with a €3.0million release in the same period last year. The ECL release in H1 2026 primarily reflects a recovery on a long-outstanding non-performing corporate loan and improved credit quality in the retail portfolio. ECL calculations continued to consider elevated global uncertainty and geopolitical risks, while the local economy remained resilient.

HSBC Life Assurance (Malta) Ltd. delivered a profit before tax of €1.9million, compared with €6.5million in H1 2025. Performance was influenced by uncertain market conditions, with yield curve movements reversing versus the prior comparative period and negatively impacting net investment results. Despite a highly competitive market, new business generation across protection and long-term savings continued to perform well in the first half of the year and ahead of last year. The company also continued to demonstrate strong financial resilience, maintaining a very robust capital position with a Solvency ratio of 252% as at 30 June 2026.

The effective tax rate remained at 35%, resulting in an interim tax expense of €15.7million.

Financial Position and Capital

Net loans and advances to customers amounted to €2,696million as at 30 June 2026, a decrease of €67million or 2% when compared to 31 December 2025. However, the bank continued to grow new lending across both business lines and strengthened portfolio quality, resulting in a reduction in non-performing loans of 6%. Non-performing loans are at the lowest levels in recent years.

The investment portfolio increased by €98million to €2,636million, reflecting continued effort to mitigate structural interest-rate risk on the balance sheet. The portfolio remains conservatively positioned and is composed of highly rated securities with the lowest investment grade of A-.

Customer deposits were €6,213million as at 30 June 2026, marginally higher than €6,203million as at 30 June 2025. Customer deposits were lower than 31 December 2025, primarily reflecting seasonal movements in corporate balances while retail deposits increased.

Capital ratios remained strong and comfortably above the regulatory requirements. Common equity tier 1 capital was 24.7% as at 30 June 2026 (compared to 24.1% at the end of 2025) and the total capital ratio was 27.8% (compared to 27.1% as at 31 December 2025).

The Board recommended an interim gross quarterly dividend of €0.043 per share, equivalent to a gross dividend of €15.5million. This represents a 60% payout of the profits after tax, adjusted for the employee benefits expense related to the industrial dispute. The interim dividend will be paid on 23 September 2026 to shareholders who are on the bank's register of shareholders on 18 August 2026.

Corporate Matters

In December 2025, HSBC Bank Malta p.l.c. was awarded the Bank of the Year by the Banker, the Financial Times internationally renowned publication covering global banking and financial affairs. HSBC Malta's recognition reflects the bank's significant progress across key performance metrics, including earnings growth, capital strength, operational efficiency, and continued investment in digital and technological capabilities. In January 2026, the bank celebrated this recognition at a landmark customer event. A further customer event was held in June 2026 to thank valued customers for their continued trust.

HSBC Bank Malta p.l.c. and the HSBC Malta Foundation have won the Corporate Award for Environmental Innovation and Sustainability in the Private Sector at the 2026 Environment and Resources Authority Awards, recognising the bank's work on Maximising Energy Efficiency Through Sustainable Building Renovation at the HSBC Hub in Qormi. The project is a €30million sustainable retrofit transforming an existing office complex into one of Malta's most energy-efficient corporate buildings.

The proposed transition to a new majority shareholder, CrediaBank, subject to regulatory approvals, is progressing and the bank's employees remain focused on serving customers. HSBC Malta is working closely with its existing majority shareholder, HSBC Continental Europe and CrediaBank, to ensure a smooth and orderly transition; one that safeguards the stability and continuity of the bank for its customers, colleagues, and shareholders.

A bank wide townhall held in May 2026, themed 'Making it Happen', brought colleagues together and reinforced key strategic messages.

Customer and Business Initiatives

Retail Banking and **Wealth Management**, Insurance and Asset Management

The bank remained focused on deepening customer relationships by delivering strong service, supporting customer acquisition and enhancing its proposition.

Retail deposit balances grew during the first half of the year, and new retail lending increased by 27% compared with the same period last year.

Wealth investment sales achieved double-digit growth year on year, reflecting the bank's focus on supporting customers' financial planning needs through protection, regular savings and investment solutions, complemented by HSBC's asset management and insurance capabilities.

Marketing activity continued across multiple channels, with a focus on lending as well as **wealth** and insurance solutions. In April 2026, eight new Target Dated Funds were added to complement the HSBC Life Pension product platform, helping customers plan more easily for retirement.

The bank continued to provide tailored credit solutions, including the selective reintroduction of mortgage fixed-rate offers, while maintaining disciplined pricing and credit standards to support long-term sustainability.

Branch modernisation also progressed. Refurbishment works at the Rabat Branch were completed in May 2026, delivering an enhanced in-branch experience with improved consultation privacy and wheelchair accessibility. Works at the Gżira branch have commenced, with measures in place to minimise inconvenience as the bank continues to service its customers.

Service levels remained a priority, with continued focus on maintaining fast turnaround times for credit applications and customer enquiries through the Contact Centre and secure messaging.

Corporate and Institutional Banking

During the first half of 2026, the bank continued preparations for its next phase of growth, maintaining proactive customer engagement while sustaining high-quality day-to-day service delivery.

Business activity remained robust, supported by a strong pipeline expected to progress in the coming months. This activity supported customers across sectors including hospitality, real estate, retail and manufacturing.

The bank also renewed its Gold Sponsorship Agreement with The Malta Chamber of Commerce, Enterprise and Industry, reinforcing its commitment to supporting Malta's business community through collaboration, knowledge exchange and sustainable economic growth.

Document MLIND00020260804em840002v

Business

HSBC sets \$1 billion buyback after profit beats forecast

Reuters

333 words

4 August 2026

RTE.ie

RTEI

English

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HSBC Holdings has today reported a better-than-expected first-half profit and raised its net interest income target, driven by revenue growth in lending and **wealth management** fee earnings on robust money flows.

Europe's largest bank posted a pretax profit of \$19.5 billion for the first six months of this year, up 23% from \$15.8 billion a year earlier and ahead of the \$18.9 billion that analysts forecast.

HSBC's solid performance reflects the payoff of its Asian focus, where an overhaul targeting **wealth** and cross-border banking drove fee income growth alongside a favourable rate backdrop.

It also caps a strong earnings season for Europe's big banks, which have extended a more than two-year-long recovery thanks to a surge in trading activity and resilient interest income despite dips in central bank rates.

HSBC lifted its guidance for net interest income for this year, saying it now expects to exceed \$46 billion, having previously said it would hit that level.

The lender announced a resumption of its share buybacks with an up to \$1 billion plan, the first since it announced late last year it was taking smaller Hong Kong lender Hang Seng Bank private.

HSBC also set a second interim dividend of \$0.1 per share, following a \$0.1 payout in May.

The half-year update from HSBC showed CEO Georges Elhedery continuing his strategy of streamlining the lender by exiting markets where it lacks scale, as the bank sold its Singapore insurance, Egypt retail banking and Australian mortgage businesses.

Wealth revenue in the first half grew 18% from a year ago, backed by strong growth from its Asian markets.

Rival Standard Chartered also announced a forecast-beating first-half profit last week, powered by a push for fee income.

Source: [Reuters](#)

[HSBC, Europe's largest bank, posted a pretax profit of \\$19.5 billion for the first six months of this year](#)

Document RTEI000020260804em840005r

Business News

HSBC chief says 'UK growth needs strong banks' after profits swell by 23%

Anna Wise

632 words

4 August 2026

standard.co.uk

NSOGL

English

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HSBC has rounded off a bumper reporting season for the UK's high street banks.

The boss of [HSBC](#) has said that "UK growth needs strong banks" after saying its profits soared by nearly a quarter this year and amid calls for the [Government](#) to raise taxes on bank earnings.

HSBC recorded a pre-tax profit of 19.5 billion US dollars (£14.5 billion) for the first six months of the year.

This was 23% higher than the same period a year ago, and above the 18.9 billion US dollars (£14.1 billion) that most analysts had been forecasting.

It rounds off a bumper reporting season for the UK's high street banks, joining Lloyds, [Barclays](#) and NatWest in recording higher profits year on year and beating analysts' expectations.

This has helped fuel renewed questions about whether the Government could choose to target banks to help raise extra revenue.

The [Trades Union Congress](#) (TUC) said the four banks generating a combined £29 billion in first-half profits meant there was a "mountain of evidence" to suggest banks could afford to pay more tax.

The union is calling for the Government to increase the corporation tax surcharge on banks, from the current rate of 3% to at least 8%, which it said would raise £9 billion over four years.

In response to questions about the potential for tax hikes, HSBC's group chief executive Georges Elhedery said: "This is a matter for the Government, but let me tell you how we're thinking about this.

"First, we're very, very encouraged by the Government's ambition to support and enable growth in the UK, which of course we have a major role to play here.

"Second, for growth to be able to manifest, you need businesses to be confident and invest.

"For businesses to invest, you need them to have access to financing and we, as the banking sector with a strong balance sheet and strong capital position, are the preferred financing mechanism for these businesses.

"So the UK growth requires strong banks."

HSBC said in its half-year financial results that it intended to launch a new share buyback of up to one billion US dollars (£740 million).

Meanwhile, the group's operating expenses went up over the first half as a result of plans to invest further in technology, and the impact of inflation.

But this was partly mitigated by cost-cutting under chief executive Mr Elhedery's drive to simplify the group, which has stripped out some 1.5 billion US dollars (£1.12 billion) worth of costs ahead of schedule.

Profit growth was driven by higher net interest income and increased fee income, particularly from its **wealth management** and banking services, according to the bank.

The rise was partly offset by higher expected credit losses which totalled 2.4 billion US dollars (£1.79 billion), including a 400 million dollar (£298 million) “fraud-related” exposure to a lender in the UK, and expected losses relating to geopolitical tensions and higher trade tariffs.

But Mr Elhedery said that the UK economy has been “outstandingly resilient throughout all the challenges we’ve seen lately”, while acknowledging the impact of the Iran war “in some of the more fragile economies” around the world.

“For the UK, what we’re watching is what this means in terms of inflation and the reaction of the Bank of England to inflation,” he said.

“But we remain very confident in the resilience of our businesses in the UK.

“We are absolutely standing ready to support any of them to continue investing for their growth ambition and, at this stage, we saw no indication that could tell us otherwise.”

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Business

HSBC launches \$1 billion share buyback after profits surge leads to calls for bigger bank taxes

Karl Matchett

797 words

4 August 2026

Independent Online

INDOP

English

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The bank said the growth was driven by higher net interest income and increased fee income

[HSBC](#) has reported a 23 per cent surge in pre-tax [profits](#) for the first half of the year, with a billion-dollar share buyback programme initialised - though that was materially smaller than most experts had anticipated.

The Trades Union Congress (TUC) have reacted to high profit reports from HSBC and the wider banking industry by calling on the government to tax those businesses accordingly.

Richard Hunter, head of markets at interactive investor, noted that a \$1bn share buyback for HSBC was in contrast to “general estimates of \$2 billion and even some punchier speculation of £3 billion” ahead of the earnings call, but that strong growth put profits before tax ahead of expectation too.

An increased focus on **wealth** development, especially in some Asian nations, is seen as key for HSBC to maintain its growth trajectory.

However, Kathleen Brooks, research director at XTB, warned that increased bank profits overall would only up the expectation on the new prime minister to put a big profits tax on heavyweight financial institutions.

“HSBC announced a second dividend for this year and a share buyback of \$1bn, to be completed in the next 3 months. The share price has risen by 10% in the past month, and a lot of good news may already be priced in,” she said.

“The share price slipped in overnight trading in the US, and HSBC could be a victim of its own success. There is political pressure on PM Andy Burnham to tax banks more, and HSBC’s results and high profit levels could add to calls for a higher levy on the sector, which could act as a counterweight to banking stocks later on Tuesday.”

And the TUC demanded some of those taxes go toward lowering energy bills for those most at risk in the UK.

“The TUC is today calling for the government to increase taxes on banks to bring down energy bills as the big four banks rake in £29bn in total profit in the first half of the year,” a statement read.

“The union body wants the government to use the money to pay for a social tariff that brings down energy bills by up to £559 a year for those on low and middle incomes.

“Currently the bank surcharge is an additional 3% [corporation tax](#) on the profits of banking companies above £100 million, which was reduced from 8% in April 2023 by the Conservatives – just as bumper profits kicked in alongside higher interest rates.

“The TUC is calling for the government to increase the surcharge to raise up to £60 billion over the next four years.”

HSBC’s interim results revealed a 3.7 billion dollar (£2.75 billion) rise in profit before tax to 19.5 billion dollars (£14.5 billion) compared with the same period last year.

The [bank](#) attributed this growth to higher net interest income and increased fee income, particularly from **wealth management** and banking services.

These gains were partially offset by higher expected credit losses and increased operating expenses.

HSBC also set a second interim dividend of \$0.1 per share, following a \$0.1 payout in May. The bank's Hong Kong-listed shares gained 0.8 per cent to HK\$169.5 after the earnings release, hitting a new high.

Group chief executive Georges Elhedery said: "HSBC is becoming the stronger bank we set out to build. We are executing our strategic priorities with pace, precision and discipline.

"This is allowing our four businesses to focus on their core strengths, grow, work together more effectively and deepen customer relationships. The result is a bank capable of achieving more."

HSBC's solid performance reflects the payoff of its Asian focus, where an overhaul targeting **wealth** and cross-border banking drove fee income growth alongside a favourable rate backdrop.

It also caps a strong earnings season for Europe's big banks, which have extended a more than two-year-long recovery thanks to a surge in trading activity and resilient interest income despite dips in central bank rates.

HSBC lifted its guidance for net interest income for this year, saying it now expects to exceed \$46 billion, having previously said it would hit that level.

The half-year update from HSBC showed CEO Georges Elhedery continuing his strategy of streamlining the lender by exiting markets where it lacks scale, as the bank sold its Singapore insurance, Egypt retail banking and Australian mortgage businesses.

Wealth revenue in the first half grew 18 per cent from a year ago, backed by strong growth from its Asian markets.

Additional reporting by PA

Document INDOP00020260804em840008d

HSBC resumes share buybacks as quarterly profits soar to \$10.1bn

Arjun Neil Alim in Hong Kong and Ortenca Aliaj in London

690 words

4 August 2026

13:39

ft.com

FTCMA

English

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Wealth management and insurance business in Hong Kong boosts Europe's biggest lender

HSBC's pre-tax profits jumped 60 per cent to \$10.1bn in the second quarter as the bank raised its target for cost savings and announced a new share buyback.

Revenues at Europe's largest lender came in at \$19.1bn in the three months to June 30, against a company-compiled analyst consensus of \$18.6bn — up 16 per cent on the same period last year.

Profits were boosted by its **wealth management** and insurance business, including in its “second-home market” of Hong Kong, where it said it onboarded 640,000 new clients across HSBC and its subsidiary Hang Seng this year.

Pre-tax profits in the second quarter last year was damped by impairment losses relating to the bank's stake in a Chinese lender, as well as restructuring costs of \$500mn.

“HSBC is becoming the stronger bank we set out to build,” said chief executive Georges Elhedery. “We’re executing our strategic priorities with pace, precision and discipline.”

Shares dipped 0.4 per cent in morning trading in London, bringing the increase this year to a third and valuing the company at £273bn.

HSBC retained its targets of a return on tangible equity of 17 per cent or higher for the next three years, and updated its banking net interest income outlook for 2026 from “around” to “at least” \$46bn.

Profits were up across HSBC's four businesses, with Hong Kong and international **wealth** and premier banking both delivering double-digit growth.

Wealth revenues rose 22 per cent in the second quarter from a year earlier to \$2.8bn, while wholesale transaction banking revenues were up 7 per cent at \$3bn.

The share buyback worth up to \$1bn is the first since the bank last year announced a deal to take Hang Seng Bank private. It also planned to pay a second interim dividend of \$0.10 per share.

The bank raised its target for savings from its restructuring from \$1.5bn to \$2bn annualised by the end of this year, and recognised an additional \$200mn of costs in the quarter relating to Elhedery's plans to simplify operations.

HSBC also warned its costs may increase if it allowed “additional performance-related pay” on the back of strong business performance. Analysts at Citi responded by warning that higher costs were not factored into existing consensus estimates.

Expected credit losses for the quarter stood at \$1.1bn, in line with the previous year and analyst expectations, with an additional \$400mn set aside for risky loans related to the Hong Kong commercial real estate sector.

Provisions for wholesale banking were \$1.6bn, which HSBC attributed to “fraud-related, secondary, securitisation exposure with a financial sponsor in the UK”. In May the FT reported that HSBC had exposure to collapsed mortgage lender Market Financial Solutions through Apollo's asset-backed lending unit Atlas SP.

The higher provisions also reflected an uptick for “mid-market clients across the globe”, said Pam Kaur, HSBC’s chief financial officer.

HSBC has continued its drive to simplify operations and reduced the number of managing director positions by 15 per cent between October 2024 and June 2026.

It announced the sale of its \$25.3bn Australian mortgage and personal loan book to a Blackstone-backed group last month and sold its Singapore insurance business to Allianz for \$2.1bn — which the bank said would net it a pre-tax gain of \$1.8bn.

Last month the FT also reported that HSBC had begun to market risky loans made by Hang Seng Bank to investors, in an early sign of how it intends to overhaul the Hong Kong lender after taking full control at the start of this year.

On Andy Burnham taking over as prime minister and the potential for higher taxes on banks, Elhedery said: “We’re very, very encouraged by the government’s ambition to support and enable growth in the UK. UK growth requires strong banks.”

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market

HSBC Holdings resumes buybacks, increases cost savings as profit beats estimates

CNBCTV18.com

292 words

4 August 2026

CNBC TV18

CNBCTV

English

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HSBC Holdings Plc has announced a stock buyback and increased its cost-cutting target while it reported its second quarter results which beat expectations despite China's crackdown on cross-border **wealth** flows.

The lender will repurchase up to \$1 billion in stock post pretax profit for the June quarter rising to \$10.1 billion, surpassing a company-piled consensus estimate of \$9.5 billion. The earnings were bolstered by notable items with gains in **wealth** revenue and banking.

HSBC CEO Georges Elhedery said that the lender is executing its strategic priorities with pace, precision and discipline. This is allowing its four businesses to focus on their core strengths, work and grow together more effectively and also deepen customer relationships, the CEO added, Bloomberg reported.

The resumption of stock repurchases comes after a pause was announced in October last year, when the lender signaled it would stop buybacks for around three quarters to accommodate its \$15 billion deal to take Hang Seng Bank private.

The HSBC stock has touched fresh all time highs in recent weeks, rebounding from a slump in June triggered by Beijing's clampdown on cross-border capital flows that had stoked concerns among investors over potential friction in its **wealth management** unit.

HSBC's **wealth** inflows slowed to \$25 billion in the June quarter from \$39 billion in the first three months. However, the same was flat in comparison to the year-ago period.

The bank's provisions came in at \$1.1 billion, which included charges related to the Hong Kong commercial real estate sector, while it upgraded its banking net interest income guidance to at least \$46 billion for 2026.

With inputs from Bloomberg

Document CNBCTV0020260804em84000e3

Business News

HSBC first-half profits surge by 23% to £19.5 billion

Jessica Coates

192 words

4 August 2026

standard.co.uk

NSONL

English

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[HSBC](#) saw pre-tax profits for the first half of the year increased by 23%, the bank has revealed.

Interim results reported a 3.7 billion dollar (£2.75 billion) rise in profit before tax to 19.5 billion dollars (£14.5 billion) compared with the same period last year.

The bank said the growth was driven by higher net interest income and increased fee income, particularly from its **wealth management** and banking services.

The rise was partly offset by higher expected credit losses and increased operating expenses.

HSBC also announced it would resume share buybacks with a planned buyback of up to one billion dollars (£744.8 million), the first since the Hang Seng Bank privatisation announced in October.

Group chief executive Georges Elhedery said: "HSBC is becoming the stronger bank we set out to build. We are executing our strategic priorities with pace, precision and discipline.

"This is allowing our four businesses to focus on their core strengths, grow, work together more effectively and deepen customer relationships. The result is a bank capable of achieving more."

Document NSONL00020260804em8400001

TECHNOLOGY

DBS COO's most important tip for AI transformation: Lead with 'why'

Lionel Lim

1,064 words

4 August 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

print

A18

English

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Derrick Goh, DBS' first-ever group chief operating officer (COO), is leading the execution of the bank's artificial intelligence strategy.

"Data quality, data governance, responsible AI and proper controls are critical if we want to scale with AI safely and responsibly... The stronger our governance foundations, the more confidently we can scale."

Derrick Goh

A recent milestone was the roll-out of an agentic AI assistant to all its corporate clients in Singapore, with plans to expand into Hong Kong and other key markets in the coming months.

Scaling up the capabilities of this assistant, named DBS Joy, and a transformed call centre are two outcomes Goh is proud of – mostly because they directly benefit the bank's customers.

Since becoming group COO in April 2025, Goh has spearheaded an initiative to redesign how work gets done using AI, translating strategy into tangible results.

"Transformation is key to adapt, compete and establish a competitive advantage," he told The Business Times during his first one-on-one interview with Singapore media in his current role.

While driving transformation is nothing new for Goh, who has been in the financial services industry since 1997, this time the changes he is executing involve leveraging the latest AI advancements to ensure the bank stays ahead in a rapidly evolving technological landscape.

For Goh, the journey starts with being able to explain the "why".

"You can't drive change alone, and (transformation) can't be a dictate because it's a team effort; everyone is a key piece," he said.

Emphasising that clarity is "critical", he added. "When people are convinced, they will come along and also be able to bring different perspectives."

Under Goh's leadership, DBS leveraged AI applications to upgrade its call centre's capabilities.

Chatbots are now able to resolve routine customer queries in a natural language format, which has reduced the amount of calls operators need to handle. For more complex requests, the bank has invested in co-pilot assistants to aid call centre operators.

DBS has also integrated its consumer and corporate call centres into a single operation with AI. The bank said it transitioned all its call centre operators into new or upgraded roles after the transformation.

For Goh, the call centre is just one illustration of how the latest AI advancements can streamline operations and increase employee proficiency.

Importantly, it started with leadership explaining the "why" behind the shift.

A pioneering path

Goh, 58, did not begin his career in banking. He spent three years at the American confectionery Mars Wrigley before moving to American Express where he spent 11 years, during which he was mostly based in Paris, London and New York.

"Different perspectives matter," Goh said, reflecting on how his time abroad influenced his leadership style. "When there are issues or challenges, different perspectives need to be taken into account when coming up with a solution."

He returned to Singapore and started at DBS in 2008, the year before former CEO Piyush Gupta joined the bank and two years before current CEO Tan Su Shan.

At DBS, Goh held several leadership positions ranging from consumer banking to audit. By the time he was approached for the newly created group COO role, he felt confident to step in.

"This role is about connecting the dots and driving the transformation," he said. "Piyush brought us to a stage where we were the best digital bank, and so the question is how do we do even better?"

As group COO, Goh oversees operations, transformation and data, as well as marketing and communications. He sees himself as a "midfielder" in football parlance, executing the coach's vision on the field and orchestrating the plays from the strategy book.

His strategy for leading DBS' AI transformation is influenced by those early lessons on perspective, as well as two trips he took earlier this year.

In February, the bank's senior leadership and board travelled to Silicon Valley, where they were struck by the sheer acceleration of innovation, from individual AI models to agentic AI capable of reasoning, planning and executing tasks.

Then in May, he visited China and was impressed with how quickly organisations had scaled AI adoption.

Goh's takeaway was that since Singapore and DBS are not tied to a particular system, the bank's approach should be to learn from and adopt the best practices from both East and West.

That view mirrors his own career path; working in globalised cities around the world allowed him to absorb the best practices from the different cultures he interacted with.

Now, as group COO, he is encouraging DBS' employees to explore opportunities in the bank's international operations, as he believes the human capital investments will augment the bank's AI investments.

"When you move overseas, you move out of your comfort zone. It's a good time to learn new cultures, and absorb and learn what's out there."

Leveraging artificial intelligence

With Tan championing AI's critical role, Goh sees it as his job to ensure the bank can redesign workflows with the aid of AI applications or pursue new opportunities that are now made possible because of technology.

For him, the bank's 11 ongoing enterprise-wide transformation initiatives reflect its belief that real opportunity lies in enabling human-AI collaboration and reimagining how work is done.

For example, DBS' plan to accumulate more than S\$1 trillion in assets under management across its retail and **wealth** segments by 2030 is being boosted by AI, with enhanced portfolio tools augmenting advisers and digital assistants better supporting mass-market clients.

While Goh is passionate about leveraging AI advancements to accelerate certain objectives, speed is not the only priority. He is also involved in ensuring that the bank scales its AI use responsibly.

"Data quality, data governance, responsible AI and proper controls are critical if we want to scale with AI safely and responsibly," he said. "The stronger our governance foundations, the more confidently we can scale."

As DBS adopts more agentic AI tools, Goh is overseeing the development of an internal "Agentic Control Plane". This framework provides full oversight of the bank's AI ecosystem, allowing teams to track every AI agent and ensure it operates strictly within defined guard rails.

Document STBT000020260804em8400003

Top Stories

Firmer rates, loan growth and **wealth** gains seen lifting Singapore banks' Q2 results

Tan Nai Lun
1,026 words
4 August 2026
Business Times Singapore
STBT
print
A1
English
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Singapore's banks are expected to report resilient second-quarter earnings this week, buoyed by higher interest rates, robust loan growth and strong **wealth management** income.

For Jonathan Koh, director of research at UOB Kay Hian, the banks will likely post strong double-digit growth in **wealth management** fees for Q2, accentuated by a low base in the same period last year.

Investors will be watching for signs that pressure on net interest margins (NIMs) has yet to fully ease and whether earnings momentum can be sustained in the second half of 2026, said analysts.

DBS kicks off the reporting season on Aug 6, followed by OCBC and UOB on Aug 7.

Industry watchers expect to see a slowdown in margin compression after Singapore interest rates rose for the second consecutive month in June, while lending growth remained strong.

At the same time, buoyant equity markets and volatile trading conditions should support non-interest income through **wealth management** and treasury activities, they added.

NIMs, loan growth in focus

Singapore's three-month Singapore Overnight Rate Average (Sora) was up one basis point on month to 1.07 per cent in June.

This was after six quarters during which flushed Singapore dollar liquidity and persistent belief in US dollar weakness kept front-end Singdollar rates low, said DBS Group Research analyst Lim Rui Wen.

This could slow the quarter-on-quarter decline in NIMs, although she cautions that the trend is "not yet over".

For Glenn Thum, research manager at Phillip Securities Research, the "single most important line" to watch is how NIMs fare against what the banks have guided.

Specifically, he noted that UOB had previously guided its 2026 NIM to be 1.75 to 1.80 per cent, but already reported a 1.82 per cent NIM in the first quarter.

"Any beat there resets the whole sector narrative," he said.

Loan growth in the local banking system was also strong in the second quarter.

In May, Singapore's banking system loans grew 8.7 per cent on year, which could lead to the banks raising their loan growth guidance, Thum said.

Thilan Wickramasinghe, head of Singapore research and regional financials at Maybank Investment Banking Group, added: "We will be watching how this has translated into market share for each bank and looking for indicators on the sustainability of this momentum."

Still, analysts cautioned against being overly optimistic.

Thum warned that a US rate hike will likely come because of reignited concerns of oil-driven inflation, which will result in slower loan growth and higher credit cost.

Citi analyst Tan Yong Hong also said markets may have been “euphoric” in pricing in NIM upside from the recent Sora rebound, noting that Singapore continues to have excess liquidity while spot Sora has since gone down.

Tan expects the banks will guide for asset yield pressure, given that they have limited room to reprice their cost of funds lower.

He sees greater downside risks for UOB and OCBC than DBS, which has given consistent guidance. He has a “buy” call on DBS.

He downgraded his call on OCBC to “neutral” on Jul 30, noting that its growth prospects are largely priced in.

Earlier in July, he also put a 30-day downside catalyst watch on UOB, as he expects the market had been “overly optimistic” on a turnaround of UOB’s non-interest income and asset quality.

Non-interest income “heavy lifting”

Analysts also expect non-interest income to provide a meaningful boost to earnings in the second quarter.

Maybank’s Wickramasinghe expects non-interest income to “do some heavy lifting” while DBS’ Lim said that the low cost of funding and ongoing volatility likely supported markets trading revenue.

Strong equity markets are also likely to support growth in **wealth** assets under management (AUM) alongside net new money inflows, Lim added.

Thum noted that the opportunity with **wealth** income is that it carries “little credit risk and spills over into treasury and bancassurance”.

But the risk is that fee income is a leveraged bet on markets, so a risk-asset drawdown would hit it hard, he said.

Wickramasinghe flagged that investors should pay attention to how much client **wealth** has been deployed into investments rather than remaining in cash, as that would provide a better gauge of underlying client sentiment, rather than just safe-haven demand.

For Jonathan Koh, director of research at UOB Kay Hian, the banks will likely post strong double-digit growth in **wealth management** fees for Q2, accentuated by a low base in the same period last year.

However, the banks may “tone down their expectations” on growth in **wealth management** for the rest of 2026, due to the recent pullback in technology stocks and the “on-and-off” nature of the Middle East conflict.

Even so, Koh has an “overweight” call on the banking sector, noting that the banks “deserve to trade at a premium for their structural resilience”.

He added that the sustainability of the banks’ dividend payouts is supported by their resilient earnings, strong capital adequacy and discipline in capital management.

Lim also noted that Singapore banks continue to benefit from robust dividend yields and strong investor sentiment, though she remains watchful on asset quality.

In particular, UOB will likely continue to be weighed by its higher quarter-on-quarter operating expenses, as well as its exposure to commercial real estate loans, Lim said.

DBS has a “buy” call on OCBC and “hold” on UOB.

Phillip’s Thum added that one-off gains from asset sales could possibly flatter UOB’s headline earnings.

Thum previously upgraded his call on the sector to “accumulate” from “neutral”, citing stronger-than-expected loan growth, bottoming rates and attractive dividends yields.

At market close on Monday (Aug 3), DBS gained 0.6 per cent or S\$0.43 at S\$74.45, OCBC fell 0.9 per cent or S\$0.26 to S\$28.87, and UOB lost 0.8 per cent or S\$0.36 at S\$43.04.

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INDUSTRY SNAPSHOTS - UNITED KINGDOM BANKING 3 AUG 26_EN

10,905 words

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Acquisdata Global Industry SnapShot Online

ACQIND

English

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LATEST COMPANY NEWS

This Week's News

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HSBC Holdings Plc has held early talks to offload billions of pounds in UK pension assets after being approached by insurers, according to people familiar with the matter.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-07-30/hsbc-weighs-offloading-billions-in-uk-pension-assets-to-insurer>

Reuters - Lloyds reports first-half profit up 23%, outlines AI-driven cost-cutting plans - 30/7/2026

Lloyds Banking Group (LLOY.L), opens new tab reported a better than expected statutory pretax profit of £4.3 billion for the first half of 2026, as CEO Charlie Nunn also outlined the lender's next plan to grow its core businesses and harness technology such as AI to cut costs.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.reuters.com/business/finance/lloyds-reports-first-half-profit-up-23-outlines-new-strategy-2026-07-30/>

Financial Times - Standard Chartered launches \$1bn buyback as bank embraces AI - 30/7/2026

Standard Chartered has announced a \$1bn share buyback and higher quarterly profit as the Asia-focused UK lender embarks on a cost-cutting programme to...

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Reuters - EXCLUSIVE: NatWest had funded failed consumer lender with up to £250 million, filings show - 24/7/2026

Financial Times - HSBC sells Singapore insurance business to Allianz for \$2.1bn - 24/7/2026

Bloomberg - BOE Bond Sales Decision Complicated by Burnham Yield Surge - 24/7/2026

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HSBC Holdings plc (LSE: HSBA, NYSE: HSBC) - HSBC agrees to sell Egypt retail banking business to Emirates NBD - 2/8/2026

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Challenges of Nigerian Fintech Startups Expanding into the United Kingdom By Ahmed, Ali

Overviews of Leading Companies

Atom Bank

Barclays plc (LSE: BARC)

HSBC Holdings plc (LSE: HSBA, NYSE: HSBC)

Lloyds Banking Group (LSE: LLOY)

OneSavings Bank (LSE: OSB)

Royal Bank of Scotland Group plc (LSE: RBS, NYSE: RBS)

Standard Chartered plc (LSE: STAN)

Secure Trust Bank (LSE: STB)

Virgin Money UK plc (LSE: VMUK, ASX: VUK)

Associate: Laura Eva

News and Commentary

Bloomberg.com - HSBC Weighs Offloading Billions in UK Pension Assets to Insurer - 30/7/2026

HSBC Holdings Plc has held early talks to offload billions of pounds in UK pension assets after being approached by insurers, according to people familiar with the matter.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-07-30/hsbc-weighs-offloading-billions-in-uk-pension-assets-to-insurer>

Reuters - Lloyds reports first-half profit up 23%, outlines AI-driven cost-cutting plans - 30/7/2026

Lloyds Banking Group (LLOY.L), opens new tab reported a better than expected statutory pretax profit of £4.3 billion for the first half of 2026, as CEO Charlie Nunn also outlined the lender's next plan to grow its core businesses and harness technology such as AI to cut costs.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.reuters.com/business/finance/lloyds-reports-first-half-profit-up-23-outlines-new-strategy-2026-07-30/>

Financial Times - Standard Chartered launches \$1bn buyback as bank embraces AI - 30/7/2026

Standard Chartered has announced a \$1bn share buyback and higher quarterly profit as the Asia-focused UK lender embarks on a cost-cutting programme to...

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.ft.com/content/e0153a16-aa0a-4d01-8614-9d332aa86690?syn-25a6b1a6=1>

Bloomberg.com - Barclays Equities Traders and Investment Bankers Beat Estimates - 28/7/2026

Barclays Plc's investment bank disappointed shareholders after a quarter of record profits for its larger American rivals, sending the London-based lender's shares down by the most in more than a year.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-07-28/barclays-equities-traders-and-investment-bankers-beat-estimates>

Bloomberg.com - Barclays Trading Boss Hunts for Growth Against Wall Street Giants - 24/7/2026

Every few months the most senior traders and salespeople at Barclays Plc head to a one-hour meeting with their boss Adeel Khan.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-07-24/barclays-trading-boss-seeks-to-deliver-growth-in-volatile-markets>

Reuters - EXCLUSIVE: NatWest had funded failed consumer lender with up to £250 million, filings show - 24/7/2026

Britain's NatWest helped fund London-based consumer credit firm Amplifi Capital with up to £250 million (\$333 million) in the years before.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.reuters.com/business/finance/natwest-had-funded-failed-consumer-lender-with-up-250-million-filings-show-2026-07-24/>

Financial Times - HSBC sells Singapore insurance business to Allianz for \$2.1bn - 24/7/2026

Deal is latest example of lender's 'ongoing simplification' under Georges Elhedery.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.ft.com/content/1bd022f7-1c96-49a1-addb-1128c2975515?syn-25a6b1a6=1>

Bloomberg - BOE Bond Sales Decision Complicated by Burnham Yield Surge - 24/7/2026

Only last month, Andrew Bailey again insisted quantitative tightening is here to stay. The Bank of England governor has been adamant the UK.

For the complete story, see:

<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-07-24/boe-bond-sales-decision-burnham-yield-surge>

Media Releases

HSBC Holdings plc (LSE: HSBA, NYSE: HSBC) - HSBC agrees to sell Egypt retail banking business to Emirates NBD - 2/8/2026

* Sale expected to generate an estimated pre-tax gain of approximately US\$0.3 billion

* Egypt remains important market for HSBC Corporate and Institutional Banking with strong growth potential

HSBC Holdings plc ('HSBC' or 'HSBC Group') today announces that its indirect subsidiary, HSBC Bank Egypt S.A.E. ('HSBC Egypt'), has entered into an agreement to sell its retail banking business to Emirates NBD Egypt (S.A.E) ('Emirates NBD'), a direct subsidiary of Emirates NBD Bank PJSC, a leading banking group in the region. The sale is expected to complete in the second half of 2027, subject to regulatory approvals.

The transaction covers the assets and liabilities of HSBC Egypt's entire retail banking business, including retail loans, deposits and accounts, as well as the employees supporting the transferring business. There are no immediate changes for HSBC Egypt's retail customers and their HSBC products and services will continue to operate as normal. Both parties will work together to enable a smooth transition for colleagues and customers.

HSBC Group financial impact

The sale is expected to generate an estimated pre-tax gain for the HSBC Group¹ of approximately US\$0.3 billion², to be recognised largely at completion and classified as a material notable item³. The sale is expected to have an immaterial impact on the HSBC Group Common Equity Tier 1 capital ratio.⁴

HSBC's strategic focus in Egypt

Egypt remains an important market for HSBC with strong growth potential, and the bank will continue to support its corporate and institutional banking clients in the country. HSBC is committed to driving two-way trade and investment flows to support multinational clients operating in Egypt and enabling domestic wholesale clients to achieve their international ambitions.

The sale follows a strategic review of HSBC Egypt's retail banking business, announced last year, and forms part of ongoing simplification of the HSBC Group as it focuses on increasing leadership and market share in the areas where it has a clear competitive advantage and the greatest opportunities to grow and support its clients.

<https://www.hsbc.com/news-and-views/news/media-releases/2026/hsbc-agrees-to-sell-egypt-retail-banking-business-to-emirates-nbd>

Standard Chartered plc (LSE: STAN) - Standard Chartered releases Second Quarter and Half Year 2026 Results - 29/7/2026

We've released our financial results for the first half and second quarter ended 30 June 2026.

For more details, please visit our Investor Relations section.

All figures are presented on a reported basis and comparisons are made to 2025 on a constant currency basis, unless otherwise stated.

Bill Winters, Group Chief Executive, said:

"We delivered a record first-half performance in 2026, with double-digit growth in **Wealth** Solutions and Global Banking. Our performance demonstrates the strength of our differentiated international network and the disciplined execution of our strategy. Clients continue to turn to us to facilitate trade, investment and **wealth** flows across the world's most dynamic markets. We delivered a 17 per cent increase in our earnings per share, and our upgraded income guidance and new share buyback of USD1 billion reflect our confidence in the business."

Manus Costello, Group Chief Financial Officer, said:

"We are now compounding the growth of our powerful franchise while investing to build a simpler, faster and more connected bank that meets the evolving needs of our clients. At the same time, we remain disciplined on expenses and focused on managing capital tightly.

Together, these strengths give us confidence in our ability to deliver exceptional growth and sustainably higher returns."

Selected information on H1'26 financial performance with comparisons to H1'25 unless otherwise stated

- * Record operating income up 6 per cent to USD11.6 billion, up 8 per cent excluding the Solv India transaction
- * Net interest income¹ (NII) up 4 per cent to USD5.7 billion; Non-interest income¹ up 8 per cent to USD5.9 billion
- * **Wealth** Solutions up 38 per cent, driven by strong growth in investment products
- * Global Banking up 19 per cent, driven by strong origination activity and strong capital market activity
- * Operating expenses up 1 per cent to USD6.3 billion, up 2 per cent excluding notables²
- * Credit impairment charge of USD446 million with USD296 million from **Wealth** & Retail Banking (WRB) and USD150 million from Corporate & Investment Banking (CIB) mostly driven by management overlays relating to the Middle East conflict
- * Record profit before tax of USD4.8 billion, up 9 per cent
- * Tax charge of USD1.1 billion; effective tax rate of 23.3 per cent
- * Return on Tangible Equity (RoTE) of 17.6 per cent, up 120bps
- * Earnings per share increased 17 per cent to 151.6 cents

Selected information of Q2'26 financial performance with comparisons to Q2'25 unless otherwise stated

- * Operating income of USD5.7 billion up 3 per cent
- * Excluding USD238 million gain on the Solv India transaction in Q2'25, income is up 8 per cent
- * NII1 up 7 per cent to USD2.9 billion; driven by volumes and improved balance sheet mix
- * Non-interest income1 of USD2.8 billion was broadly flat, up 9 per cent excluding the Solv India transaction; driven by continued momentum in **Wealth** Solutions and Global Banking
- * **Wealth** Solutions up 43 per cent, mostly driven by strong double-digit growth in Investment Products
- * Global Banking up 18 per cent, driven by strong origination activity and increased capital markets activity
- * Operating expenses were broadly flat, up 3 per cent excluding a notable item of USD74 million release of provisions on Korea equity-linked securities (ELS) portfolio
- * Credit impairment charge of USD150 million up USD31 million. WRB charge of USD116 million down USD49 million mainly from portfolio actions. CIB charge of USD39 million was up USD78 million mostly from management overlays partly offset by releases
- * Profit before tax of USD2.3 billion, up 2 per cent
- * RoTE of 17.9 per cent, broadly flat
- * Balance sheet remains strong, liquid and well diversified with underlying loans and advances to customers up 2.2 per cent and underlying customer deposits up 2 per cent quarter-on-quarter
- * Risk-weighted assets (RWA) of USD261.5 billion, down USD4.7 billion since 31.3.26; Credit risk RWA down USD3.4 billion, Market RWA down USD1.4 billion, and Operational RWA flat
- * The Group remains strongly capitalised with Common Equity Tier 1 (CET1) ratio of 14.2 per cent up 77bps quarter-on-quarter
- * USD1 billion share buyback starting imminently is expected to reduce CET1 ratio by 38bps
- * Interim ordinary dividend increased 66 per cent to 20.4 cents per share (USD448 million)
- * Tangible net asset value per share of USD17.55, up 4 per cent

Guidance

Our revised 2026 guidance is as follows:

- * Operating income growth year-on-year to be around the middle of the 5-7 per cent range at constant currency and excluding material notable2 items
- * Within which, net interest income1 expected to be low single digit percentage growth year-on-year at constant currency
- * Expenses excluding notables2 expected to be around USD13.3 billion at constant currency
- * RoTE to be greater than 12 per cent.

<https://www.sc.com/en/press-release/half-year-2026-results/>

Latest Research

Challenges of Nigerian Fintech Startups Expanding into the United Kingdom

Ahmed, Ali

Abstract

The study uses a qualitative approach based solely on secondary data. Sources include academic articles, publications from the Financial Conduct Authority and Bank of England, industry reports, and company documents. Four Nigerian fintech firms: Kuda Bank, PalmPay, Paystack, and Kora are examined as cases. The

Page 96 of 144 © 2026 Factiva, Inc. All rights reserved.

analysis applies population ecology theory, resource-based view, and internationalization theory, alongside PESTEL, Porter's Five Forces, SWOT, and Bowman's Strategy Clock.

The findings show that Nigerian fintech possess useful strengths: solid technical abilities, cost effective products, and experience reaching unbanked people. However, these strengths alone do not guarantee success. Four entry pathways emerge: using the FCA Regulatory Sandbox, partnering with UK licensed firms, focusing on the Nigerian diaspora niche, or starting with a narrow remittance licence.

The study concludes that fitting into the UK regulatory environment matters more than technological strength. The findings support population ecology theory, extend the resource based view by highlighting diaspora ties as a strategic asset, and challenge the Uppsala model's step by step entry assumptions.

<https://www.theseus.fi/handle/10024/929343>

The Industry

U.K. Banking Outlook 2025 Entering The Year With Solid Earnings And Balance Sheets

Key Takeaways

- Our stable outlooks on all U.K. bank ratings show that we expect banks to remain resilient over 2025, possibly with limited positive rating actions over the medium term if a more supportive economic outlook and banks' controlled credit risk appetites lead to an improvement in our BICRA economic risk trend.
- Strong earnings driven by stable margins should allow rated U.K. banks to maintain their robust capital positions and prioritize distributions via share buybacks and special dividends.
- Despite mixed reactions to the government's autumn budget, we think the U.K. economy will deliver steady growth in 2025* on the back of expected rate cuts and a strong labour market. These factors should support banks' loan growth and asset quality.
- We expect credit loss charges to normalize for banks, with a steady but manageable flow of lending into arrears and overall cost of risk increasing toward the long-run average.
- Historical motor finance commissions remediation could dent earnings and shareholder distributions for rated banks with material exposures, but we expect minimal impact on their capital ratios.
- We expect rated banks' funding and liquidity metrics to remain stable as deposit migration slows and central bank borrowing is refinanced using existing liquidity and limited wholesale issuance

Our Ratings On U.K. Banks

- The outlooks on all our U.K. bank ratings are currently stable and we see stable trends for economic and industry risk under our U.K. Banking Industry Country Risk Assessment (BICRA).
- Bank fundamentals remain solid, including healthy capital levels, good liquidity, and contained credit losses.
- We could consider positively revising our BICRA economic risk trend and certain outlooks on rated banks, in the medium term, if the economic outlook is more favorable and inflation remains low, while the banking system maintains a controlled credit risk appetite.
- Conversely, we could selectively take negative rating actions if downside risks to the economy crystallize, triggering a materially sharper asset quality deterioration than we currently expect.

Source: S&P Global

https://www.spglobal.com/_assets/documents/ratings/research/101611959.pdf

Banking in the United Kingdom (UK) - statistics & facts

The banking industry in the UK has witnessed notable developments and trends in recent years, reflecting changes in banking system efficiency, structural transformations such as the declining number of bank branches, and shifts in consumer behavior toward online banking.

Banking system efficiency fluctuated, with total assets decreasing in 2023 following substantial growth in 2022. HSBC remains a global banking leader, holding over 2.4 trillion British pounds in assets as of 2024. The sector demonstrated resilience as primary capital ratios, after declining sharply in early 2022, stabilized by year-end and maintained that stability through 2023-2024, indicating confidence in the industry's strength. These developments have occurred alongside two major structural trends: the continued reduction in physical bank branches and the increasing prominence of digital banking solutions.

Branching out: the decline of traditional banking spaces

The UK banking sector has experienced significant structural changes over the past five years, marked by a considerable decrease in the number of credit institutions and physical bank branches, with the latter nearly halving in number. This trend extends beyond the UK, reflecting a broader European pattern where bank branches declined from approximately 206,000 to 129,000 between 2012 and 2023. Driving this transformation is the remarkable growth in online banking adoption. UK online banking usage has nearly doubled between 2009 and 2023, fundamentally altering consumer banking habits. Mobile and online platforms have now become the predominant channels for conducting banking activities. This digital shift has fundamentally reshaped the banking landscape, prompting financial institutions to consolidate and close physical locations as they adapt their service delivery models to align with customers' evolving preferences and behaviors.

Digital banking boom: customer surge amid profit struggle

Some of Europe's largest digital banks are based in the UK, including Revolut, Wise, Monzo, Starling, and Monese. Among them, Revolut stands out with the largest customer base, boasting 50 million user base worldwide. The majority of its users are in the UK, which also accounts for most of its downloads. While these digital banks have seen significant growth in their customer bases, profitability remains a challenge. Revolut reported its first profit in 2021, followed by Starling Bank in 2022 and Monzo in 2024. However, Atom Bank and Monese continue to report losses, underscoring the financial hurdles many digital banks face despite their increasing popularity and adoption.

The UK banking sector continues to evolve, shaped by digital adoption, structural consolidation, and shifting profitability dynamics. While traditional banks streamline operations and reduce branch networks, digital banks are expanding their customer bases, though many still face financial hurdles. The industry's resilience is evident in stable capital ratios and the presence of global leaders like HSBC. As online banking cements itself as the dominant channel, the future of UK banking will likely be defined by the balance between digital innovation and sustainable profitability. This text provides general information. Statista assumes no liability for the information given being complete or correct. Due to varying update cycles, statistics can display more up-to-date data than referenced in the text.

Source: Statista Research Department

<https://www.statista.com/topics/11974/banking-industry-in-the-uk/#topicOverview>

Financial services

The UK has one of the most open, innovative and dynamic financial services sectors in the world.

The UK is a global centre for finance. Companies can benefit from an exceptional business environment, regulatory and government support, physical and digital connectivity and highly skilled international talent. The government is aiming to make the UK open and competitive, at the cutting-edge of technology and innovation, and a world leader in green finance.

Opportunity highlights

Islamic finance

The UK is the leading Western centre for Islamic finance, ranking first among non-Muslim majority nations for Islamic finance. The UK has bolstered its position in this sector by issuing its second sovereign Sukuk in 2021. Investors can take advantage of one of the world's most attractive regulatory and tax environments for Islamic finance.

The UK has put in place a fiscal and regulatory framework intended to broaden the market for Islamic financial products. This includes the removal of double tax and extension of tax relief on Islamic mortgages and the reform of arrangements for issues of debt.

Fintech

The UK accounts for 11% of the global fintech industry. It is home to an estimated 2,500 fintech firms, with 6 of the top 10 fintech companies headquartered in London. It's at the cutting-edge of fintech innovation taking the lead in areas such as payment technology (Paytech), **wealth** technology (Wealthtech) and more.

The Fintech Pledge demonstrates government and industry commitment to accelerating the growth of the UK fintech sector. It establishes globally leading standards for efficient and transparent commercial partnerships between banks and fintech firms.

Environmental, Social, and Corporate Governance (ESG) and Green Finance

The UK is a leading centre for sustainable finance with London, ranking first in the Global Green Finance Index. The market for Environment, Social and Governance (ESG) investments in the UK has grown dramatically.

In 2020, the value of responsible investment (RI) funds under management almost doubled to £55 billion from the previous year. On the London Stock Exchange, there are 260 sustainability-related bonds from 23 countries, over 180 ESG Indexes and over 150 Green Funds and Exchange Traded Funds (ETFs).

The UK will become the first country in the world to make Task Force on Climate-Related Financial Disclosure (TCFD) - aligned disclosures mandatory across the economy from April 2022. The new requirements will help investors and businesses to better understand the financial impacts of their exposure to climate change, and price climate-related risks more accurately.

Capital markets

The London Stock Exchange is one of the world's most international capital markets and the destination of choice for both international firms and international investors. It accounts for 43% of global foreign exchange trading and is the leading centre for international bond trading with around 79% of global secondary market turnover.

Between 2014 to 2018, UK companies raised £750 billion in the bond, equity and leveraged loan market – almost half the total amount banks lent to all UK companies over the same period.

The UK is also the world's largest asset management centre outside the US with £8.5 trillion of assets under management. London is also an important destination for global asset managers seeking to attract international investors to their own products and services. These span all the main asset classes, including equities, fixed income and property, as well as a wide range of alternative investments.

Commercial maturity

The UK is an important and innovative financial services hub. It's the world's largest centre for international debt issuance, commercial (re)insurance and foreign exchange trading.

The UK is also the world's leading net exporter of financial services, generating an industry trade surplus of £63.7 billion in 2020.

A new chapter for financial services sets out the UK government's vision for an open, green and technologically advanced financial services sector that is globally competitive.

Key UK assets

The UK's time zone makes it easy to do business with major markets to both the east and west within the working day.

One in 14 UK workers (2.3 million in total) are employed in financial and related professional services, and 2 out of 3 of these jobs are outside of London.

Important financial centres across the UK include:

- * Edinburgh and Glasgow in Scotland
- * Birmingham, Bristol, Leeds, Liverpool, Manchester and Sheffield in England
- * Cardiff in Wales

* Belfast in Northern Ireland

The UK's technology ecosystem is supported by expertise in artificial intelligence (AI) and cyber security. This system and knowledge have helped create a successful digital transformation of financial services operations and allow businesses to remain competitive in the market.

FinTech Bridge agreements with other fintech hubs including Singapore, South Korea, China, Hong Kong, and Australia create valuable opportunities for expansion and collaboration by reducing barriers to entry to international markets.

The Green Finance Institute champions the UK's green finance brand internationally. It brings together global practitioners to design sector-specific solutions that channel money towards an environmentally sustainable economy.

R&D capability

The UK's business schools have some of the world's best MBA programmes. In 2021, 9 UK programmes made the Financial Times Global MBA's ranking of the 100 best full-time MBA programmes worldwide.

Financial and professional services firms in the UK have access to a large pool of highly qualified talent. In 2018 to 2019, 184,155 students graduated across business, finance and accounting, computer and mathematical sciences studies. The Financial Services Skills Commission works with the UK financial services sector to ensure that it has the talent and skills it needs for the future.

Business and government support

The UK financial services sector benefits from a supportive regulatory regime. The Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) work to build a competitive and innovation-friendly business environment.

Key initiatives include the creation of the:

- * FCA's Regulatory Sandbox

- * Global Financial Innovation Network (GFIN)

- * Open Banking framework

The UK Financial Services Act 2021 represents a major milestone in shaping the regulatory and legislative framework of the UK's post-Brexit financial services landscape.

The City of London Corporation works to strengthen the UK's competitiveness as the world's leading global hub for financial services. It runs The Global City to showcase the UK's offer.

Source:Business.gov.uk

<https://www.business.gov.uk/invest-in-uk/investment/sectors/financial-services/>

Leading Companies

Atom Bank

We're all about making a difference

Whether you want to make the most of your savings, apply for a mortgage or take out a loan for your business, we provide simple, secure products that can make a difference.

Man smiling looking away from phone

We've created a bank that's changing things for the better. We want to improve things for our customers, our people and the world around us, while changing the industry for good.

What's the story?

We were founded in 2014 as the UK's first app-based bank and were the country's first digital-only bank to be granted a regulatory licence.

We're based in the North East of England and we love the region for its culture, energy and sense of community, so we strive to add value wherever we can.

We've grown to a team of over 470 people, many of whom are based in the area. As a progressive employer, we understand the benefits of enabling a diverse bunch of people to shape our business, so we're actively making it easier for individuals from a range of backgrounds to work for us.

<https://www.atombank.co.uk/about-us/>

Barclays plc (LSE: BARC)

Our strategy

We have a clear plan to improve our operational and financial performance, and improve total shareholder returns. To do so, over the next three years we will make Barclays Simpler, Better and More balanced.

Our Priorities

We want Barclays to be renowned for an excellent operational performance, highly satisfied customers and clients, strong liquidity, capital and risk management, and predictable, attractive shareholder returns. Building on our strong foundations, we have a clear plan to achieve these objectives and deliver further value for shareholders by 2026.

<https://home.barclays/who-we-are/our-strategy/>

Barclays PLC 2025 Results Announceme

31 December 2025

Performance Highlights

Barclays achieved all financial guidance in 2025 including a return on tangible equity (RoTE) of 11.3%. Barclays is on track to deliver 2026 targets and is announcing new targets to 2028, including RoTE of greater than 14% in 2028 and capital distributions of greater than £15bn between 2026 and 2028

* S. Venkatakrishnan, Group Chief Executive, commented "Barclays achieved all financial guidance in 2025. RoTE was 11.3% as all divisions delivered double-digit RoTE. We distributed £3.7bn to our shareholders, including the £1.0bn share buyback announced today, up from £3.0bn in 2024. We ended the year with a robust common equity tier 1 (CET1) ratio of 14.3% (14.0% rebased for buyback). We grew profit before tax by 13%, earnings per share (EPS) by 22% and tangible net asset value (TNAV) per share by 15% to 409p, a tenth consecutive quarter of growth.

Our progress in the past two years provides a strong foundation to deliver more for our customers, clients and shareholders. As we outline in our plan for the next three years, we will invest further to improve customers' experience and deepen relationships, while harnessing new technology, including AI, to improve efficiency and build segment-leading businesses and drive further growth. Our aim is to secure sustainably higher returns through to 2028 and beyond, delivering Group RoTE of greater than 14% in 2028 and greater than £15bn of capital distributions to shareholders between 2026 and 2028."

- Announced 2028 financial targets
- FY25 Group RoTE of 11.3% (FY24: 10.5%) with earnings per share (EPS) of 43.8p (FY24: 36.0p)
- Total capital distributions of £3.7bn announced in relation to 2025 23% higher than 2024
- Reflecting a total dividend of 8.6p (£1.2bn) and total share buybacks of £2.5bn for 2025. This includes a 5.6p (£0.8bn) full year dividend, and the intention to initiate a further share buyback of up to £1.0bn
- FY25 Group net interest income (NII) excluding Barclays Investment Bank (IB) and Head office of £12.8bn, of which Barclays UK was £7.7bn, meeting 2025 guidance of greater than £12.6bn and £7.6bn respectively

- Continued cost discipline with FY25 Group cost: income ratio improving to 61% (FY24: 62%) driven by positive operating leverage for the third consecutive year
- Achieved £0.7bn of cost efficiency savings in FY25, exceeding the c.£0.5bn guidance, with a total of £1.7bn across FY24 and FY25
- Robust risk management with FY25 Group loan loss rate (LLR) of 52bps (FY24: 46bps), within the through the cycle range of 50-60bps
- Strong balance sheet with CET1 ratio of 14.3%
 - Taking into account the impact of the £1.0bn share buyback announced today, the CET1 ratio as of 31 December 2025 would be reduced to 14.0% (at the top end of the 13-14% target range)
- TNAV per share of 409p (December 2024: 357p)

FY25 Performance highlights:

- Group RoTE was 11.3% (FY24: 10.5%) with profit before tax of £9.1bn (FY24: £8.1bn). All divisions delivered double-digit RoTE in FY25
- Group income of £29.1bn increased 9% year-on-year. Group NII excluding IB and Head Office was £12.8bn, up 13% year-on-year
 - Barclays UK income increased 5%, reflecting higher structural hedge income and Tesco Bank NII, partially offset by the non-repeat of the £0.6bn day 1 gain from the acquisition of Tesco Bank in the prior year
 - Barclays UK Corporate Bank (UKCB) income increased 16%, reflecting higher average deposit and lending balances, and higher structural hedge income
 - Barclays Private Bank and **Wealth Management** (PBWM) income increased 5%, driven by growth in deposit, invested asset and loan balances from net new inflows and market movements
 - Barclays Investment Bank (IB) income increased 11%, with growth across Global Markets and Investment Banking, supported by continued growth in more stable income streams (Financing and International Corporate Bank)
 - Barclays US Consumer Bank (USCB) income increased 11%, reflecting the impact of repricing initiatives, business growth and the acquisition of General Motors co-branded cards portfolio (GM portfolio) in Q325, partially offset by the strengthening of GBP against USD

For the full release, see:

<https://home.barclays/content/dam/home-barclays/documents/investor-relations/ResultAnnouncements/FullYear2025Results/FY25-BPLC-Results-RA.pdf>

HSBC Holdings plc (LSE: HSBA, NYSE: HSBC)

Our history

Supporting our customers for 160 years

The birth of a bank

HSBC was born from one simple idea – a local bank serving international needs. In March 1865, HSBC opened its doors for business in Hong Kong, helping to finance trade between Europe and Asia.

We have been supporting our customers for 160 years. Today, we serve around 41 million personal, **wealth** and corporate customers worldwide in 57 countries and territories.

The experiences of the past 160 years have formed the character of HSBC. A glance at our history explains why we believe in capital strength, in strict cost control and in building long-term relationships with customers.

The bank has weathered change in all forms – revolutions, economic crises, new technologies – and adapted to survive. The resulting corporate character enables HSBC to meet the challenges of the 21st century.

HSBC Holdings plc 2025 results

25 February 2026

Georges Elhedery, Group CEO, said: “2025 was a year of decisive action and swift execution, which is reflected in our strong performance. Each of our four businesses performed well and we have strong momentum across the bank. That is why we are raising our ambition and targeting a 17% RoTE or better, excluding notable items, in each year from 2026 to 2028. We are also targeting year-on-year revenue growth over the same period on the same basis, rising to 5% in 2028. We are becoming a simple, more agile, focused bank, one that moves with the speed our customers need to navigate the modern world. We are delivering growth, investing for growth and we are executing our strategy with discipline and precision. That gives us confidence in our ability to continue delivering for our shareholders.”

2025 financial performance (vs 2024)

- Reported profit before tax decreased by \$2.4bn to \$29.9bn, mainly due to a \$4.9bn year-on-year net adverse impact from notable items. Profit after tax decreased by \$1.9bn to \$23.1bn.
- In 2025, notable items included dilution and impairment losses of \$2.1bn related to our associate Bank of Communications Co., Limited ('BoCom'), reserve recycling losses of \$1.5bn following the completion of the sale of our French retained portfolio of home and certain other loans, legal provisions of \$1.4bn and restructuring and other related costs associated with our organisational simplification of \$1.0bn. In 2024, notable items included net losses relating to our disposals in Canada and Argentina of \$1.4bn.
- Constant currency profit before tax excluding notable items increased by \$2.4bn to \$36.6bn, from a strong performance in **Wealth** in our International **Wealth** and Premier Banking ('IWPB') and Hong Kong businesses, and from Wholesale Transaction Banking in our Corporate and Institutional Banking ('CIB') business. This was partly offset by a rise in expected credit losses and other credit impairment charges ('ECL') and an increase in operating expenses due to planned investment and inflation.
- RoTE in 2025 was 13.3%, compared with 14.6% in 2024. Excluding notable items, RoTE in 2025 was 17.2%, a rise of 1.6 percentage points compared with 2024.
- Revenue of \$68.3bn increased by \$2.4bn or 4% compared with 2024. The increase was primarily due to fee and other income growth in **Wealth** from Investment Distribution and Insurance, and in Wholesale Transaction Banking, particularly in Foreign Exchange in CIB. This was partly offset by the year-on-year impact of notable items, mainly relating to business disposals and a dilution loss related to BoCom. Constant currency revenue excluding notable items rose by \$3.4bn to \$71.0bn.
- Net interest income ('NII') of \$34.8bn was \$2.1bn higher than 2024 reflecting the benefit of the reinvestment of our structural hedge at higher yields, deposit balance growth and higher NII in Markets Treasury. In addition, the increase included the non-recurrence of a \$0.2bn loss in 2024 on the early redemption of legacy securities. This was partly offset by the adverse year-on-year impact of \$1.6bn from business disposals in Argentina and Canada, and margin compression on our deposits. The growth in NII of \$2.1bn also reflected a benefit from lower funding costs associated with the trading book of \$1.7bn. Banking net interest income ('banking NII'), which excludes these funding costs, increased by \$0.3bn to \$44.1bn.
- Net interest margin ('NIM') of 1.59% was 3 basis points ('bps') higher, reflecting the reinvestment of our structural hedge at higher yields.
- ECL were \$3.9bn, an increase of \$0.4bn compared with 2024, including charges in both periods related to the commercial real estate ('CRE') sectors in Hong Kong and mainland China. In 2025, the charge in this sector in Hong Kong of \$0.7bn (2024: \$0.1bn) reflected higher allowances for new defaulted exposures, the impact of an over-supply of non-residential properties that has put continued downward pressure on rental and capital values, and updates to our models used for ECL calculations. The 2025 charge in the mainland China CRE sector was \$0.2bn (2024: \$0.4bn). ECL were 39 bps of average gross loans, including loans and advances classified as held for sale.
- Operating expenses increased by \$3.4bn or 10% to \$36.4bn. The increase primarily reflected notable items in 2025 of \$3.0bn, including legal provisions of \$1.4bn, restructuring and other related costs associated with our

organisational simplification of \$1.0bn, and \$0.5bn related to disposals, wind-downs, acquisitions and related costs.

- Cost growth also reflected planned spend and investment in technology, higher performance-related pay and the impacts of inflation, partly offset by reductions related to our business disposals and the benefits of our organisational simplification.
- Target basis operating expenses rose by 3%, in line with our cost growth target. This increase primarily reflected higher planned spend and investment in technology, higher performance-related pay and the impact of inflation, partly offset by the benefits of our organisational simplification.
- Customer lending balances rose by \$57.7bn including favourable foreign currency translation differences. On a constant currency basis, lending balances rose by \$17.6bn, mainly in our UK business reflecting growth in mortgage and commercial customer lending.
- Customer accounts rose by \$131.9bn, including favourable foreign currency translation differences. On a constant currency basis, customer accounts increased by \$67.6bn with growth in all our businesses, particularly our Hong Kong business segment.
- Common equity tier 1 ('CET1') capital ratio remained at 14.9%. This reflected an increase in risk-weighted assets ('RWAs'), which was offset by an increase in CET1 capital through capital generation net of distributions. The increase in RWAs was mainly driven by foreign currency translation differences and asset size movements.
- The Board has approved a fourth interim dividend of \$0.45 per share, resulting in a total of \$0.75 per share in respect of 2025.

For the full release, see:

<https://www.hsbc.com/-/files/hsbc/investors/hsbc-results/2025/annual/pdfs/hsbc-holdings-plc/260225-annual-results-2025-media-release.pdf>

Lloyds Banking Group (LSE: LLOY)

About us

Lloyds Banking Group is a leading UK-based financial services group. We provide a wide range of banking and financial services, focused primarily on retail and commercial customers.

<https://www.lloydsbankinggroup.com/who-we-are/group-overview.html>

2025 Results News Release

RESULTS FOR THE FULL YEAR

"In 2025, we entered the second phase of our five year strategy and continued to deliver for customers, shareholders and wider stakeholders. As our strategic transformation accelerates into 2026, we remain guided by our purpose of Helping Britain Prosper in driving positive change in areas where we can have impact at scale and create value.

The Group demonstrated sustained strength in financial performance in 2025, including in the final quarter, with continued balance sheet and income growth, as well as strong cost discipline and credit performance. This performance enables total shareholder distributions of c.£3.9 billion for the year.

Looking ahead to 2026 and the culmination of the five year strategy we set out in 2022, our continued business momentum and strategic delivery enable us to upgrade guidance. The sustained strength in performance means we are well positioned for 2026 and beyond. Having entered this year on a positive trajectory, I look forward to sharing more detail on the next stage of the Group's strategy, beyond the current plan, in July." Charlie Nunn, Group Chief Executive

Delivering on our purpose-driven strategy, confident in delivering 2026 strategic outcomes

- Diversified revenue growth across the business through focusing on building the core franchise, deeper customer relationships, developing high value business areas and cross-Group collaboration

- Delivered £1.4 billion of annualised additional revenues from strategic initiatives in 2025; now confident in delivering c.£2 billion by the end of 2026 (ahead of previous target of c.£1.5 billion)
- Enhancing operating leverage through transforming delivery capabilities and capitalising on scale, driving gross cost savings of £1.9 billion since 2021
- Progress in digital capabilities to innovate at scale and reinforce competitive strength, driving revenue and efficiency opportunities, as highlighted at the Digital and AI seminar in November 2025. Focused on extending leadership position across new and emerging technologies including Generative AI (Gen AI) and digital assets

Sustained strength in financial performance

- Statutory profit before tax of £6.7 billion (2024: £6.0 billion) benefitting from higher total income, partially offset by higher operating expenses and a higher impairment charge. Return on tangible equity of 12.9%, or 14.8% excluding a charge for motor finance commission arrangements in the third quarter. Fourth quarter return on tangible equity of 15.7%
- Underlying net interest income of £13.6 billion, up 6% compared to 2024. This reflects a banking net interest margin of 3.06%, up 11 basis points year-on-year (up 4 basis points in the fourth quarter to 3.10%), alongside higher average interest-earning banking assets of £462.9 billion
- Underlying other income of £6.1 billion, 9% higher than 2024 (2% higher in the fourth quarter versus the third), driven by strengthening customer activity and the benefit of strategic initiatives
- Operating lease depreciation of £1,454 million, up 10%, due to fleet growth, the depreciation of higher value vehicles and declines in used electric car prices, partially offset by risk mitigation actions
- Operating costs of £9.8 billion, up 3% versus the prior year, reflecting strategic investment (including increased severance expense), business growth costs and inflationary pressures, partially offset by cost savings from investment and continued business-as-usual cost discipline
- Remediation costs of £968 million, of which £800 million related to the potential impact of motor finance commission arrangements taken in the third quarter
- Underlying impairment charge of £795 million, reflecting strong and stable credit performance and an asset quality ratio of 17 basis points

For the full release, see:

<https://www.lloydsbankinggroup.com/assets/pdfs/investors/financial-performance/lloyds-banking-group-plc/2025/q4/2025-lbg-fy-results.pdf>

OneSavings Bank (LSE: OSB)

About us

OSB Group is a UK listed bank supporting underserved segments of the mortgage market with over 150 years heritage. Our team of experts deliver specialist lending and retail savings through our industry leading brands.

Our Purpose

To help our customers, colleagues and communities prosper.

By that we mean more than just helping them to be more financially well off. We want them to flourish, thrive and succeed in their personal and professional goals.

Our Vision

To be recognised as the UK's number one choice of specialist bank, through our commitment to exceptional service, strong relationships and competitive propositions.

By working Stronger together, Taking ownership, Aiming high and Respecting others, we will more powerfully achieve our own goals, as well as our stakeholders'.

But we are not just focused on lending and savings (though that is what we do and what we are great at); we are a business that cares about leaving things better than we found them. We are passionate about our final value, Stewardship, which encourages us to give back to our communities, supporting those who are vulnerable or less fortunate, embracing diversity and finding new ways to protect our environment.

It does not matter where we are working from; a branch, on the road, in the office or from home. It does not even matter that we are not all in the same country, we are clear about what we want to achieve. We know how we want to achieve it and we are absolutely determined to build upon the foundations we have created so our customers, shareholders, communities and our people can all prosper.

<https://www.osb.co.uk/about-us/our-business-model>

OSB GROUP PLC Full year results for the year ended 31 December 2025

5 March 2026

2025 Full year results OSB GROUP PLC (OSBG or the Group), the specialist lending and retail savings group, announces today its results for the year ended 31 December 2025.

Andy Golding, Group CEO, said: "The Group delivered resilient financial performance in the first year of the transition period, which was in line with our 2025 guidance. We also made tangible progress against our strategy that we set out at the Investor update last year. The loan book diversification has been gaining momentum and in 2025, combined originations in our higher-yielding sub-segments grew by 53%. The Buy-to-Let gross loan book represented 68% of the Group's total gross loan book, a reduction from 70% a year ago, on track with our 2029 target. Finally, many milestones were achieved in the transformation programme in the year. I am particularly pleased with the launch of our new lending platform, a new brand dedicated to Buy-to-Let borrowers: Rely as well as a successful migration of some of our existing savers onto the new savings platform. All this was achieved on time and to budget.

I am pleased that the Group's MREL resolution strategy was reclassified to Transfer from Bail-in, which will bring benefits in the later stages of our Plan. With greater clarity over the Basel 3.1 rules and our confirmed MREL status and therefore our capital requirements, the Board set a new CET1 target for the Group of 13-13.5% post implementation of the Basel 3.1 rules.

The Board has recommended a final dividend per share of 24.1 pence (2024: 22.9 pence), which together with the interim dividend of 11.2 pence (2024: 10.7 pence), represents a total ordinary dividend per share of 35.3 pence for 2025, an increase of 5% from the prior year as guided. The Board is committed to returning excess capital to shareholders and has today announced a new £100m share repurchase programme to commence on 6 March 2026.

The previously communicated direction for 2026 has been refined as guidance as follows:

- net loan book growth is now expected to be broadly similar to 2025 outcome,
- net interest margin is expected to be circa 225bps, reflecting the same key drivers as in 2025: a continuation of lending back book dynamics; new business written at sustainable margins; and a gradual normalisation of the cost of retail funding from the current elevated levels,
- administrative expenses are expected to be c.£280m1 with core costs increasing at no more than the rate of inflation and as we continue to invest in the transformation programme,
- finally, we anticipate a low teens return on tangible equity and a dividend per share increasing by 5% in 2026.

Return on tangible equity remains our key focus. We continue to expect mid teens RoTE in 2027-28, increasing to the top end of mid teens in 2029 driven by the successful execution of our strategy, capital optimisation and the MREL qualifying debt securities reaching their respective call dates.

The Group is well-capitalised, with strong liquidity and a high-quality secured loan book. We are focused on making progress through the transition period to deliver on our medium-term aspirations, prioritising positive outcomes for our stakeholders and strong returns for our shareholders."

<https://www.osb.co.uk/media/anxbqbbz/fy-2025-osb-group-rns.pdf>

Natwest Group

The Royal Bank of Scotland plc (1727-date) is part of NatWest Group.

[https://www.natwestgroup.com/heritage/companies/the-royal-bank-of-scotland-plc.html#:~:text=The%20Royal%20Bank%20of%20Scotland%20plc%20\(1727%2Ddate\)%20is,as%20The%20Three%20Banks%20Group](https://www.natwestgroup.com/heritage/companies/the-royal-bank-of-scotland-plc.html#:~:text=The%20Royal%20Bank%20of%20Scotland%20plc%20(1727%2Ddate)%20is,as%20The%20Three%20Banks%20Group) .

<https://www.rbs.com/rbs/about/update-on-parent-name.html#:~:text=We%20have%20announced%20that%20we,80%25%20of%20our%20customer%20base> .

Who we are

We're a UK-focussed bank serving over 20 million customers, with businesses across retail, commercial and private banking markets.

<https://www.natwestgroup.com/who-we-are/about-natwest-group.html>

2025 Annual Results

2025 performance summary

Chief Executive, Paul Thwaite, commented: "2025 was another strong year for NatWest Group, rooted in the support we provide to people, families and businesses in every nation and region of the UK. We delivered broad-based growth across our three customer businesses, and our positive impact is clear to see; whether making home ownership a reality for more people, helping more customers to save and invest or supporting more businesses to scale and grow.

Our performance reflects the progress we have made against our strategic priorities. Income of £16.4 billion and a Return on Tangible Equity of 19.2% are significantly up on last year, and ahead of guidance, whilst dividends per share increased by 51% compared to 2024.

It is clear our strategy is working, and we are delivering consistently. We are raising our ambition and sharpening our strategic focus, with stretching new targets in place. We must now make the most of the investment we've made to become even more productive, build deeper customer relationships and ensure we are the bank of choice in the areas we want to grow.

Across NatWest Group, we are determined to succeed with our customers as a trusted partner to them and the UK, whilst delivering for our shareholders."

Growth in all of our customer businesses

We have delivered a strong financial performance in 2025 with income and balance sheet growth across all of our businesses. We have added around one million new customers in the year, both organically and through the Sainsbury's Bank transaction, demonstrating our broad-based support for our customers.

- Total income excluding notable items(1) was up £1.8 billion to £16.4 billion in the year supported by deposit margin expansion, as a result of higher customer balances and strong hedge income, increased customer lending, strong AUMA growth and an increase in FX trading revenue. Attributable profit was £5.5 billion with earnings per share of 68.0 pence, up 27% on the prior year, and a Return on Tangible Equity (RoTE) of 19.2%.
- We are growing in ways that build and strengthen customer relationships and improve the sustainability of our earnings. Net loans to customers excluding central items were up by £20.7 billion in the year as we grew our Retail Banking mortgage book and increased Commercial & Institutional balances. Customer deposits excluding central items increased by £10.4 billion with growth across each of the businesses, particularly in Retail Banking savings.
- We continue to maintain a strong loan:deposit ratio, up 3 points in the year to 88%, and liquidity position, with an average Liquidity Coverage Ratio (LCR) of 147%.
- Assets under management and administration (AUMA) grew by 19.6% to £58.5 billion, assisted by strong client net inflows including more than 50,000 new to invest clients.

Simplification continues to drive efficiency

We continued to make good progress on becoming a simpler, more agile and technology driven bank by delivering efficiencies from our investment programmes and digitising more to deliver faster, simpler, and safer customer journeys. We have accelerated AI and data transformation with partnerships with Open AI, AWS and Accenture. Our stable cost base has resulted in a cost:income ratio (excl. litigation and conduct) improvement of 4.8%, to 48.6%, when compared with 2024 and an FTE reduction of c.0.5k in the year.

Active balance sheet management creates capacity for growth

We continued to actively manage our balance sheet and risk, delivering £10.9 billion benefits from RWA management actions as we created capacity for growth. Capital generation pre-distributions was 252 basis points in the year as we increased our capital velocity. Our Common Equity Tier 1 (CET1) ratio of 14.0% was up c.40 basis points in the year. TNAV per share increased by 55 pence in the year to 384 pence. A final dividend of 23.0 pence per share is proposed, bringing the total for the year to 32.5 pence, up 51% compared to 2024.

For the full release, see:

https://investors.natwestgroup.com/~/_media/Files/R/RBS-IR-V2/results-center/13022026/nwg-company-announcement.pdf

Standard Chartered (LSE: STAN)

Who we are

We are a global bank connecting corporate, institutional and affluent clients to a network that offers unique access to sustainable growth opportunities across Asia, Africa and the Middle East.

<https://www.sc.com/en/about/>

Standard Chartered releases Second Quarter and Half Year 2026 Results

29 Jul 2026

We've released our financial results for the first half and second quarter ended 30 June 2026.

For more details, please visit our Investor Relations section.

All figures are presented on a reported basis and comparisons are made to 2025 on a constant currency basis, unless otherwise stated.

Bill Winters, Group Chief Executive, said:

"We delivered a record first-half performance in 2026, with double-digit growth in **Wealth** Solutions and Global Banking. Our performance demonstrates the strength of our differentiated international network and the disciplined execution of our strategy. Clients continue to turn to us to facilitate trade, investment and **wealth** flows across the world's most dynamic markets. We delivered a 17 per cent increase in our earnings per share, and our upgraded income guidance and new share buyback of USD1 billion reflect our confidence in the business."

Manus Costello, Group Chief Financial Officer, said:

"We are now compounding the growth of our powerful franchise while investing to build a simpler, faster and more connected bank that meets the evolving needs of our clients. At the same time, we remain disciplined on expenses and focused on managing capital tightly.

Together, these strengths give us confidence in our ability to deliver exceptional growth and sustainably higher returns."

Selected information on H1'26 financial performance with comparisons to H1'25 unless otherwise stated

* Record operating income up 6 per cent to USD11.6 billion, up 8 per cent excluding the Solv India transaction

* Net interest income¹ (NII) up 4 per cent to USD5.7 billion; Non-interest income¹ up 8 per cent to USD5.9 billion

* **Wealth** Solutions up 38 per cent, driven by strong growth in investment products

* Global Banking up 19 per cent, driven by strong origination activity and strong capital market activity

- * Operating expenses up 1 per cent to USD6.3 billion, up 2 per cent excluding notables²
- * Credit impairment charge of USD446 million with USD296 million from **Wealth** & Retail Banking (WRB) and USD150 million from Corporate & Investment Banking (CIB) mostly driven by management overlays relating to the Middle East conflict
- * Record profit before tax of USD4.8 billion, up 9 per cent
- * Tax charge of USD1.1 billion; effective tax rate of 23.3 per cent
- * Return on Tangible Equity (RoTE) of 17.6 per cent, up 120bps
- * Earnings per share increased 17 per cent to 151.6 cents

Selected information of Q2'26 financial performance with comparisons to Q2'25 unless otherwise stated

- * Operating income of USD5.7 billion up 3 per cent
- * Excluding USD238 million gain on the Solv India transaction in Q2'25, income is up 8 per cent
- * NII1 up 7 per cent to USD2.9 billion; driven by volumes and improved balance sheet mix
- * Non-interest income¹ of USD2.8 billion was broadly flat, up 9 per cent excluding the Solv India transaction; driven by continued momentum in **Wealth** Solutions and Global Banking
- * **Wealth** Solutions up 43 per cent, mostly driven by strong double-digit growth in Investment Products
- * Global Banking up 18 per cent, driven by strong origination activity and increased capital markets activity
- * Operating expenses were broadly flat, up 3 per cent excluding a notable item of USD74 million release of provisions on Korea equity-linked securities (ELS) portfolio
- * Credit impairment charge of USD150 million up USD31 million. WRB charge of USD116 million down USD49 million mainly from portfolio actions. CIB charge of USD39 million was up USD78 million mostly from management overlays partly offset by releases
- * Profit before tax of USD2.3 billion, up 2 per cent
- * RoTE of 17.9 per cent, broadly flat
- * Balance sheet remains strong, liquid and well diversified with underlying loans and advances to customers up 2.2 per cent and underlying customer deposits up 2 per cent quarter-on-quarter
- * Risk-weighted assets (RWA) of USD261.5 billion, down USD4.7 billion since 31.3.26; Credit risk RWA down USD3.4 billion, Market RWA down USD1.4 billion, and Operational RWA flat
- * The Group remains strongly capitalised with Common Equity Tier 1 (CET1) ratio of 14.2 per cent up 77bps quarter-on-quarter
- * USD1 billion share buyback starting imminently is expected to reduce CET1 ratio by 38bps
- * Interim ordinary dividend increased 66 per cent to 20.4 cents per share (USD448 million)
- * Tangible net asset value per share of USD17.55, up 4 per cent

Guidance

Our revised 2026 guidance is as follows:

- * Operating income growth year-on-year to be around the middle of the 5-7 per cent range at constant currency and excluding material notable² items
- * Within which, net interest income¹ expected to be low single digit percentage growth year-on-year at constant currency
- * Expenses excluding notables² expected to be around USD13.3 billion at constant currency

* RoTE to be greater than 12 per cent.

<https://www.sc.com/en/press-release/half-year-2026-results/>

Secure Trust Bank (LSE: STB)

Here to help you fulfil your ambitions

It's what we've been doing since 1952

We are an award-winning UK retail bank, providing savings accounts and lending services to over a million customers. In 2022 the Group celebrated 70 years of helping consumers and businesses fulfil their ambitions.

Our approachable teams are based at our Solihull headquarters and offices in Cardiff, London, Manchester and Reading. We are making good progress towards our vision to be the most trusted specialist lender in the UK.

Since 1952, Secure Trust Bank has been here to help you fulfil your ambitions. Our Savings business in Solihull offers bonds and savings accounts, whilst the Real Estate Finance team offer finance to experienced developers for residential, commercial and mixed use development schemes, as well as professional landlords. Meanwhile, our business and commercial division in Manchester provides companies with refinance options to help them grow.

V12 is our retail finance division in Cardiff that has an underwriting team, as well as risk and fraud departments, plus a call centre. V12 arrange and administer retail finance loans for national brands and retail partners all over the UK, helping customers buy the things they want.

<https://www.securetrustbank.com/about-us>

SECURE TRUST BANK PLC 2025 Annual Results and Investor Update Event: updated strategic plans and medium-term targets

12 March 2026

Secure Trust Bank PLC ('STB', 'Secure Trust Bank', or the 'Group'), a leading specialist bank, will host its 2025 Annual Results and Investor Update event for analysts and institutional investors today, 12 March 2026.

A live webcast of the presentation and slides will be available at the following link at 13.00:

https://brrmedia.news/STB_FY25_Investor_Update. The Annual Results presentation will begin at 13.00, with the Investor Update presentation to begin at 14.15. The event will cover the Group's 2025 annual results and refreshed strategic plans, including product driven growth opportunities, and its capital allocation strategy.

The event includes presentations from the CEO, CFO and management of the Retail Finance, Business Finance and Savings divisions.

2025 Financial highlights¹ :

- Achieved return on average equity ('ROAE') of 14.3% (2024: 14.6%)
- Delivered continuing profit before tax of £59.3 million (2024: £59.4 million)
- Common Equity Tier 1 ('CET 1') ratio improved by 60 bps to 12.9% (2024: 12.3%)
- Sale of Consumer Vehicle Finance business further increases CET 1 ratio to 14.7%² on a pro forma basis
- Growth in lending balances of 8.1% to £3.3 billion (2024: £3.1 billion)
- Cost income ratio improved by 220 bps to 45.2% (2024: 47.4%)
- Tangible book value per share increased by 5.8% to £19.73 per share (2024: £18.64 per share)
- Increased total dividend to 35.5 pence per share (2024: 33.8 pence per share), in line with progressive dividend policy
- Committing £10 million of capital to initiate a share buyback programme to be delivered over 12 months, subject to regulatory approval Strategic update

- Refreshed strategic priorities centred on product expansion, effective digital solutions and capital discipline will deliver targeted growth for higher returns
- New medium-term targets of c.10% annual growth and ROAE above 16%
- Simplified business on clear trajectory to grow in large scale markets at lower cost of risk
- Investment in cost efficiency alongside operating leverage will drive strong cost income ratio

Strategic update

- Refreshed strategic priorities centred on product expansion, effective digital solutions and capital discipline will deliver targeted growth for higher returns
- New medium-term targets of c.10% annual growth and ROAE above 16%
- Simplified business on clear trajectory to grow in large scale markets at lower cost of risk
- Investment in cost efficiency alongside operating leverage will drive strong cost income ratio

2025 Annual Results

The Group achieved strong levels of new business lending, leading to an 8.1% increase in net lending balances to £3.3 billion (2024: £3.1 billion). Retail Finance grew 8.0%, as the business continued to leverage the strength of its retail distribution network. Business Finance grew by 8.1%, driven by Real Estate Finance which grew by 9.4% and continued momentum in Commercial Finance, delivering 3.2% growth in net lending balances. Strong pricing discipline across the Group in a falling rate environment contributed to stable net interest margin ('NIM') of 4.7% (2024: 4.7%).

Customer deposits increased 8.2% year on year to £3.5 billion (2024: £3.2 billion), supporting growth in the lending book, and remaining stable relative to the half year. The rundown of the Vehicle Finance portfolio reduced the need for additional funding in the second half of the year. The Group fully repaid its Bank of England Term Funding Scheme with additional incentives for SMEs ('TFSME') balances in 2025 (2024: £230.0 million). The Group has £201.2 million (2024: £125.7 million) of funding through sale and repurchase arrangements.

Cost income ratio improved to 45.2% (2024: 47.4%) reflecting strong income growth and effective cost management in an inflationary environment, and the delivery of operational efficiencies through our cost optimisation programme, Project Fusion3. In 2025, operating expenses included £2.5 million of non-recurring costs relating to changes in senior leadership; excluding these items, the cost income ratio would have been 43.7%.

Cost of risk increased to 1.0% (2024: 0.8%). This reflects the impact of three specific cases in Business Finance and a normalisation of impairment charges in Retail Finance, following the impact of one-off model benefits.

The Group was capital accretive in 2025 and strengthened its capital position in the year, improving the CET 1 ratio by 60 bps to 12.9% (2024: 12.3%). The sale of the Consumer Vehicle Finance business, which completed on 25 February 2026, further increases the CET 1 ratio on a pro forma basis to 14.7%².

For the full release, see:

<https://www.securetrustbank.com/investor-relations/document-library/press-release-2025-final-905476464137>

Virgin Money UK plc (LSE: VMUK, ASX: VUK)

About us

Virgin Money is so much more than just a bank. As part of the Nationwide Building Society, we are driven by our purpose, Banking – but fairer, more rewarding, and for the good of society.

Banking – but fairer, more rewarding, and for the good of society.

We offer red-hot products and services to meet the full range of our 6.6m customers' retail and business banking needs via our leading technology platform, telephone banking and a network of innovative branches and business banking centres.

Visit Virgin Money to find out more about what we offer for our customers.

As a Virgin company, we are also committed to being a force for good. Guided by our Purpose, we seek to drive social and environmental impact. This includes tackling the poverty premium, offering products that aim to help our customers make a positive impact on society and the environment, providing grants through the Virgin Money Foundation to enable local organizations to improve their communities, and helping build the next generation of budding entrepreneurs while boosting their confidence in managing money through our Make £5 Grow programme.

You can find out more by visiting our Corporate Sustainability section.

<https://www.virginmoneyukplc.com/about-us/>

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HSBC to offload Egypt retail banking unit to Emirates NBD

357 words

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MarketLine News and Comment

DTMNTR

English

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HSBC has agreed to divest its retail banking operations in Egypt to Emirates NBD Egypt.

The agreement includes the assets and liabilities tied to HSBC Egypt's full retail banking business.

This covers retail loans, customer deposits and accounts, along with employees supporting the business being transferred.

The deal is expected to close in the second half of 2027, pending regulatory clearance.

HSBC said there will be no immediate change for retail customers in Egypt, and existing products and services will continue as usual during the process.

The two banks will work together on the transition for staff and customers.

For HSBC Group, the transaction is expected to result in an estimated pre-tax gain of about \$300m.

The bank said this would be recognised mainly when the deal completes and treated as a material notable item.

HSBC expects the disposal to have an immaterial effect on the group's common equity Tier 1 capital ratio.

"Egypt remains an important market for HSBC with strong growth potential", said the bank adding that it will continue to support its corporate and institutional banking clients in the country.

The bank also said it remains focused on "two-way trade" and investment flows, supporting multinational companies in Egypt and domestic wholesale clients with international activities.

The transaction follows a review of HSBC Egypt's retail banking arm announced last year.

It is part of a broader effort to simplify the group and concentrate on markets and business areas where it sees stronger competitive positioning and room for growth.

The Egypt deal follows other disposals involving HSBC's retail operations.

Last week, HSBC Bank Australia agreed to sell its Australian mortgage and personal lending portfolio to Blackstone, with those assets carrying a book value of around A\$36bn (\$25bn).

In June, Bloomberg reported, citing sources, that Emirates NBD was in discussions to acquire HSBC's operations in Türkiye.

Earlier, in May, OCBC Indonesia signed an agreement with PT Bank HSBC Indonesia to take over the assets and liabilities linked to HSBC Indonesia's retail banking and **wealth management** business.

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Document DTMNTR0020260804em830001a

Frankly Speaking: Valuing life insurers and why Great Eastern's rally has been so strong

By Goola Warden (goola.warden@bizedge.com)

565 words

3 August 2026

The Edge Singapore

EDGESI

English

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In general, Singapore's financial services stocks rallied. Great Eastern Holdings (GEH) is up 41% in the year to July 29. Its parent, Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation (OCBC), has gained 48% in the same time, and it has outperformed the other two banks. DBS has gained 32% and UOB 25%. JP Morgan is up 6.98% this year, while the MSCI USA Banks 20/35 Capped Index, which measures the performance of the large and mid-cap securities in the US, is up 6.99%.

Was GEH the cause of OCBC's outperformance? It is now trading at a price-to-comprehensive equity of 1.39 times and must be among the most expensive life insurance companies in Singapore and Hong Kong. Investors are certainly valuing GEH higher than AIA and Prudential, against which it is often benchmarked.

During OCBC's offer to privatise GEH, which started in 2024 and concluded in July last year, GEH was not trading. It resumed trading in August 2025 at \$13.50. Since its relisting, its share price has moved higher, resulting in one of the best performances of a mega-cap (with market capitalisation of more than \$20 billion) this year.

On July 24, part of the reason that GEH has done so well emerged. Allianz agreed to pay \$2.7 billion for 100% of HSBC Life. According to the Allianz statement, there are numerous reasons for acquiring HSBC Life (see charts 1 and 2). They include Singapore's GDP growth, AAA credit rating, a stable political environment with a very stable currency, and attractive insurance and **wealth** dynamics.

Of note is that in Allianz's view, Singapore is the largest life insurance market in Southeast Asia. More importantly, Allianz is expecting a return on investment of more than 10% in the "short- to mid-term". Its contractual service margin (CSM) growth is well above Allianz's overall group target.

CSM is the carrying amount of an insurance contract group representing the unearned profit that an entity expects to recognise as it provides future insurance contract services. Simply put, it is the untouched profit that an insurance company has locked away in a long-term policy. It's the money the company expects to make from that policy, but they aren't allowed to count it as earnings all at once.

European life insurers such as Allianz have moved away from embedded value (EV) to comprehensive equity to value life insurance companies. Comprehensive equity is the sum of shareholders' funds plus CSM net of reinsurance contracts and tax.

Allianz is paying around 1.5 times HSBC Life's comprehensive equity of EUR1.2 billion (\$1.773 billion, see table). GEH's performance and potential are likely to be as positive as HSBC Life's because of its market positioning.

Income Insurance does not report its comprehensive equity, so analysts have estimated it. It is likely to have been valued at around 1.3 times based on Allianz's offer for Income in 2024. At the time, Allianz offered to acquire 51% of Income. The valuation for HSBC Life is higher because Allianz is acquiring 100%.

Is GEH undervalued and should it trade at more than 1.5 times comprehensive equity? That remains to be seen.

Document EDGESI0020260804em8300001

DBS names Jonathan Larsen to Board of Directors

Distributed by Contify.com

645 words

3 August 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Larsen brings deep financial services expertise and tech understanding.
- * Larsen's experience spans 18 years at Citigroup and roles at Ping An Group.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Regional, Aug. 3 -- DBS Bank Ltd issued the following news release:

- Larsen will bring deep financial services expertise and a strong understanding of the evolving technology landscape to the DBS Boards.

DBS Group Holdings (DBSH) said today it has appointed Jonathan Larsen, 60, to the Boards of DBS Group Holdings and DBS Bank, with effect from today.

Jonathan Larsen

With his deep experience in financial services, coupled with his track record of harnessing technology and innovation to drive business growth, Larsen will strengthen the overall composition of the DBS Boards.

Larsen was the Chief Innovation Officer of Ping An Group as well as the Chairman and Chief Executive Officer/ Managing Director of the Ping An Global Voyager Fund from May 2017 until he retired in February 2026. He was responsible for bringing new technologies, platforms and business models to support Ping An's growth in China and internationally.

Prior to joining Ping An, he spent 18 years at Citigroup where his last role was Global Head of the firm's Retail Banking and Mortgage businesses spanning 19 countries. Other senior roles he held in Citigroup included the Region Head of the Asia Pacific Consumer Business and Country Head of Singapore.

Prior to joining Citigroup, he was a Principal in the Financial Services Practice of global management consulting firm, Booz Allen & Hamilton.

Said DBS Chairman Peter Seah, "I join my fellow directors in welcoming Jonathan to the DBS Boards. Jonathan brings a unique combination of financial services expertise, technology leadership and innovation experience, shaped through decades of senior leadership at leading global and Asian financial institutions. His perspectives will be highly valuable as the DBS Boards continue to guide the bank through an increasingly dynamic and technology-driven environment."

DBS has been recognised as "World's Best Bank" by publications such as Euromoney, The Banker and Global Finance nine times. It was recognised as "World's Best AI Bank" by Global Finance in 2025.

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named “World’s Best Bank” by Global Finance, “World’s Best Bank” by Euromoney and “Global Bank of the Year” by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named “World’s Best AI Bank” by Global Finance and “World’s Best Digital Bank” by Euromoney. In addition, DBS has been accorded the “Safest Bank in Asia” award by Global Finance for 17 consecutive years from 2009 to 2025.

DBS provides a full range of services in Consumer, **Wealth**, SME and corporate banking. As a bank born and bred in Asia, DBS understands the intricacies of doing business in the region’s most dynamic markets.

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by uplifting lives and livelihoods of those in need. It provides essential needs to the underprivileged, and fosters inclusion by equipping the underserved with financial and digital literacy skills. It also nurtures innovative social enterprises that create positive impact.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com

[Category: Investment Banking, Management Changes, Technology]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd

Document ATINBK0020260803em83000ed

Analyst Blog
Why HSBC is Scaling Back Retail Banking in Egypt and Australia

Zacks Equity Research

678 words

3 August 2026

zacks.com

ZDCOM

English

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HSBC is exiting retail banking in Egypt and Australia to cut complexity, boost efficiency and shift capital toward higher-return global franchises.

HSBC Holdings HSBC is accelerating the simplification of its global operations and recently announced two major transactions involving its retail banking businesses in Egypt and Australia. The moves reflect the lender's strategy of withdrawing capital from operations where it lacks sufficient scale while retaining businesses that benefit from its international network and competitive strengths.

HSBC has agreed to sell its entire Egyptian retail banking business to Emirates NBD Egypt. The transaction includes retail loans, deposits and customer accounts, along with employees supporting the business. Subject to regulatory approvals, the deal is expected to close in the second half of 2027 and generate an estimated pre-tax gain of approximately \$300 million. The impact on HSBC's common equity tier 1 capital ratio is expected to be immaterial.

Despite the retail exit, HSBC will maintain its corporate and institutional banking operations in Egypt. The bank sees growth opportunities in supporting multinational companies, facilitating trade and investment flows and helping domestic wholesale clients expand internationally. The disposal followed a strategic review and is intended to concentrate resources on areas where HSBC possesses a stronger competitive advantage.

Separately, HSBC Australia agreed to sell an approximately A\$36-billion, or \$25-billion, portfolio of home and personal loans to an entity owned by Blackstone-managed funds. Pepper Money will service the loans after completion, which is expected in the first half of 2027, subject to regulatory and competition approvals. The portfolio disposal is expected to result in an immaterial loss of less than \$100 million.

HSBC will also wind down the remainder of its Australian retail operation over 18 months. Its corporate and institutional banking, private banking and asset-management businesses will subsequently be consolidated into the HSBC Sydney Branch, simplifying the group's legal-entity footprint. The process is expected to entail around \$300 million of restructuring costs and write-offs.

Our Take on HSBC's Streamlining Initiatives

These two transactions extend HSBC's broader portfolio reshaping. This year, the company completed the privatization of Hang Seng Bank and divested its U.K. life insurance business, as well as its retail banking operations in South Africa and Sri Lanka. HSBC also reclassified its Malta business as held for sale and agreed to sell its Indonesian retail banking business and Singapore life and health insurance business.

HSBC is undertaking these steps to reduce complexity, improve cost efficiency and redirect capital and spending toward higher-return franchises, particularly Hong Kong, the U.K., globally connected corporate banking and international **wealth**. The company had actioned roughly \$1.4 billion of its targeted \$1.5 billion in annualized simplification savings by the first quarter of 2026 and plans to redeploy about \$1.8 billion from non-strategic activities into priority growth areas.

These efforts should strengthen operating leverage, sharpen management accountability and support HSBC's target of delivering a return on tangible equity of at least 17% through 2028.

This year, HSBC shares have gained 35.3%, outperforming the industry's growth of 18.3%.

YTD Price Performance

[Image Source: Zacks Investment Research](#)

At present, HSBC carries a Zacks Rank #2 (Buy).

Similar Steps Taken by Other Banks

In July, Northern Trust Corporation NTRS agreed to sell its guardianship services business to Wintrust Financial Corporation's subsidiary, Wintrust Private Trust Company.

The divestiture aligns with NTRS' broader strategy of strengthening its core **wealth management**, asset servicing, and asset management businesses while streamlining its portfolio and focusing investments on areas with stronger long-term growth potential.

In June, Deutsche Bank AG DB entered into a definitive agreement to sell its retail banking, affluent private banking and **wealth management** business in India to Kotak Mahindra Bank.

The divestiture aligns with DB's broader Global Hausbank strategy, announced in November 2025, which emphasizes simplifying operations, enabling disciplined capital allocation and concentrating investments in businesses with stronger scale and competitive advantages.

Document ZDCOM00020260803em830001c

Stanchart hosts roundtable on second-half 2026 global market outlook

705 words

3 August 2026

Business and Financial Times

BUSFINC

English

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The event formed part of the bank's global rollout of its latest investment outlook, bringing together clients and investment specialists to examine key global trends and their implications for Ghanaian investors. Standard Chartered said it expects risk assets to remain supported by a soft-landing global economy, although investors should prepare for periods of volatility driven by oil prices, equity market supply, investor positioning and central bank policy.

Presenting the outlook, Chief Investment Officer for Africa, Middle East and Europe, Manpreet Singh Gill said investors should resist the temptation to time markets and instead maintain diversified portfolios capable of weathering short-term disruptions.

"We continue to be optimistic on equity markets and think that's where the biggest source of returns will come from," Gill said, noting that the bank's preferred equity markets remain the United States and Asia excluding Japan.

He said resilient corporate earnings continue to justify the bank's constructive stance on equities, particularly in the technology sector, arguing that current valuations are supported by underlying profit growth rather than speculative excesses. While semiconductor companies have dominated gains this year, Gill said earnings growth is expected to broaden across other sectors of the U.S. market as well as Asian markets, including China and India.

Beyond equities, Standard Chartered continues to favour emerging market U.S. dollar-denominated bonds and corporate credit over long-duration government bonds. Investors are not being sufficiently compensated for the additional risks associated with long-maturity government securities at a time when inflation uncertainty and interest-rate volatility remain elevated. Instead, the bank sees stronger opportunities in corporate bonds and emerging market dollar debt, including African Eurobonds, where yields remain attractive.

According to the bank, four key themes are expected to shape markets through the remainder of the year: oil prices, new equity issuance, investor positioning and monetary policy decisions by major central banks.

Although geopolitical tensions in the Middle East caused a sharp spike in oil prices earlier this year, strong global inventories and improved energy efficiency helped cushion the global economy from a more severe shock. We expect oil prices to gradually moderate when supply conditions normalise, although there may be periods of volatility.

The bank also forecasts a gradual weakening of the U.S. dollar as other major central banks continue tightening monetary policy while the U.S. Federal Reserve is expected to keep interest rates broadly unchanged. A softer dollar, Gill said, would provide a supportive backdrop for emerging market assets by encouraging cross-border capital flows.

Standard Chartered also maintained a positive view on gold as a portfolio diversifier, citing continued purchases by emerging market central banks as a key structural driver despite temporary selling earlier in the year to support foreign exchange reserves.

The roundtable concluded with a panel discussion on **wealth** creation and preservation featuring Jerry Asamba, Head of Managed Investments and Advisory; Andrew Agyaben, Head of Capital Markets Products; and Emmanuel Naboo, Head of Insurance, where executives emphasised diversification, professional portfolio management and insurance as critical components of long-term financial planning.

They emphasised diversification should be viewed as constructing portfolios that would prove resilient under different economic scenarios rather than simply holding an assemblage of numerous investment assets and encouraged investors to balance exposure across local and offshore bonds, equities, alternative assets such as real estate and gold, and multiple currencies.

The panellists encouraged clients not to leave idle cash in deposit accounts, noting that professionally managed investment portfolios can help investors capture opportunities across market cycles while reducing emotionally driven investment decisions. They also urged clients to integrate insurance into their broader investment strategies, rather than viewing it solely as protection against death, stressing that insurance should be regarded as an essential **wealth** protection tool that helps preserve assets, manage unforeseen financial shocks and facilitate the efficient transfer of **wealth** across generations.

The event was attended by senior executives of the bank, including Xorse Godzi, Chief Executive Officer, Head, **Wealth** and Retail Banking; Yvonne Gyebi, Head of **Wealth Management**; Setor Quashigah and Albert Asante, Executive Director and Chief Financial Officer, underscoring Standard Chartered's commitment to deepening client engagement and supporting clients on their **wealth** journey.

Document BUSFINC020260803em83000jm

Emirates NBD expands Egypt reach with HSBC deal

The Arabian Post Network

758 words

3 August 2026

The Arabian Post

ARAPO

English

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[Arabian Post Staff](#) -Dubai

Emirates NBD has agreed to acquire HSBC Egypt's retail banking business, gaining its customer accounts, branches, cash machines and associated employees in a transaction expected to strengthen the Dubai-based lender's position in one of the Arab world's largest financial markets.

The acquisition will be conducted through Emirates NBD Egypt, the banking group's wholly owned subsidiary. Completion is targeted for the second half of 2027, subject to approval from the Central Bank of Egypt, other regulatory clearances and customary closing conditions.

Financial terms were not disclosed by Emirates NBD. HSBC expects the disposal to generate a pre-tax gain of about \$300 million, although the final amount could change depending on the portfolio transferred, market conditions and adjustments made before completion.

The agreement covers HSBC Egypt's retail banking portfolio, its related branch and ATM network, customers and employees identified as relevant to the business. HSBC's corporate and institutional banking operations are excluded and will remain under the group's ownership.

Retail customers will not face immediate changes. Accounts, cards, digital banking facilities and other services will continue to operate normally during the transition period. Customers and employees are expected to receive advance notice before any operational changes are introduced.

The deal gives Emirates NBD an opportunity to expand without relying solely on opening branches and attracting customers individually. The acquisition adds an established portfolio of deposits, loans, credit cards and **wealth-management** relationships, while increasing the group's physical distribution network across key urban centres.

Emirates NBD has operated in Egypt since acquiring BNP Paribas Egypt in 2013. The business was subsequently rebranded as Emirates NBD Egypt and developed retail, corporate, investment and digital banking services. Absorbing HSBC's consumer operations could improve its scale in a market dominated by large state-controlled banks and several well-established private lenders.

The transaction also advances Emirates NBD's international growth strategy. The group has been expanding beyond its home market through operations and investments across Egypt, Türkiye, Saudi Arabia and other jurisdictions. Its international plans have been supported by strong earnings, rising deposits and sustained growth in lending.

Emirates NBD recorded a net profit of 24 billion dirhams in 2025, an increase of 4 per cent from the previous year. Gross loans rose 24 per cent to 658 billion dirhams, while deposits increased 18 per cent to 786 billion dirhams. Total assets reached 1.16 trillion dirhams at the end of the year.

The group has also pursued a proposed \$3 billion investment for a controlling stake in RBL Bank, underlining its willingness to use acquisitions to enter or deepen its presence in high-growth markets. Its expansion reflects a broader move by Gulf banks to diversify earnings, serve cross-border clients and capture trade and investment flows linking the Middle East, Africa and Asia.

Egypt offers substantial long-term potential because of its population of more than 100 million, expanding digital payments sector and relatively low level of formal financial inclusion. Banks have been investing in mobile applications, instant payments, cards and electronic merchant services as authorities seek to reduce dependence on cash.

The country's banking industry has nevertheless faced pressure from inflation, currency depreciation and elevated interest rates. The pound has undergone several adjustments since 2022, raising operating costs and affecting borrowers' repayment capacity. Banks with strong capital positions and access to international funding may be better placed to manage those risks and invest in technology.

HSBC began reviewing its Egypt retail business in October 2025 as part of a global programme intended to simplify operations and concentrate resources in areas where it holds a stronger competitive advantage. Similar reviews covered consumer banking activities in Australia, Indonesia, Sri Lanka and Bangladesh, while the group separately moved to divest its retail operation in Bahrain.

The London-headquartered bank has maintained a presence in Egypt since 1982. It will continue serving multinational companies, large domestic businesses, financial institutions and other wholesale clients after the retail sale. Its remaining operation will focus on corporate finance, transaction banking, international trade and investment flows.

HSBC has described Egypt as a market with significant growth potential despite its decision to dispose of the consumer franchise. Retaining the corporate and institutional business allows the group to connect companies operating in Egypt with its international network while reducing the capital, technology and branch-management demands associated with mass-market banking.

The article [Emirates NBD expands Egypt reach with HSBC deal](#) appeared first on [Arabian Post](#).

Document ARAPO00020260803em830005m

Standard Chartered HK eyes business growth in H2

OSWALD CHAN in Hong Kong

829 words

3 August 2026

China Daily-Hong Kong Edition

CHNDHK

4

English

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Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong), the local arm of the global banking titan Standard Chartered Group, expressed optimism about business growth momentum in the second half of this year, focusing on strategic priorities such as renminbi internationalization, cross-border income, digital assets, and gold trading.

The United Kingdom-based banking group announced its first-half and second-quarter results last week, with the Hong Kong market remaining the largest income and profit contributor.

Profits before taxation from the Hong Kong market in the first half rose 13 percent year-on-year to \$1.6 billion, with operating profits before impairment and taxation increasing by 9 percent and credit impairment down 24 percent during that period.

Mary Huen Wai-yi, CEO for Hong Kong and Greater China and North Asia at Standard Chartered Group, and executive director of Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Ltd, said the momentum of its loan business can be sustained in the second half, based on the four major growth areas - mortgage loans, trade finance, renminbi loans and **wealth** lending.

In the first half, the bank's lending business achieved a broad-based 12 percent growth from a year ago.

First, the Hong Kong residential home market is posting a gradual recovery. Coupled with a stabilizing consumer market, this drives the demand for mortgage loans.

Second, the growth of Hong Kong exports and cross-border trade, driven by the artificial intelligence investment supercycle, is boosting the corporate need for trade finance and working capital.

"The city's strong export performance creates business flows for the bank. When clients have greater balance sheets, they will have the demand for transaction banking services," Huen said.

The third area of growth in the loan business relates to renminbi internationalization.

"As the offshore yuan liquidity pool in Hong Kong further deepens, companies can consider tapping yuan onshore rates for financing needs. Our renminbi-denominated loans have grown. By utilizing our networks, the bank can leverage Hong Kong to radiate yuan financing flows to overseas countries such as Southeast Asia, Africa and the Middle East," Huen said.

Wealth lending has also increased alongside growing **wealth management** needs. Affluent income under the **wealth** and retail banking segment grew 28 percent annually in the first half.

Huen said the bank expects interest rates in the United States to remain stable, given an improving US economy and controlled inflation rate.

She said that stable US interest rates support an ongoing appetite for loans, although a modest rate hike remains possible.

Despite its minimal effects on the bank's balance sheet, an interest-rate hike would still present challenges to the bank, Huen said. "Market competition on time deposits and the **wealth management** business is also keen."

While Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) expects traditional lending and the **wealth management** business to be robust and diversified in the second half, it is also targeting new opportunities based on four new growth drivers.

The first is the business potential arising from renminbi internationalization, as the Chinese mainland accelerates opening-up.

"Mainland and Hong Kong firms are actively pursuing overseas business expansion while overseas companies are venturing into the mainland market. This will bolster the demand for offshore yuan financing services," Huen said.

Second, cross-border business activities are creating new growth drivers. In the first half of 2026, cross-border income under the corporate and investment banking segment increased 16 percent from a year ago.

For example, mainland companies expanding overseas are relying on the bank's expertise in corporate treasury management, generating cross-border income for the bank.

"As we successfully help companies expand operations in one particular country, say Malaysia or Vietnam, these corporate clients still prefer to use our services there - even though we do not have a strong presence in these markets," Huen said. "This creates network income for Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong)."

The third strategic priority is digital assets.

Anchorpoint Financial - a joint venture established by Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong), Hong Kong Telecommunications, and Animoca Brands - will announce the formal launch of the regulated Hong Kong dollar-backed stablecoin, HKD At Par (HKDAP), along with selected authorized distributors and usecase scenarios of the HKDAP, within this month.

In April, Anchorpoint Financial was one of the two companies granted a stablecoin issuer license by the Hong Kong Monetary Authority under the Stablecoins Ordinance, which came into effect in August 2025.

"Many of our corporate clients are eager to consult with us for formulating their digital asset deployment strategies. By addressing the pain points of cost efficiency and flexibility, the HKDAP can enable smooth cross-border settlement or tokenization of real-world assets that can support the real economy," Huen said.

She also said the bank is proactively considering the construction of its first gold-storage warehouse in Hong Kong, as the city strives to develop a full value chain in gold trading services amid significant market demand.

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Top Stories

Glide-path portfolios for CPF attract 25 proposals from interested offerors

Genevieve Cua

1,284 words

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print

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English

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Competition to offer glide-path portfolios is keen as several parties, including large asset managers and financial institutions, are understood to have submitted proposals to the Central Provident Fund (CPF).

"By automatically adjusting risk according to an individual's life stage... (the portfolios) can help investors stay disciplined through market cycles without having to decide when or how to rebalance their portfolios."

Calvin Ong, DBS head of consumer banking

The CPF Board said its call for applications from solutions providers attracted "meaningful industry interest", with 25 proposals by the submission deadline of Jul 24.

The Business Times understands that interested parties are free to collaborate with others to offer solutions for the "new investment scheme" (NIS), as it is currently generically called. It is expected to launch in 2028.

Proposals will be evaluated by Morningstar, an independent investment consultant appointed by the CPF Board. To simplify choices, two to three product providers are likely to be chosen, which will be announced in the first half of 2027.

In response to questions, a CPF Board spokesperson said the selection of solution providers "will follow a rigorous evaluation process covering areas such as investment strategy and process, investor journey, investment team quality and capability, and track record".

The spokesperson said CPF has been "progressively engaging the industry on the new scheme". Following an expression of interest exercise in April, the CPF Board opened a formal call for applications.

Low fees

Sources said offerors are expected to work within an all-in fee cap of 50 basis points, which is described by some as "challenging".

If so, the portfolios' total expense ratio (TER) would be even lower than the charges of Central Provident Fund Investment Scheme (CPFIS) digital advisers, and far lower than conventional CPFIS-included funds where the TER cap is 1.75 per cent for higher-risk funds, and 1.55 per cent for medium-risk funds.

Currently, platform and advisory fees are capped at 0.4 per cent. Such fees are likely not allowed for the new glide-path portfolios.

In the effort to keep expenses low, sources said agent bank fees may not apply. This is already the case for CPFIS Special Account (SA) investments, which bypass the requirement for agent banks. Investments using OA funds are subject to agent bank charges.

"The new investment scheme will be a simple and low-cost option designed for long-term investors who are prepared to take some risk for potentially higher returns, but who may have less expertise in navigating the CPFIS offerings or prefer not to actively manage their investments," said the CPF.

The portfolios' glide-path mechanism will automatically rebalance members' asset allocation from higher-risk assets, such as equities, towards lower-risk assets, such as bonds, as they approach their target retirement age.

The portfolio will be liquidated in phases by the target date, to mitigate the risk of a sharp downturn at the point of exit.

A source said the fee cap is “absolutely fantastic” for investors, but offerors will have to work within its confines to invest in operational capabilities and compliance, in addition to mounting an ongoing educational and marketing outreach.

UOB and OCBC and some large asset managers declined to comment.

DBS declined to say whether it is participating. However, Calvin Ong, DBS’ head of consumer banking, said CPF’s glide-path portfolios are a “timely addition” complementing the CPF’s interest rates and the CPFIS.

Ong said: “There is still scope to help more Singaporeans invest, strengthen their retirement adequacy, and prepare for longer lifespans... By automatically adjusting risk according to an individual’s life stage... (the portfolios) can help investors stay disciplined through market cycles without having to decide when or how to rebalance their portfolios.”

Some asset managers who are understood to have submitted or participated in proposals manage hundreds of billions of dollars in target-date retirement strategies in mature markets such as the US.

Target-date strategies are similar to the NIS in their use of a glide-path mechanism to adjust risk exposures over time. In the US, target-date strategies hit a total of US\$4.8 trillion in assets under management at end-2025, a Morningstar study showed.

Partnering

Endowus and AutoWealth, both digital advisers for CPFIS, are partnering asset managers in their proposals. AutoWealth has partnered Aberdeen as equity manager and Lion Global Investors for fixed income assets in its submission.

Endowus chairman Samuel Rhee said: “We are unable to confirm who and how we are partnering due to confidentiality reasons. But we will continue to be an open platform structure with a selection of best-in-class funds from global and leading local fund managers.”

iFast Financial chief executive Vincent Tong said iFast Singapore is participating in the formal applications submitted by several portfolio managers, serving as their platform partner.

“As CPF investment administrator and a leading **wealth** platform in Singapore and the region, iFast intends to play a major role in supporting the delivery and long-term success of these investment solutions.”

PhillipCapital executive director Lisa Lee said the most compelling aspect of the life-cycle investment scheme is that it gives CPF members a simpler way to invest for retirement. “This matters because while many Singaporeans recognise the importance of preparing for retirement, knowing where to begin can be cumbersome and staying on course can be difficult.”

She said supporting members in this journey “is where PhillipCapital’s experience can contribute if we are appointed”.

Incorporating advice

A plan design that supports ongoing advice is seen as a key attribute.

Schroders head of product Theron Lam believes the success of any life-cycle investment solution will depend on three factors. These are: simplicity, which helps CPF members understand the investment journey and stay invested; a focus on long-term retirement outcomes; and a deep understanding of the CPF ecosystem, “recognising the unique needs of Singapore investors and the specific requirements of CPF framework”.

Jeik Sohn, head of Singapore and South-east Asia client group at Capital Group, said the CPF’s glide-path portfolios are “a meaningful evolution in strengthening retirement outcomes” for members.

“Retirement preparedness is not just about access to investments but helping people to take action and stay invested through market cycles. Thoughtfully designed target-date solutions can support these objectives by balancing growth and risk over time while keeping investors focused on their long-term goals.”

Endowus' Rhee said the CPF glide-path portfolios, if well designed, will be able to provide "a lifetime of advice on an individual's path towards successful preparation for retirement". The glide path, along with lower costs and access to "great underlying fund components will definitely improve the chances of success".

AutoWealth chief investment officer Ow Tai Zhi said the firm plans to offer a simple, personalised retirement planning and investment service "that connects the CPF members' choices in retirement spending goals, investment commitments and risk-return preferences to a good probability of success".

"The understanding of these connections or trade-offs is paramount to inspire a disciplined investment commitment... to achieve the desired retirement spending goal."

DBS' Ong said the bank has "first-mover experience" with a glide-path strategy when it rolled out the DBS Retirement digiPortfolio in 2024. The portfolio adjusts the asset allocation not just in pre-retirement but also in retirement where investors can instruct automatic drawdowns based on retirement income needs.

The number of DBS Retirement digiPortfolio investors grew more than sixfold in 2025. Customers in their late 20s to 30s comprise close to half of all investors in the portfolio.

gen@sph.com.sg

Document STBT000020260803em830000a

TOP NEWS IN BANKING & FINANCIAL SERVICES

– Japan-based Sumitomo Mitsui Financial Group Inc. (SMFG) reported a consolidated net profit of ¥501.37 billion for the fiscal first quarter ended June 30, up 33.0% year over year from ¥376.90 billion. Net interest income rose 26.44% year over year to ¥791.89 billion from ¥626.28 billion, supported by wider domestic interest margins following the Bank of Japan's rate adjustments and higher earnings in global markets amid a favorable environment.

– HSBC Holdings PLC. agreed to sell its A\$36 billion Australian home and personal loan portfolio to Blackstone Inc. affiliate Virgo Bidco Pty. Ltd. The UK-based lender said in a stock exchange filing that it will wind down its Australian retail banking operations over 18 months, shifting its focus to corporate and institutional banking in Australia and New Zealand. The deal, expected to close in the first half of 2027, is subject to regulatory approvals.

➤ Bank stocks fall for 2nd straight week; Coastal, GBank lead the decliners

The KBW Nasdaq Bank index slipped 0.35% between the July 23 and July 30 market closes, underperforming the S&P 500, which edged up 0.40% over the same period.

➤ Conflict, economic shocks top risks for euro area banks – ECB stress test

When asked about nonfinancial risks that could materialize under their geopolitical risk scenarios, banks cited cyberattacks and service disruptions from third-party providers as the most prominent threats, according to the latest ECB stress test.

BANKING

– Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co. posted an attributable net profit of 24.90 billion pesos in the first half, inching up 0.23% from 24.85 billion pesos in the prior-year half. The bank's net interest income increased 12.8% to 67.70 billion pesos, while net interest margin remained stable at 3.74%. The Philippine bank's net profit for the second quarter declined 2.33% to 12.30 billion pesos from 12.59 billion pesos, while net interest income for the quarter stood at 34.38 billion pesos, up 12.13% year over year from 30.66 billion pesos.

– Japan's SBI Shinsei Bank Ltd. will begin paying dividends twice a year starting with the fiscal year ending March 31, 2027. The move aims to enhance shareholder returns while maintaining financial soundness, according to a statement by the lender. SBI Shinsei Bank set its interim dividend forecast at ¥10 per share.

– India-based Shivalik Small Finance Bank Ltd. completed its acquisition of ManiBhavnam Home Finance India Pvt. Ltd. for nearly 1.09 billion rupees, The Economic Times reported. The agreement involves a 20% payment in cash, with the remaining amount paid via a share exchange, bank officials said. Shivalik, which is backed by Japan-based Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp., received approval from the Ministry of Corporate Affairs in July.

– Mainland China-based Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank is exploring tokenized payments and digital settlement systems, tapping Hong Kong's growing digital finance ecosystem, the South China Morning Post reported, citing the development bank's treasurer, Domenico Nardelli. The plan is part of the bank's strategy to modernize its capital market operations, according to the publication.

– Bangladesh's government will no longer appoint the managing directors and CEOs of the country's six state-owned financial institutions, the Dhaka Tribune reported. Instead, it will nominate candidates for the positions, with final appointments made by bank boards.

FINANCIAL SERVICES

– Australia-based Pinnacle Investment Management Group Ltd. is weighing a bid for Bennelong Funds Management Ltd. after the asset manager began seeking a buyer in July, the Australian Financial Review's Street Talk blog reported. Pinnacle is exploring an all-of-company proposal or a breakup involving its existing affiliate, sources told the blog.

POLICY AND REGULATION

– The Bank of Japan said it held its short-term policy rate at 1.0% in an 8-1 vote. The Japanese regulator expects core inflation to accelerate to "clearly above" 2% starting in the second half of fiscal 2026. The central bank cited wage gains being passed into selling prices, higher crude oil prices and the yen's recent depreciation.

– Bangladesh Bank cut its benchmark policy rate by 50 basis points to 9.50%, effective Aug. 2. The central bank said the economy remains in a fragile, uneven recovery, with real GDP growth slowing to 2.2% in the third quarter of fiscal year 2026. The cut poses limited inflationary risks while supporting industrial production, employment and overall economic activity, the Bangladeshi regulator noted.

– Bangladesh Bank will also issue its monetary policy statement quarterly, replacing the current six-month cycle, The Financial Express reported. The central bank is expected to adopt the new system in September to make policy more responsive to economic conditions.

– The People's Bank of China, the National Financial Regulatory Administration and the China Securities Regulatory Commission have strengthened the governance of financial institutions in China. The new measures include prohibiting shareholders from abusing their rights or meddling in operations and preventing lenders from passing benefits to shareholders and related parties. By 2029, officials plan to set clearer governance limits, improve risk controls and strengthen the financial system with stricter monitoring of equity holdings and related-party deals, according to a news release.

– The People's Bank of China will continue to implement a suitably accommodative monetary policy and ensure sufficient liquidity, according to a summary of a work meeting held Aug. 1 to plan for the second half. The central bank will also strengthen the implementation of interest rate policy, maintain the yuan's stability at a reasonable and balanced level, and continue to refine its monetary policy framework.

– South Korea's Financial Services Commission penalized Lotte Card Co. Ltd. with 5 billion won and barred it from issuing cards to new customers from Aug. 1 to Sept. 15 over a data breach in 2025, The Korea Herald reported. The hack exposed the personal information of about 2.97 million customers, according to the publication.

INDUSTRY NEWS

– Japan's Finance Minister Satsuki Katayama is expected to announce Aug. 3 that the country collaborated with the US to stop the yen from falling to its lowest level in 40 years, Reuters reported, citing two government officials. One official told the news wire the operation was "still ongoing." US President Donald Trump said Aug. 2 that the US is assisting Japan in supporting the yen as a gesture of friendship and to support the global economy, Reuters noted.

– The Reserve Bank of India said its concessional foreign exchange swap facility drew \$40.82 billion in overseas currency inflows since opening in June. As of July 31, these comprised \$36.73 billion in foreign currency deposits from non-resident Indians, \$2.58 billion in overseas foreign currency borrowings and \$1.52 billion in external commercial borrowings.

– South Korea plans to establish a new sovereign **wealth** fund in 2027 to make long-term investments in advanced and strategic sectors, Yonhap News Agency reported, citing the Ministry of Finance and Economy. State-owned financial institutions such as The Korea Development Bank, The Export-Import Bank of Korea and Industrial Bank of Korea will contribute 16 trillion won to the fund, which will begin with an initial budget of at least 20 trillion won.

[Click here](#) for a summary of indexes on the S&P Capital IQ Pro platform.

As of July 31, US\$1 was equivalent to ¥159.36 and 61.17 Philippine pesos.

R Sio, Eden Estopace, Kanas Chan and Jonathan Cheah contributed to this report.

The Daily Dose has an editorial deadline of 6:30 am Hong Kong time. Some external links may require a subscription. Links are current as of publication time, and we are not responsible if they become unavailable later.

The crack in Asia's **wealth** transfer

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The high-net-worth life insurance boom in Asia seems like a straightforward growth story for carriers, but demand only becomes durable business when the financing behind large policies holds up.

[Larry Ikard](#)

The high-net-worth life insurance boom in Asia seems like a straightforward growth story for carriers, but demand only becomes durable business when the financing behind large policies holds up. Yuvarra's Mr Larry Ikard dives into the problem.

The APAC region is set to experience an intergenerational **wealth** transfer estimated at \$5.8tn by 2030.

In February 2026, Manulife Singapore issued a single life policy worth \$300m, breaking the record as the largest ever policy written, and surpassing the \$250m that HSBC Life recorded in Hong Kong two years prior. In the 12 months before that, the same insurer wrote 10 policies of more than \$50m each.

Wealthy families across Asia are using insurance more actively in legacy, estate and liquidity planning and demand for these policies is, understandably, capturing the attention of carriers. What has received less attention, however, is the problem of conversion.

When demand meets the funding test

For sizeable policies, funding decisions can matter to the client as much as the insurance decision.

A high-net-worth individual buying a seven, eight or nine-figure policy faces three routes. Pay the premium outright, but that may mean pulling capital out of businesses, investments or long-term assets. They can pledge a wider investment portfolio to support a loan, but that introduces collateral exposure and the risk of top-up calls if markets move.

Or they can use premium financing, which, when structured properly, allows the policy to be placed while preserving the client's broader **wealth** plan.

The latter option is how most sizeable cases are financed and addresses the very practical problem of clients hesitating when it comes time to fund the policy.

I have seen this happen many times throughout my career. A client may accept the policy and intend to proceed, only to reconsider at the moment they are required to part with their cash. Sometimes there is a clear reason, such as an investment taking a hit, but other times it is psychological block.

When the cheque has to be written, the commitment becomes real.

Premium financing is meant to solve that problem and make a viable policy easier to complete, but much of the premium financing infrastructure has not kept pace with demand and we see the introduction of operational hurdles instead.

A premium financing structure that helps to preserve a client's wider **wealth** plan can quickly convert demand into written business for carriers.

But a structure that introduces new account openings or wider banking requirements, opaque credit processes or late documentation requests is going to bring in new points of hesitation.

Clients and advisers can also be quickly worn down by these extra steps, known as deal fatigue in capital markets, and leave demand that might otherwise convert stuck.

When financing becomes a protection risk

Once a financing structure is in place, it does not stop mattering once the policy is written.

The purpose of many high-value life insurance policies is long-term protection. They are often designed to provide liquidity at a critical point for a family, whether that means paying estate obligations or protecting business continuity.

So, if the financing structure introduces instability, the policy may be exposed to the very risks it was designed to manage.

Unhedged cross-currency premium finance is an example of how financing can become a carrier risk after issuance.

The headline appeal is clear: a client borrows in Swiss Francs (CHF) or Japanese Yen (JPY) at a much lower rate to fund a US dollar-denominated policy.

But when the currency exposure is not hedged, the client keeps the full risk of exchange rate movements over the life of the loan. If the borrowing currency strengthens, the dollar cost of servicing and repaying that loan rises, potentially eroding or exceeding the upfront interest saving.

That matters because the risk sits under the policy. Premium finance loans carry loan-to-value covenants, and currency movements can reprice the loan in dollar terms overnight. A sharp currency move can trigger a margin call. If the client cannot meet it, the policy may be surrendered.

Why partner selection now matters to carriers

The quality of the financing ecosystem around their policies, therefore, should be growing in importance to insurance carriers.

A financing partner should be judged on several factors, such as the transparency of the loan application process, whether the loan relies on the client's wider portfolio or whether the premium financing is the lender's core business or one product among many competing priorities.

In the next phase of Asia's high-net-worth life insurance market, success will be defined by how much of the demand can be converted without weakening the protection the policy is meant to provide.

The carriers and advisers that crack conversion, seeking transparent and reliable partners, will be well-placed to capitalise on the booming opportunity at play.

Mr Larry Ikard is the CEO of Yuvarra.

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How integrated bancassurance is reshaping insurance distribution in Singapore

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Bancassurance is now a core pillar of Singapore's financial services landscape, accounting for more than a third of new business insurance premiums. HSBC Life Singapore CEO Mr Harpreet Bindra shares how the channel is evolving, and how integrated bancassurance models are delivering holistic **wealth**, health and protection solutions to clients.

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[HSBC Life Singapore logo](#)

The bancassurance channel has experienced strong double-digit growth in recent years, momentum that Mr Bindra attributes to the "deep and trusted relationships" banks cultivate with their customers across "multiple touchpoints."

With Singapore among the most banked markets globally, customers already see banks as custodians of their **wealth**, making the extension into insurance a natural progression.

"Bancassurance supports holistic customer engagement by seamlessly integrating insurance into financial planning across life stages, from **wealth** accumulation to retirement and legacy planning," Mr Bindra said. This integration allows banks to leverage their distribution reach — from physical branches and digital platforms to expert advisory from relationship managers and insurance specialists—to engage customers in more meaningful and timely ways.

Three pillars of customer value

Asked what customers gain from bancassurance, Mr Bindra pointed to "a compelling mix of convenience, trust, and holistic, personalised advice."

First, convenience. Customers can manage their banking, investments, and long-term protection in one place. "Whether it's paying premiums through existing bank accounts or accessing policies via digital banking apps, the experience is increasingly seamless, efficient and naturally embedded into a customer's financial journey," he said.

Trust forms the second pillar. Banks are highly trusted institutions that customers rely on to safeguard their savings and investments. "When insurance solutions are introduced to clients through their bank, this sense of trust and security is a key factor for many clients in making long-term financial commitments such as life and health insurance."

Third, relationship-led advice. Bank representatives can serve as a consistent point of contact and trusted professional with a detailed understanding of a client's financial situation and aspirations. "This enables more personalised, needs-based recommendations aligned to long-term goals — from life and health protection to retirement and legacy planning."

Integrating **wealth**, protection, and health

For HSBC Life Singapore, Mr Bindra emphasised that "bancassurance is not just a distribution channel but a key differentiator that allows us to integrate **wealth**, protection, and health into a single customer journey."

HSBC Life designs its solutions to support customers as needs evolve over a lifetime. Its Health and Wellness Centre, located within HSBC's **Wealth** Centre at Star Vista, reflects this integrated approach. "By embedding medical underwriting services into the financial planning journey, we have been able to remove friction, speed up processes and enable a seamless insurance experience for HSBC Bank customers," Mr Bindra said.

Behind the scenes, HSBC Life is leveraging data, analytics and AI to transform every stage of the insurance value chain – from anticipating customer needs and supporting relationship managers with more tailored recommendations, to accelerating underwriting, improving claims management and further enhancing customer service.

HSBC Life works closely with HSBC Private Bank as well, supporting the complex and often bespoke insurance needs of high-net-worth and ultra-high-net-worth customers, as Asia enters an unprecedented period of **wealth** creation and intergenerational **wealth** transfer.

Multi-distribution strategy

While integrated bancassurance is a key anchor, HSBC Life Singapore operates a comprehensive multi-channel ecosystem, serving customers across a broad range of touchpoints. This includes a growing agency advisory force alongside strategic financial adviser partnerships, broker relationships and distribution through SingPost. The aim is to keep solutions accessible — whether customers prefer highly personalised, face-to-face advice or more digital-first journeys.

This multi-channel architecture serves a wide spectrum of customer segments, from the mass affluent to ultra-high-net-worth individuals. The product suite spans savings, protection, health, investment, retirement and legacy planning, with a focus on helping customers prepare for four major structural challenges: addressing the protection gap, longevity/retirement, rising healthcare costs and intergenerational **wealth** transfer.

Shaping the Future

The next phase of bancassurance will be defined by how effectively banks and insurers work together to deliver personalised, digitally enabled and seamlessly integrated customer experiences.

“By blending technology-enabled insights and efficiency with human empathy, we are building a bancassurance model that is fundamentally customer-centric, digitally native and deeply integrated into every stage of our clients’ lives,” Mr Bindra said.

The evolution of bancassurance is far from over. As customer expectations rise and technologies such as AI reshape financial services, insurers and banks will need to rethink traditional distribution approaches. Ultimately, customers place their trust in institutions that understand their goals and can help them navigate life’s biggest decisions with confidence.

Those that simplify complexity, deliver high-quality advice, offer solutions that genuinely meet customer needs and combine technology with human expertise will define the next chapter of bancassurance in Asia.

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Talent tracker of the week: Top executive appointments and exits across industries

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BestMediaInfo.com tracks last week's major leadership appointments, promotions, and exits impacting the world of advertising, marketing, and media

New Delhi: India witnessed a busy week of senior-level movements across automotive, banking, consumer goods, media, technology and advertising. Honda Cars India, K Raheja Group and Instamart announced CEO-level appointments, while AU Small Finance Bank elevated Yogesh Jain as Deputy CEO. Standard Chartered strengthened its regional leadership with a new technology and operations chief, and Darwinbox named a new India Country Head. The advertising and media sector also saw several elevations at WPP Media, Dentsu India and Posterscope. Meanwhile, PepsiCo, Unilever, Nykaa, Nokia, HP and other companies added senior executives across marketing, design, communications, strategy and business growth functions.

Honda appoints Toshiyuki Yanagisawa as President and CEO of Honda Cars India

Honda Motor Co has appointed Toshiyuki Yanagisawa as President and CEO of Honda Cars India, effective October 1, 2026. He will continue to serve as CEO of Honda Digital Innovation India, jointly leading both businesses. Yanagisawa currently heads Honda's India Strategic Development Office, which is developing market-specific strategies as the company increases its focus on India. He has previously worked with Honda Cars India and brings experience of the country's automotive market and consumer trends. Current President and CEO Takashi Nakajima will move to Honda's regional headquarters at Asian Honda Motor after completing his tenure in India.

K Raheja Group appoints Vijayta Nikhil Raheja as Chief Executive Officer

K Raheja Group has appointed Vijayta Nikhil Raheja as Chief Executive Officer with immediate effect. She has been associated with the Group for 16 years, including nearly six years as Chief Operating Officer and a long tenure as Strategic Advisor to its hospitality business. In her new role, Raheja will report to Managing Director Nikhil K Raheja and oversee strategic direction, business operations, governance, commercial and compliance functions, organisational transformation and process improvements. Her mandate will also cover operational excellence, digital transformation and business expansion. The appointment is part of the Group's long-term plan to strengthen institutional leadership and governance.

Former Myntra CEO Nandita Sinha replaces Amitesh Jha as Instamart CEO

Instamart has appointed former Myntra CEO Nandita Sinha as Chief Executive Officer, effective August 3. She succeeds Amitesh Jha, who led the quick-commerce platform through a key phase of expansion and margin improvement. Sinha brings more than 20 years of experience across fashion, e-commerce and FMCG. She has previously held leadership positions at Flipkart, Britannia and Hindustan Unilever. At Instamart, she will oversee the company's next phase of growth, customer strategy and operations. Swiggy said her consumer internet experience, operational discipline and customer-focused approach would support Instamart's efforts to strengthen its position in India's quick-commerce market.

AU Small Finance Bank elevates Yogesh Jain as Deputy CEO

AU Small Finance Bank has elevated Yogesh Jain as Deputy Chief Executive Officer, effective July 25, 2026. He will continue working with Founder, Managing Director and CEO Sanjay Agarwal on operations, digital transformation and long-term growth. Jain has been associated with the bank for over 16 years and contributed to its transition from an NBFC to a small finance bank. A chartered accountant with more than two decades of

experience, he has handled treasury, strategic planning, technology, digital banking, credit cards, customer experience and lending. The elevation comes as the bank prepares for its proposed transition to a universal bank.

Standard Chartered appoints Kavita Kulkarni as India and South Asia CTOO

Standard Chartered has appointed Kavita Kulkarni as Chief Technology and Operations Officer for India and South Asia. Based in Mumbai, she will join the bank's India Country Management Team and lead the execution of its technology and operations strategy across the region. Kulkarni brings more than 25 years of experience in banking, **wealth management** and technology across India, the UK and the US. Before joining Standard Chartered, she served as Managing Director and Chief Information Officer for Private Banking and **Wealth Management** at Barclays Bank, where she led global technology and operations teams and supported the adoption of artificial intelligence.

Darwinbox appoints Akshay Murthy as Vice President and India Country Head

Darwinbox has appointed Akshay Murthy as Vice President and Country Head for India. In his new role, he will lead the company's business and growth strategy in the market, with a focus on helping enterprises modernise and scale their human resource operations through Darwinbox's human capital management platform. Murthy joins from Salesforce, where he spent more than seven years and most recently served as Commercial Leader for South Asia. He has also held senior sales roles at Oracle, IBM, Subex and Tejas Networks. Murthy began his career as a software engineer at Tata Consultancy Services and holds an MBA from the Asian Institute of Management.

Dentsu elevates Abhinay Bhasin to Executive Vice-President, product and technology

Dentsu India has elevated Abhinay Bhasin to Executive Vice-President, product and technology. He previously served as senior vice-president in the same division and will now lead the agency's product and technology function. Bhasin has played a key role in expanding Dentsu's data sciences and technology capabilities in India and across the Asia-Pacific region. His responsibilities have included product development, audience intelligence, campaign management, data-led client solutions and commercial performance. Before this role, he worked as head of product marketing at ProfitWheel and held assignments with Carat, Google, Isobar, The Economist and Deloitte India.

WPP Media elevates Rajiv Rajagopal as senior VP, Advanced TV

WPP Media has elevated Rajiv Rajagopal to Senior Vice-President and Head of Advanced TV, Media Solutions, India. In the expanded role, he will lead the company's Advanced TV strategy across audience planning, addressability, measurement and accountability standards for connected television. He will also develop solutions with technology platforms, broadcasters and advertisers, while driving research-led industry insights. Rajagopal has been associated with WPP Media, formerly GroupM, for over 10 years. He previously served as Business Head of Advanced TV and led client development at Finecast. His earlier experience includes roles at Star India, Red FM and Radio Mirchi.

Dentsu India promotes Maya Nair to Senior Vice President

Dentsu India has promoted Maya Nair to Senior Vice President. She joined the company as Vice President in October 2023 and has been associated with the organisation for nearly three years. Before joining Dentsu India, Nair spent more than five years at KPMG India, where she held roles across business consulting, transformation and risk advisory, most recently serving as Associate Director. Earlier, she worked with EY as an Associate Consultant and Consultant. Nair began her career as a Market Research Executive at Lumiere Business Solutions and has also interned with Clea PR and Concept PR. She holds a master's degree in management studies from Mumbai University.

Posterscope India promotes Rasiq Sultan to Vice President

Posterscope India, part of Dentsu India, has promoted Rasiq Sultan to Vice President. Sultan has been associated with the agency since 2022 and previously served as Senior Business Director. In that role, he led the South trading team across planning, buying and operations. His responsibilities included media negotiations, campaign planning, client pitches and cost optimisation. Sultan brings more than two decades of experience in out-of-home advertising, sales and client servicing. Before joining Posterscope India, he held leadership positions at Milestone Brandcom, Percept Out of Home and Outdoor Advertising Professionals.

Unilever India appoints Tanu Sinha as Head of Design

Unilever India has appointed Tanu Sinha as Head of Design. She joins the company after spending seven years at PepsiCo, where she served as Head of Design and worked across brands including Pepsi, Lay's, Mountain Dew, Kurkure, Gatorade, Tropicana, Doritos, Aquafina, Quaker and Mirinda. Before PepsiCo, Sinha was Design Director at Landor & Fitch, where she led the Nestle Design Lab and worked on branding and packaging for Maggi, KitKat, Munch and Nescafe. Her earlier experience includes roles at YAAP, Elephant Design, Salt Studios, Illum Design Project and Onio Design.

Tanvi Swami joins PepsiCo as Marketing Director for Pepsi, 7UP and Mirinda

PepsiCo India has appointed Tanvi Swami as Marketing Director for Pepsi, 7UP and Mirinda. She will lead marketing strategy for the company's flagship beverage brands. Swami joins PepsiCo after more than three years at Pernod Ricard India, where she most recently served as Marketing Director and managed premium spirits portfolios including Chivas Regal, The Glenlivet, gin brands and Lillet. Before that, she spent over seven years at Kellogg Company, working on brands such as Chocos, Muesli, Granola and Special K. She has also held marketing and sales roles at Britannia Industries. Swami has over 15 years of experience.

BBDO Group India appoints Ankit Singh as National Strategy Director

BBDO Group India has appointed Ankit Singh as National Strategy Director. He will join the network's strategy leadership team alongside Saad Khan, Chief Strategy Officer at ULKA, and Shashank Lanjekar, Chief Strategy Officer at BBDO India. Singh joins from Cheil X, where he led integrated growth strategies across creative, commerce and customer experience. He has nearly two decades of experience across agency and client-side roles. During his career, Singh has worked with brands including Apple, Pepsi, Coca-Cola, Uber, Airtel, Tinder, Reckitt, Ferrero and Hilton. He has previously held senior positions at Leo, BBH Group and GREY Worldwide.

Nykaa appoints Ankit Jain to lead quick-commerce vertical NYKAA NOW

Nykaa has appointed Ankit Jain to lead NYKAA NOW, its quick-commerce vertical offering beauty and personal care deliveries within 30 to 60 minutes. Jain brings more than 20 years of experience across supply chain planning, logistics, warehousing, factory operations and technology, with previous roles at Unilever, Flipkart and Instamart. He will oversee the service's expansion across key markets and strengthen supply chain and fulfilment infrastructure, including the use of artificial intelligence for demand forecasting and logistics planning. NYKAA NOW currently operates in 13 cities and offers products from over 1,000 luxury, FMCG and direct-to-consumer brands.

JK Lakshmi Cement appoints Aniruddha Sinha as Head of Marketing

JK Lakshmi Cement has appointed Aniruddha Sinha as Head of Marketing. In his new role, he will oversee the company's marketing strategy, brand-building efforts, consumer engagement and integrated marketing initiatives. Sinha brings more than two decades of experience across brand strategy, digital transformation, consumer insights, channel loyalty, product innovation and business growth. He has previously held leadership roles at Lafarge, Nuvoco Vistas, ABP, Bharti Walmart, Spencer's Retail, PepsiCo, Pernod Ricard, United Spirits and Emami. Sinha is an alumnus of IISWBM, Kolkata, and has completed a strategic management programme at IIM Calcutta.

Kotak Mahindra Bank marketing head Kedar Ravangave exits, moves to AI transformation role

Kedar Ravangave has stepped down as Head of Marketing at Kotak Mahindra Bank and will now focus on artificial intelligence-led business transformation. During his tenure, he worked on the bank's brand relaunch through the Hausla Hai Toh Ho Jayega campaign, the launch of Kotak Solitaire and the development of customer growth platforms. He was also involved in exploring AI applications within marketing. Ravangave plans to build AI-led operating systems for marketing organisations and help redesign businesses around emerging technology. Before joining Kotak Mahindra Bank, he spent over nine years at Amazon India and earlier worked with Marico and Wipro Technologies.

Blissclub appoints Srijan Suman as Head of Marketing

Blissclub has appointed Srijan Suman as Head of Marketing. Based in Bengaluru, he will lead the activewear brand's marketing function as it expands its movement wear portfolio for women and men. Before joining Blissclub, Suman served as Marketing Manager for Digital Commerce at Metyis for over two years. He previously worked as Growth Marketing Manager at Titan Company, overseeing the growth of its e-commerce businesses, including Titan, Fastrack, Sonata and the Titan World app. Suman has also held roles at MediaCom, Merkle Sokrati, shumeet, Zolo and Wipro. He holds a postgraduate diploma in management from NMIMS.

Kriti Nutrients appoints Manoj Singh as Head of Marketing

Kriti Nutrients has appointed Manoj Singh as Head of Marketing. In his new role, he will oversee brand development, consumer engagement, innovation and growth initiatives. Singh joins the company after serving as Head of Marketing at Cornitos for three years, where he managed brand growth, category expansion, digital marketing, e-commerce, product launches, packaging and consumer engagement. He previously worked as National Marketing Manager at Chaayos, handling marketing across more than 200 cafes and supporting new store launches. Singh has also held marketing and trade marketing roles at Organic India, Mother Dairy and Dharampal Satyapal Group.

TransIndia Group appoints Amit Samgiskar as Head of Marketing, Sales and CRM

TransIndia Group has appointed Amit Samgiskar as Head of Marketing, Sales and CRM. With more than 15 years of experience in real estate, he has led sales, business development, marketing and customer engagement functions across several organisations. In his new role, Samgiskar will focus on integrating sales, marketing and CRM to create a seamless customer journey. He will also use technology, analytics and customer insights to understand buyer behaviour and improve engagement across different stages of the homebuying process. His mandate includes aligning marketing campaigns with sales objectives, strengthening CRM processes, enhancing customer value and supporting the company's growth plans.

FLAME University appoints Dhaivat Mehta as Brand Evangelist

FLAME University has appointed Dhaivat Mehta as Brand Evangelist and Director of Branding and Communication. In his new role, he will lead institutional communications, stakeholder engagement and brand strategy as the university expands its academic programmes, global collaborations and research initiatives. Mehta brings more than two decades of experience in branding and corporate communications across the private and public sectors. He previously served as Vice President of Global Brand and Corporate Communications at Sagility and Global Brand Communications Director at Capgemini. He has also held marketing and public diplomacy roles at the British Council and the British High Commission.

Eloelo Group appoints Rahul Nag as Head of Brand Communications

Eloelo Group has appointed Rahul Nag as Head of Brand Communications. In his new role, he will lead the entertainment technology company's brand narrative and communications as it expands its portfolio, including vertical storytelling platform StoryTV. Before joining Eloelo Group, Nag served as Director of Brands, Communications and Partnerships at Pocket FM for over four years, leading communications across India and the US. He previously headed communications at ShareChat and public relations and corporate communications at Mindtree. Nag has also worked with Flock, Text100, HCL Infosystems, IPAN Hill and Knowlton, Adfactors PR and SAPRA India Foundation.

HP appoints Dirk Lewis as India Market Communications Lead

HP has appointed Dirk Lewis as India Market Communications Lead. In his new role, he will oversee the company's communications strategy for India, covering corporate and product storytelling, media relations, content development and the localisation of global campaigns and activations. Lewis joins HP from Tata Digital, where he served as Director of Corporate Communications, Online Reputation Management and Sustainability. He has previously held communications and public relations roles at MSLGroup India, Text100, Wipro, Fleishman-Hillard and Gartner. During his career, Lewis has worked with brands across technology, consumer services, financial services and aviation.

Kanika Bedi joins Nokia as Regional Communications Manager

Nokia has appointed Kanika Bedi as Regional Communications Manager, where she will lead media relations for the company in India. Bedi brings more than 16 years of experience across corporate communications, reputation management, sustainability communication and executive positioning. Before joining Nokia, she worked independently through PersonaKraft, advising founders, senior executives and organisations. She previously led corporate communications for India and South Asia at Reckitt and held multiple communications and sustainability roles at The Coca-Cola Company. Earlier in her career, Bedi worked with International Paper and Ericsson. She has also served as visiting faculty at the Altera Institute.

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Companies

StanChart to transfer part of credit card, personal loan clients to Trust Bank

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STANDARD Chartered (StanChart) will be transferring part of its credit card and personal loan clients to Trust Bank to boost growth in Singapore.

The move, which will take place in September, is expected to deepen both banks' combined abilities to serve retail banking clients in Singapore, StanChart said on Friday (Jul 31).

Following this, Trust will continue to scale its digital banking platform and everyday banking propositions, while StanChart invests in **wealth** capabilities.

Affected customers' other existing relationships with StanChart, including deposit accounts, **wealth** products and insurance policies, will be unchanged.

StanChart declined to disclose the number of affected customers.

A spokesperson said that mortgage loans are not part of the transfer. Affected customers will be contacted directly with information on what the transfer means for them and any next steps, the spokesperson added. Trust is a subsidiary digital bank jointly owned by StanChart and FairPrice Group.

FairPrice Group CEO Vipul Chawla noted that Trust was set up to bring "fuss-free and rewarding banking services right into the heart of Singaporeans' daily lives".

Trust posted a loss of S\$54 million in FY2025, narrowing from S\$93 million the year before.

But the digital bank managed to turn profitable in March 2026, making it one of the fastest digital banks in Singapore to swing into the black.

Trust has more than one million customers. Its products and features include numberless cards that combine debit and credit functions, no foreign-exchange fees on overseas spending, and integrated rewards across FairPrice Group purchases.

Meanwhile, London-headquartered StanChart beat expectations to post a pre-tax profit of US\$2.33 billion for the second quarter of 2026, bolstered by the strength of its **wealth** business and global banking.

In a strategy update in May, StanChart said it was targeting higher returns by cutting headcount and expanding its **wealth** business.

StanChart also owns digital bank Mox in Hong Kong, which was set up in 2020 as a joint venture with telco HKT and its parent PCCW, as well as Trip.com.

Kathy Chan, Morningstar equity analyst, noted that StanChart's latest move broadly mirrors its earlier transfer of a US\$1 billion personal instalment loan portfolio to Mox.

StanChart is building scale in its majority-owned digital banks, while the parent bank sharpens its focus on affluent clients in line with strategy, she said.

Nevertheless, Chan does not see this as a "complete bifurcation" between its mass retail customers and the **wealth management** business.

“StanChart has previously highlighted the role of digital banks as a part of the client continuum, and a **wealth** incubator that provides a pipeline of future affluent clients,” she added.

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Tej Company Profile - HSBC Holdings plc

542 words

1 August 2026

Taiwan Economic Journal - Hong Kong Company Profile

TEJHK

English

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Company Name :
HSBC Holdings plc
Address : 1 Queen's Rd C Central, HK
Telephone : (852)-28221111 Fax No : (852)-25375109
Stock Exchange: HKSE Stock Exchange Company Code : 00005
Industry Index: Financials Accounting End :12
Listing in : Main Board Employee No : 257,603
Listed Date : Establishment Date :1866/08/14
Chairman : Brendan Robert NELSON
President : Georges Bahjat ELHEDERY
Business : HSBC Holdings plc (HSBC) is a banking and financial services company. Its business segments include Hong Kong, UK, Corporate and Institutional Banking (CIB), and International **Wealth** and Premier Banki

Balance Sheet (Units: Million)

Code /Date	USD 2026/03	%	USD 2025/12	%	USD 2024/12
% USD 2023/12	%				
Total assets	3,306,011	100.00	3,233,034	100.00	3,017,048
100.00	3,038,677	100.00			
Total liabilities	3,108,741	94.03	3,027,368	93.64	2,824,775
93.63	2,846,067	93.66			
Common stocks		NA	8,588	.27	8,973
.30	9,631	.32			
PreKerred stocks		NA	0	.00	0
.00	0	.00			
Reserves-B/S		NA	189,637	5.87	176,000
5.83	175,698	5.78			
Minority Intere		451 .01	7,441	.23	7,300
.24	7,281	.24			
Total stockholder	197,270	5.97	205,666	6.36	192,273
6.37	192,610	6.34			
Total liabilities	3,306,011	100.00	3,233,034	100.00	3,017,048
100.00	3,038,677	100.00			

Financial Ratios

	2025/12	2024/12	2023/12	2022/12	2021/12
2020/12					

Profit Ability

Return on Total	.74	.83	.82	.55	.49
.21					

Return on Equity	11.63	12.99	13.00	8.29	7.14
3.07					
Pre-Tax Income R	43.80	49.06	45.94	33.70	29.57
13.92					
Net Income Ratio	33.88	37.96	37.18	32.10	22.98
9.67					
Liquidity					
Current Ratio	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
NA					
Asset Turnover					
Fixed Asset Turn	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
NA					

Share Holdings

Date : 2026/06

Share holder	Holding Shares	Holding Ratio	Duty
-----	-----	-----	----
Blackrock, Inc.			Substantial Shareholders
1,586,341,122	9.23		
Ping An Asset Management Co., Ltd.			Substantial Shareholders
1,502,584,731	8.74		
The Bank of New York Mellon Corporation			Substantial Shareholders
1,032,088,179	6.01		
J. P. Morgan Chase &Co.			Substantial Shareholders
871,870,258	5.07		
Geraldine Buckingham			Independent Non-executive Di
15,000	0.		
Dame Carolyn Fairbairn			Independent Non-executive Di
15,000	0.		
Duan Xiao Ying			Independent Non-executive Di
15,000	0.		

Per Share Ratios

Financial Data Date: 2026/03

Currency: USD

Sales Per Share	:	1.09	YOY% Total Assets :	8.24 %
Operating Income Per Share	:	.50	YOY% Total Equity :	-.43 %
Pre_Tax Income Per Share	:	.52	YOY% Fixed Assets :	NA %
BEPS	:	NA	Labittities % :	94.03 %

Shares Market Movements

(Units: HKD\$)

Date	Close	Vol.(000)	ROI	Market Value(000)
----	-----	-----	-----	-----
2026/07	168.200	317,553	13.73	2,890,275,438
2026/06	147.900	346,311	1.93	2,541,449,092
2026/05	145.100	276,065	4.07	2,493,334,633
2026/04	140.200	290,158	11.45	2,409,135,186
2026/03	125.800	511,587	-12.26	2,161,691,915

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Business

Blackstone forks out \$36bn for HSBC loans

Bridget Carter

469 words

1 August 2026

The Australian

AUSTRN

Australian

25

English

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HSBC has confirmed a sale of its \$36bn Australian home and personal loan portfolio to Blackstone in a deal that will bring in Pepper Money to manage the assets.

The sale confirms reports in DataRoom that the New York private equity giant was buying the loans with HSBC to retain Australian deposits.

HSBC said it would continue to invest in and grow its corporate and institutional banking, private banking and asset management businesses in Australia.

The remainder of the HSBC retail business in Australia would be wound down over 18 months.

Customers holding HSBC credit cards or deposit accounts in Australia will need to make alternative arrangements, though HSBC has stressed that no immediate action is required.

Blackstone, advised by Morgan Stanley and Barrenjoey, is the world's largest alternative asset manager. Working on the sale for HSBC was Citi.

The Australian-listed Pepper Money will act as the servicer of the \$36bn portfolio, HSBC said.

Pepper Money is one of Australia's largest non-bank lenders, with over 26 years' experience as a lender and service provider across a wide range of asset classes and portfolio transactions.

HSBC said the sale of the portfolio was expected to be completed in the first half of 2027, subject to regulatory approval.

The retail products scheduled for wind down over 18 months, which include transaction accounts, savings and term deposits, credit cards, foreign currency accounts, and **wealth** and investment products, affect a significant number of Australian customers. HSBC said the decision to sell the portfolio and wind down the remainder of the retail business follows a strategic review of HSBC Australia's retail business and forms part of the ongoing simplification of the HSBC Group. "HSBC is focused on increasing leadership and market share in the areas where it has clear competitive advantage and the greatest opportunities to grow and support its clients," the bank said.

HSBC said the disposal of the portfolio was expected to generate an immaterial loss for the HSBC Group.

Blackstone said the transaction was happening through funds managed by Blackstone Credit & Insurance, Blackstone Tactical Opportunities, and Blackstone Real Estate Debt Strategies.

"International expansion is a major priority for our private credit business," Dan Leiter, head of international for Blackstone Credit & Insurance, said.

Also overseeing the transaction was Mike Culhane, head of international business development for Asset Based Finance, Blackstone Credit & Insurance, who previously ran and co-founded Pepper Money.

"Pepper Money will serve as the portfolio's loan management partner," he said. Blackstone is the world's largest alternative asset manager with over \$1.3 trillion in assets under management. This includes global investment

strategies focused on real estate, private equity, credit, infrastructure, life sciences, growth equity, secondaries and hedge funds.

The Australian-20260801-Australian-25-000503263162

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Search Summary

Text	"wealth" or "wealth management"
Date	01/08/2026 to 30/08/2026
Source	Group: All Pubs Excluding Wires Not MBMR (Mavericks Business & Market Research) (India)
Author	All Authors
Company	DBS Group Holdings Limited Or Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Limited Or United Overseas Bank Limited Or HSBC Holdings PLC Or Standard Chartered PLC
Subject	All Subjects
Industry	All Industries
Region	All Regions
Language	English
Results Found	268
Timestamp	24 August 2026 12:18